Pew Research Center

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Americans More Upbeat on the Economy; Biden's Job Rating Remains Very Low

In their own words: How people feel about the economy

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How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand how the public views Joe Biden and the economy at the start of the new year. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16-21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

Americans More Upbeat on the Economy; Biden's Job Rating Remains Very Low

In their own words: How people feel about the economy

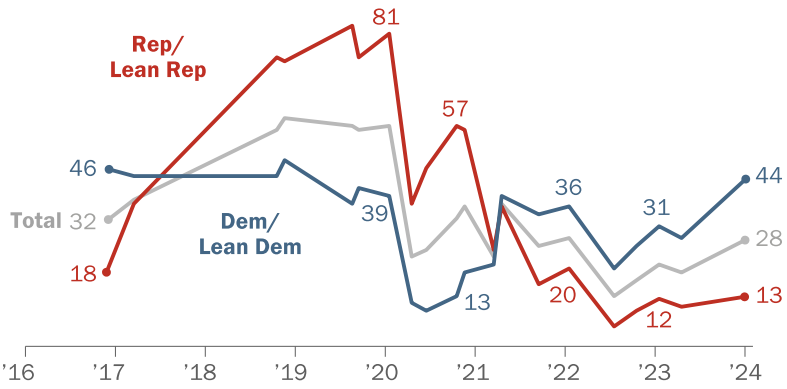
Americans' views of the nation's economy – while mostly stagnant for the past few years – are showing signs of improvement. Slightly more than a quarter (28%) rate economic conditions as excellent or good, a 9 percentage point increase from last April.

Virtually all the change since then has come among Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents. Currently, 44% of Democrats have positive views of the economy – the highest share of Joe Biden's presidency.

The new survey by Pew Research Center, conducted Jan. 16-21 among 5,140 adults, finds that Biden's own job rating remains highly negative: Just 33% of Americans approve of his job performance, unchanged from last month.

Positive views of the nation's economy increase, driven by Democrats

*% who say economic conditions in this country today are **excellent or good***



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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The economy, past and future; top concerns

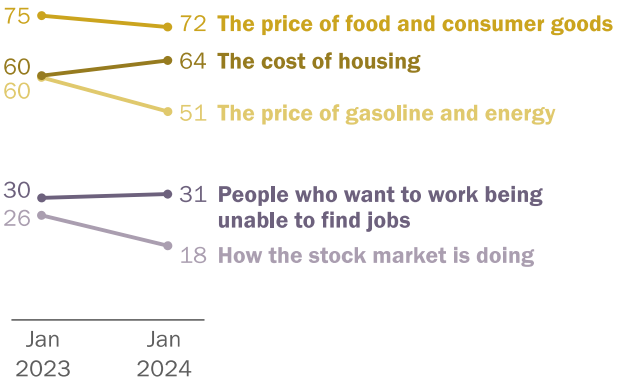
Despite the improvement in economic attitudes, the public is far less upbeat today than it was from 2018 through early 2020, during Donald Trump's presidency and prior to the outbreak of the coronavirus pandemic.

Economic ratings remain far less positive than before the pandemic. In January 2020, 57% of Americans rated economic conditions as excellent or good; positive ratings fell to 23% in April of that year, as the coronavirus outbreak spread across the country. Views of the economy improved early during Biden's first few months in office but declined subsequently.

The public's future economic outlook turns less negative. The share of Americans saying economic conditions will be worse a year from now has fallen from 46% last April to 33% today.

Consumer prices remain a major concern, but fewer say they are very concerned about energy prices

*% who say they are **very concerned** about each of the following economic issues in the country today*



Note: Item on stability of banks not asked in January 2023.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16 -21, 2024.

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However, more continue to say that conditions will be *worse* than *better* (26%) next year; 41% expect the economy will be about the same as it is today.

There's less concern about energy prices and the stock market. A sizable majority of Americans (72%) say they are very concerned about prices for food and consumer goods, little changed from last year. The cost of housing also is a major issue, with 64% very concerned.

However, the shares expressing a great deal of concern about prices of gasoline and energy and how the stock market is doing have declined 9 points and 8 points, respectively, since last January.

In their own words: Americans on the economy

When the majority of Americans who rate economic conditions poor or only fair are asked *why* they feel this way, most point to inflation or high prices. Nearly half (45%) specifically mention high inflation (28%) or the high cost of living (21%); 11% specifically point to the high cost of food and groceries or the cost of housing.

People who view the economy positively – those who rate conditions as excellent or good – most often say low unemployment is a major reason why they feel the way they do (43% say this). Other factors cited are that inflation has come down (18%), wage growth (10%), or the strong performance of the stock market (9%).

Why do Americans rate the economy the way they do?

*Why did you rate national economic conditions the way you did? (%) **[open-end]***

Among those who say conditions are **excellent/good** (28% of adults)	%
Low unemployment	43
Inflation is down	18
Wage growth	10
Positive mentions of stock market	9
U.S. outperforming expectations	5

Among those who say conditions are **only fair/poor** (72% of adults)	%
High inflation	28
High cost of living	21
Lack of good paying jobs/ Wages low	15
National debt	7
High cost of food and groceries	6
High cost of housing	6
High interest rates	6
Negative mentions of Biden/Democrats	6
Illegal Immigration	5
Wealth inequality	5

Note: Researchers coded up to three responses. Only responses that made up 5% or more of responses are shown here. Refer to topline for full question wording and response list.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Biden's job performance, personal traits

Currently, 33% of Americans approve of Joe Biden's job performance, while 65% disapprove. Biden's job rating has not been above 40% since April 2022.

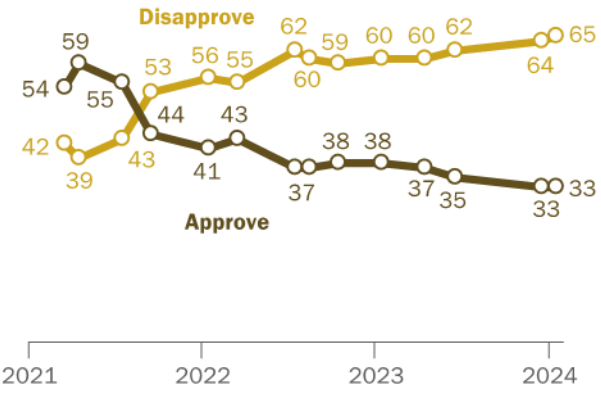
Young adults are negative about Biden's job performance. Biden's job rating is low across all age groups, including young adults. Just 27% of adults ages 18 to 29 approve of the way Biden is handling his job as president, while 71% disapprove.

Black adults are divided over Biden. About as many Black adults disapprove (49%) as approve (48%) of Biden's job performance. Biden's job rating is lower among Asian (39%), Hispanic (32%) and White (30%) adults.

Views of Biden's personal traits have grown less positive. Biden gets his most positive ratings for being even-tempered (62% say this phrase describes him very or fairly well) and standing up for what he believes in (50%).

By nearly 2 to 1, Americans disapprove of Biden's job performance

% who say they ___ of the way Joe Biden is handling his job as president



Note: No answer responses are not shown
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Far fewer Americans describe him as mentally sharp (29%), inspiring (26%) or energetic (24%). For the most part, perceptions of Biden's personal traits have followed the same downward trajectory as his job ratings.

Judgments on Biden's legacy

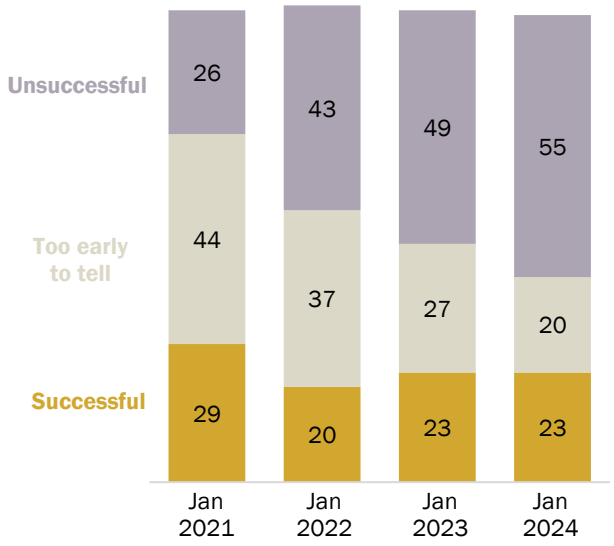
The share of Americans saying that Biden will be an unsuccessful president in the long run has increased steadily over the course of his administration.

Currently, 55% say he will be an unsuccessful president while just 23% say he will be successful; 20% say it is too early to tell. These opinions, like other views of Biden, are deeply partisan: Republicans overwhelmingly say Biden will be unsuccessful (87%).

Among Democrats, 45% say he will be successful, 26% say unsuccessful, and 28% say it is too early to tell.

Growing share of Americans say Biden ultimately will be an unsuccessful president

% who say Biden will be a(n) __ president in the long run



Note: No answer responses are not shown
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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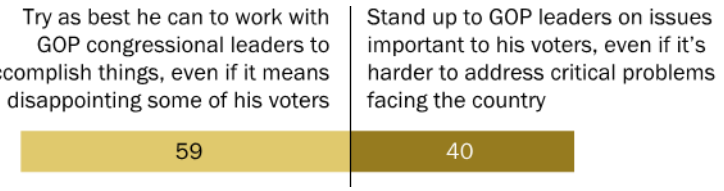
Other findings on partisan compromise and the House GOP impeachment inquiry

A majority of Democrats (59%) say Biden should try his best to work with GOP leaders to accomplish things, even if that disappoints some of his voters; only 32% of Republicans say the same of GOP leaders trying to reach compromises with Biden. These opinions have changed little over the course of Biden's presidency.

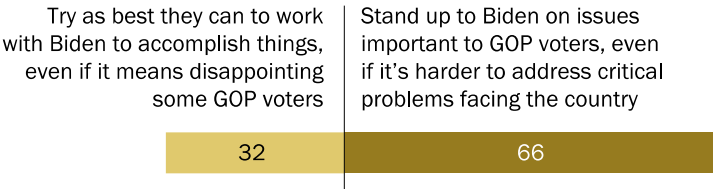
During the Trump administration, Democrats were less likely to say their party's leaders should seek compromise with Trump than Republicans were to say their party should try to seek political compromise with Democratic leaders.

Democrats more likely than Republicans to support efforts aimed at forging partisan compromises

Among Democrats and Democratic leaners, % who say Joe Biden should ...



Among Republicans and Republican leaners, % who say Republican congressional leaders should ...



Note: No answer responses are not shown
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

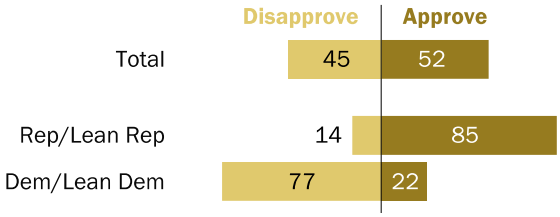
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About half of Americans (52%) approve of House Republicans' decision to conduct an impeachment inquiry into Joe Biden, while 45% disapprove. These opinions – and views about whether Biden has done anything that is grounds for his impeachment – are deeply divided along partisan lines: 85% of Republicans approve of the inquiry, while 77% of Democrats disapprove.

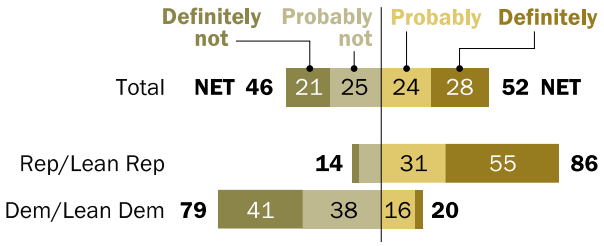
Relatively few Americans (16%) say they are following news about the impeachment inquiry launched by House Republicans into Biden's conduct and possible connections to his son Hunter's business dealings extremely or very closely.

Wide partisan divide on House GOP's impeachment inquiry into Biden

% who ___ of the House of Representatives' decision to conduct an impeachment inquiry into Joe Biden



% who think Joe Biden has ___ done things that are grounds for impeachment



Note: No answer responses are not shown
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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1. Views of the nation's economy

About three-in-ten Americans (28%) currently rate national economic conditions as excellent or good, while a similar share (31%) say they are poor and about four-in-ten (41%) view them as "only fair."

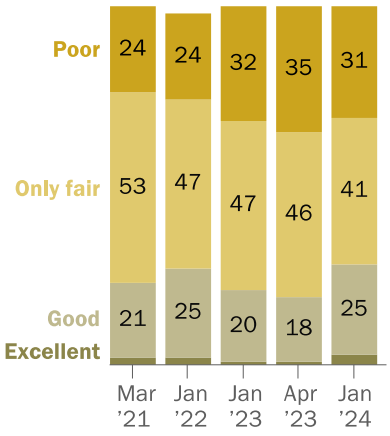
While ratings remain substantially lower than they were prior to the start of the COVID-19 pandemic, they are more positive than they were last spring – when just 19% viewed the economy in positive terms.

Expectations for *future* economic conditions are also more positive than they were last spring: **Today, roughly a quarter say that they expect economic conditions will be better a year from now (26%) – up from 17% in April 2023.**

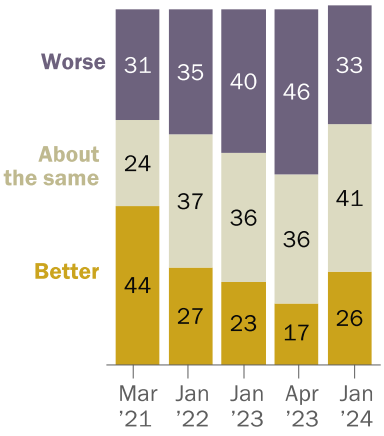
At the same time, the share who says conditions will be worse has declined by 13 percentage points. About four-in-ten say they expect conditions will be about the same.

Modest improvement in national economic outlook

% who say that economic conditions in this country today are ___



% who say they expect that economic conditions in the country will be ___ a year from now



Note: No answer responses are not shown. Refer to the topline for full trend.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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As has long been the case, partisans who share the party of the president have more positive views of economic conditions than those who support the opposing party. **Today, 44% of Democrats and Democratic leaners say the nation's economy is excellent or good. This compares with 13% of Republicans and GOP leaners.**

Similarly, Democrats are more likely than Republicans to say they expect economic conditions a year from now will be better than they are today: 34% of Democrats say this, compared with 20% of Republicans.

There are substantial differences *among* Democrats in views of the nation's economy – particularly by age and income.

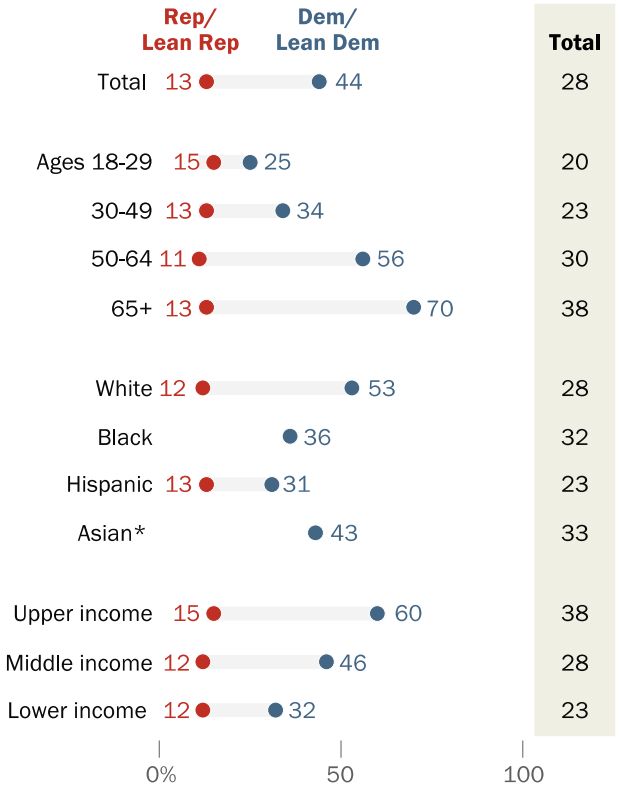
Younger Democrats are much less likely than older Democrats to view current economic conditions in positive terms. Among Democrats under 30, a quarter view the economy positively. This share rises to 34% among those ages 30 to 49, 56% among those 50 to 64, and 70% among those 65 and older.

There are also significant differences by race and ethnicity. **White Democrats are more likely than Black, Hispanic and Asian Democrats to say the economy is excellent or good.**

Democrats in different income groups also diverge in their evaluations of the nation's economy. **Democrats with higher household incomes are more positive about economic conditions than Democrats with lower incomes.** A clear majority of upper-income Democrats (60%) say the economy is doing excellent or good. By comparison, 32% of those with lower incomes view the economy positively, while a majority say it is only fair (40%) or poor (28%).

Among Democrats, wide differences by age, race and ethnicity, and income in views of nation's economy

*% who say that economic conditions in this country today are **excellent/good***



* Asian adults were interviewed in English only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Insufficient sample size to show results among Hispanic and Black Republicans. Family income tiers are based on adjusted 2022 earnings.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Across Republican groups, economic assessments vary less drastically. Republicans overwhelmingly rate the economy negatively: Just 15% or less across demographic groups say national economic conditions are good or excellent.

However, there are some differences in how negative GOP assessments are. For instance, upper-income Republicans are more likely to say the economy is doing only fair (48%) rather than poorly

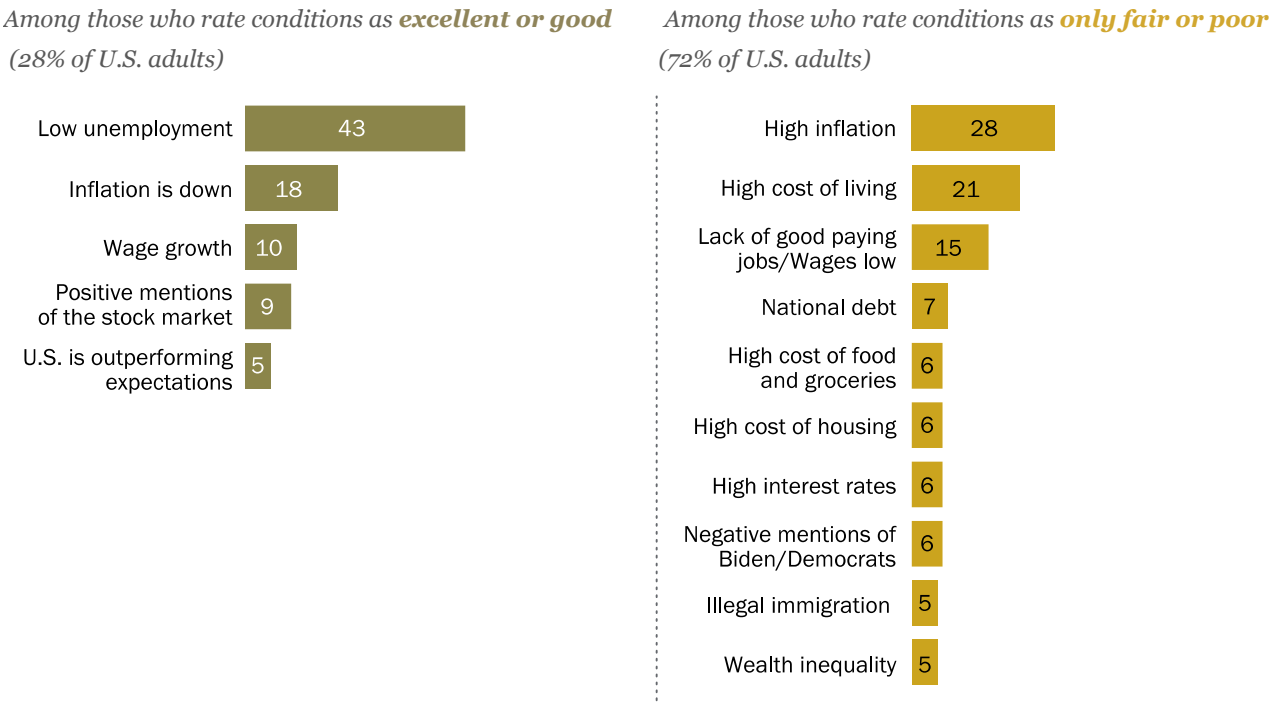
(36%), while lower-income Republicans are more likely to say poor (49%) rather than only fair (38%).

Why do Americans rate the nation's economy as they do?

In an open-ended question which asked Americans to explain the reasons for their overall evaluation of the nation's economy (as excellent, good, only fair, or poor), people provide wide-ranging answers.

The reasons behind Americans' ratings of national economic conditions

In a few words, what are the main reasons for your rating of economic conditions in the country (%) ***[open-end]***



Note: Researchers coded up to three responses. Only responses for which 5% or more of respondents listed the reason are shown. Refer to the topline for a full list of responses. Totals may exceed 100% due to multiple responses.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.
"Americans More Upbeat on the Economy; Biden's Job Rating Remains Very Low"

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Among the 28% of Americans who say the nation's economy is doing excellent or good, many offer overwhelmingly positive reasons for why they rate the economy this way. A large share (43%) note the country's low unemployment, while 18% say that inflation is coming down or is lower than it has been in recent months. Roughly one-in-ten mention wage growth, while a similar share (9%) say strong stock market performance contributes to their rating. And 5% say the reason for their rating is that the U.S. is outperforming expectations or otherwise doing better than other countries in terms of economic growth.

Among the 72% of adults who say the economy is doing only fair or poor, most offer negative reasons for why they rate the economy the way they do. Those who say the economy is only fair are slightly more likely to offer a mix of positive and negative responses than those who say the economy is poor. However, respondents in both groups offer similar reasons for their ratings.

Among those who say the nation's economy is only fair or poor, high inflation or high costs of various goods are frequently mentioned: 28% say high inflation is a main reason they evaluate the economy as only fair or poor, while roughly two-in-ten cite the high cost of living. Along this same theme, 6% point to the high cost of food and groceries while identical shares say the high cost of housing and high interest rates are a main reason they view the economy as doing only fair or poor.

Other issues are also mentioned: 15% say the lack of good paying jobs or low wages is a major reason for their rating while 7% point to the national debt and government spending. Another 5% give a negative response about Biden's or Democrats' economic policies more broadly.

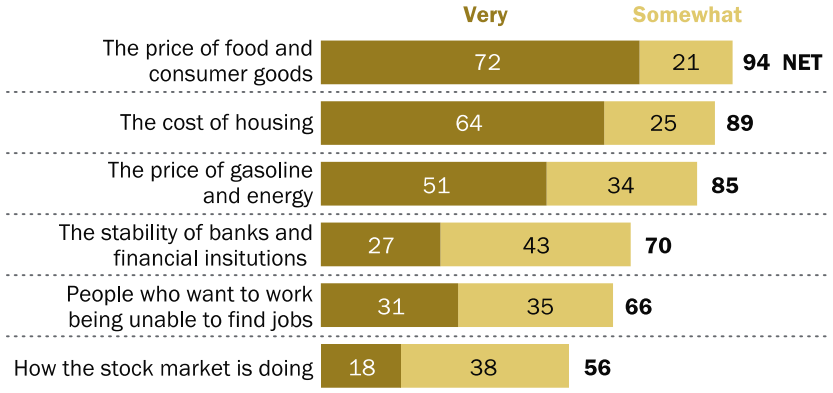
Cost of goods, housing remain top economic concerns

Majorities of Americans continue to express a high level of concern about the price of food and consumer goods (72% say they are very concerned about this) and the cost of housing (64%). About half (51%) say they are very concerned about the price of gasoline and energy. More than eight-in-ten say they are at least somewhat concerned about each of these economic issues.

Other economic issues rank lower on the public's list of concerns. Smaller shares of Americans say they are very concerned about the stability of banks and financial institutions (27%), people who want to work being unable to find jobs (31%) or the performance of the stock market (18%).

Household costs top Americans' list of economic concerns

% who say they are ___ concerned about each of the following economic issues in the country today



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

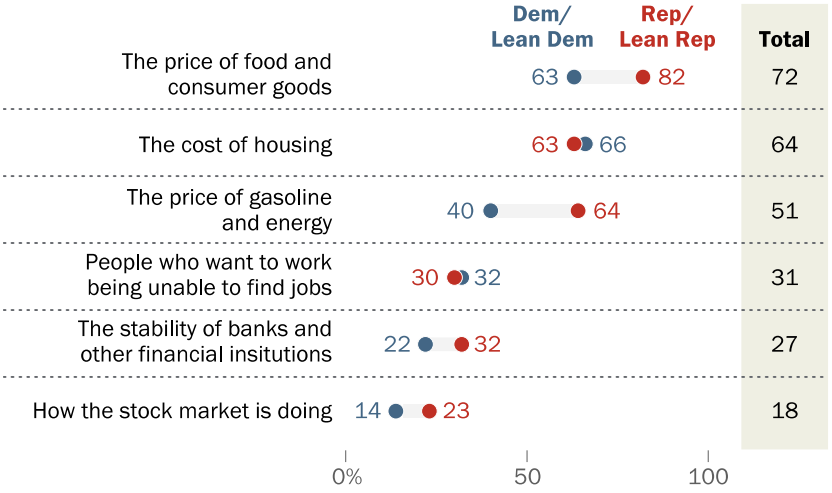
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Majorities in both parties are very concerned about the cost of goods and housing

Republicans and Democrats are fairly aligned in their economic concerns. Majorities in both groups say they are very concerned about the cost of food, consumer goods and housing. And substantially smaller shares express concern about the stability of banks or the performance of the stock market.

Modest partisan gaps in economic concerns

*% who say they are **very concerned** about each of the following*



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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However, Republican concern about the price of food and consumer goods is more widespread than Democratic concern (82% vs. 63%). And the partisan gap on concerns about the price of gasoline and energy is even wider: A 64% majority of Republicans say they are *very* concerned about the cost of gas, compared with 40% of Democrats.

Partisans' expectations for the year ahead

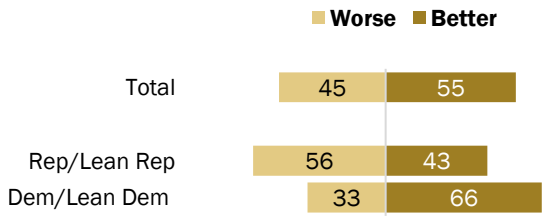
As has been the case for the last three years, Democrats are more likely than Republicans to say the upcoming year will be better than the last. Two-thirds of Democrats say 2024 will be better than 2023, while 43% of Republicans say the same.

This dynamic in feelings about the new year – with Democrats expressing more optimism than Republicans – has held true since 2021. Then, 83% of Democrats said 2021 would be better than 2020 while 48% of Republicans agreed.

In 2020, the pattern was the reverse. Republicans were more likely to say 2020 would be better than 2019 compared with Democrats (78% vs. 36%, respectively).

Will 2024 be better than 2023?

% who say, looking ahead, they think 2024 will be ___ than 2023



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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In Pew Research Center surveys dating back to 2006 (when the question was first asked), Americans who identify with or lean toward the president's party have tended to be more optimistic about the coming year than those who associate with the opposing party.

2. Biden's job rating, personal traits and whether he will be a successful president

Today, 33% of Americans approve of President Joe Biden's job performance, while 65% disapprove. Biden's overall approval rating is nearly identical to his rating last month.

Biden also gets low marks for many personal traits and characteristics, with two exceptions: 62% say "even-tempered" describes Biden very or fairly well, while half say he stands up for what he believes in.

Partisans' views of Biden's personal characteristics

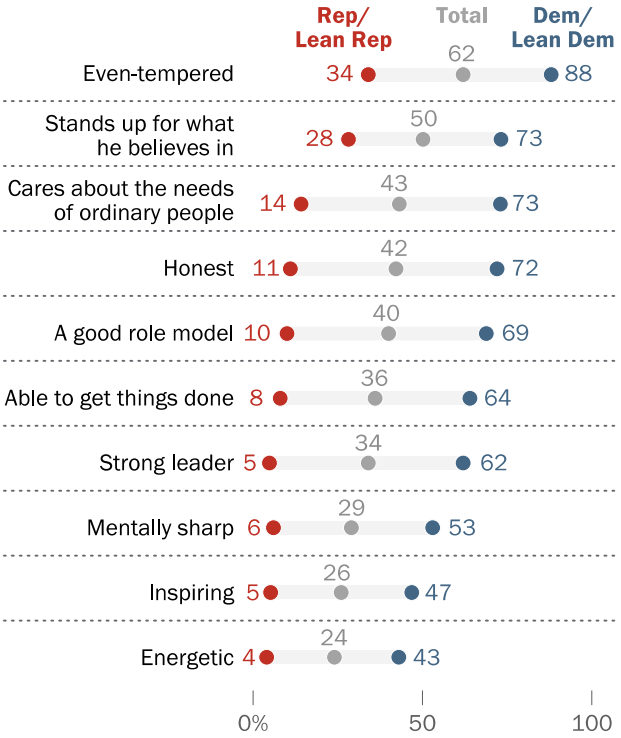
As is often the case, Republicans and Democrats sharply differ in their views of Biden's personal traits. Very few Republicans and GOP leaners say most positive descriptions apply to Biden, although about a third (34%) say he is even-tempered and 28% say he stands up for his beliefs.

Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents are very positive about some – though not all – of Biden's traits and characteristics. For example, 88% say he is even-tempered and roughly seven-in-ten describe him as someone who stands up for his beliefs, cares about the needs of ordinary Americans, is honest and is a good role model.

Yet Democrats express mixed views of some of Biden's other traits. About half (53%) say he is mentally sharp; fewer say he is inspiring (47%) or energetic (43%).

Biden widely viewed as even-tempered; fewer than a third describe him as mentally sharp, inspiring, energetic

% who say each of the following describes Joe Biden ***very or fairly well***



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Perceptions of Biden over time

For the most part, views of Biden's personal traits have become less positive over the course of his presidency.

For example, during the 2020 presidential campaign, about half of Americans (53%) said the phrase "cares about the needs of ordinary Americans" described him very or fairly well.

The share describing him this way rose to 62% in March 2021, but has declined 19 percentage points – to 43% – since then.

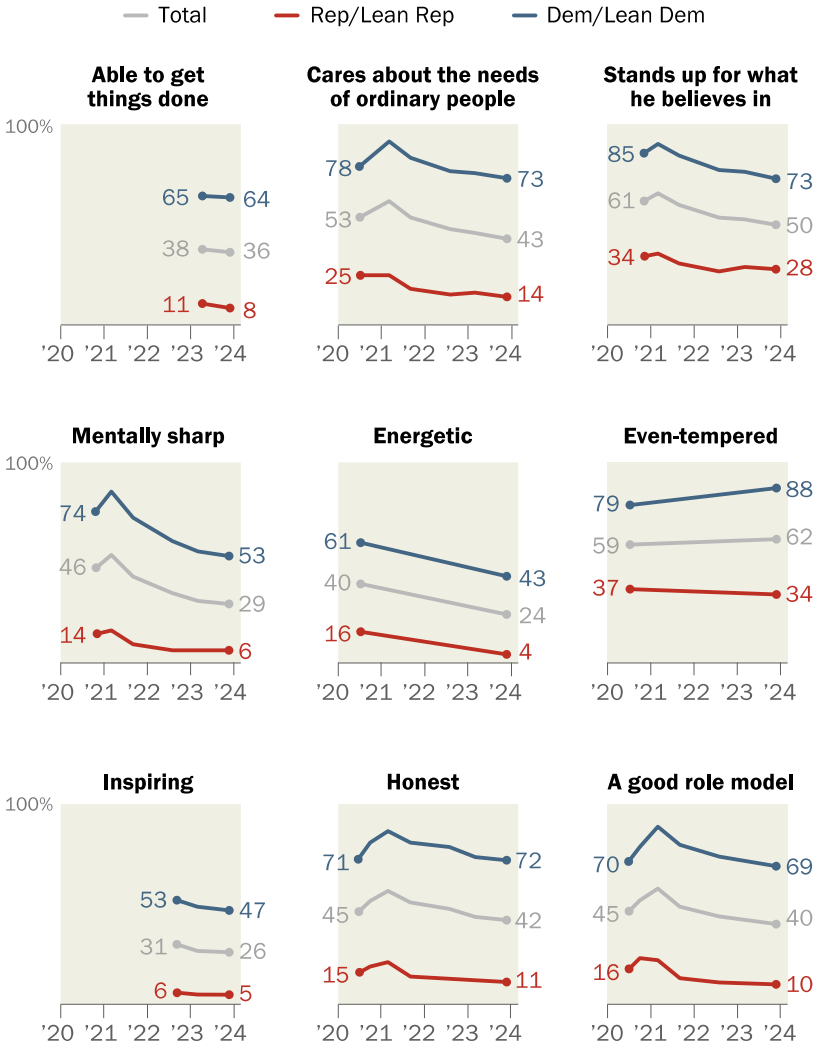
This pattern is evident on other traits as well, including perceptions of whether Biden stands up for his beliefs and whether he is mentally sharp, honest or a good role model.

Evaluations of Biden's energy and temperament were asked only in 2020 and the current survey. Currently, 62% describe him as even-tempered, little different than the 59% who said this in the summer of 2020.

A quarter of Americans now say "energetic" describes Biden

Biden viewed less positively on several personal traits than at earlier points in his term

% who say each of the following describes Joe Biden ***very or fairly well***



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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at least fairly well – a 16-point drop from how the public saw Biden during the 2020 campaign.

The share of Democrats describing Biden as even-tempered is higher today (88%) than in 2020 (79%). On other traits, however, Democrats view Biden less positively than they did four years ago.

In 2020, about three-quarters of Democrats (74%) described Biden as mentally sharp. That share increased to 86% in March of 2021, early in his presidency. Since then, the share of Democrats describing Biden as mentally sharp has fallen 33 points (to 53%).

There has been less change in Republicans' views of Biden's personal traits, largely because relatively few Republicans held positive views of Biden to begin with. Still, fewer Republicans now say Biden is honest, mentally sharp, a good role model, that he cares about ordinary people, or stands up for his beliefs, than did so in March 2021.

Biden's job approval ratings

Across most demographic groups, Americans are more likely to disapprove than approve of Biden's job performance.

But views of Biden differ by race and ethnicity, age and education:

Race

White Americans disapprove of Biden's performance by a margin of more than 2-1 (68% disapprove, 30% approve). More than half of Hispanic (65%) and Asian (59%) Americans also disapprove.

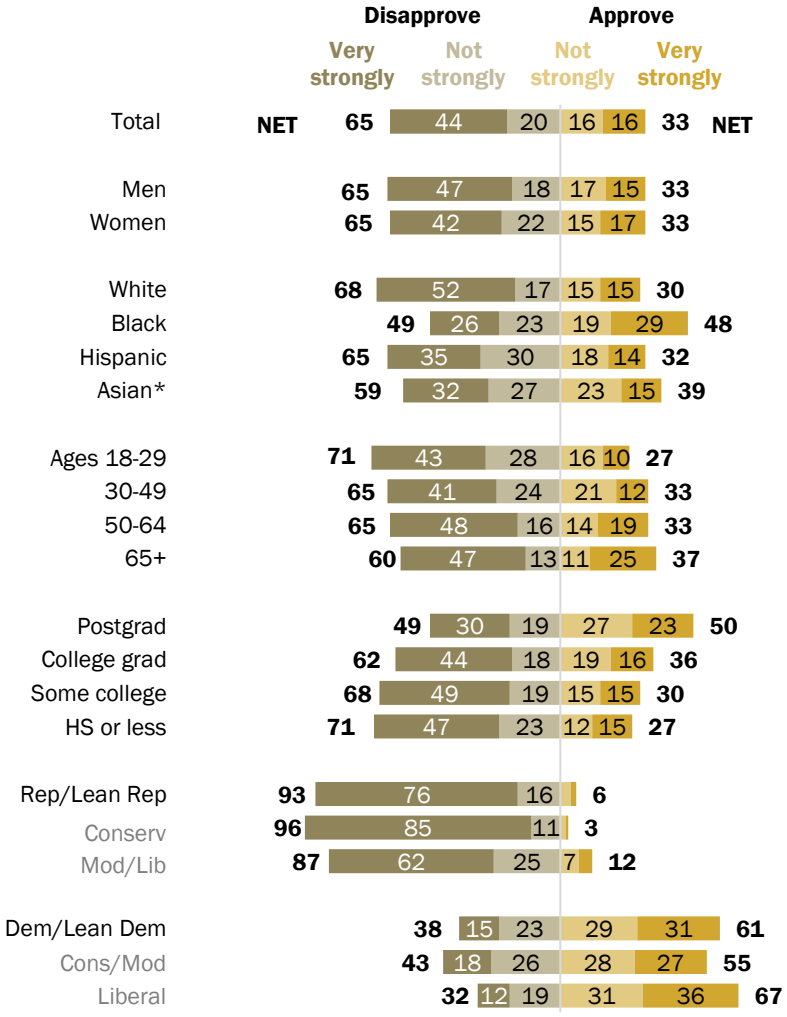
By comparison, Black Americans are about evenly divided in their views (49% disapprove, 48% approve).

Age

While Americans across all age groups are more likely to disapprove than approve of Biden's job performance, older Americans are slightly more likely than younger Americans to approve: 27% of those ages 18 to 29 approve, compared with 37% of those 65 and older.

Biden viewed negatively across most demographic groups

% who say they ___ of the way Joe Biden is handling his job as president



* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.
Notes: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race. No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Education

Approval of Biden is higher among those with more formal education: While half of those with postgraduate degrees approve, only about a quarter (27%) of those with a high school diploma or less education do.

Partisanship

Republicans overwhelmingly disapprove of Biden (93% disapprove). By contrast, a much smaller majority of Democrats (61%) *approve* of his job performance.

Two-thirds of liberal Democrats and 55% of conservative and moderate Democrats approve of Biden's job performance. Among Republicans, 96% of conservative Republicans and 87% of moderate and liberal Republicans disapprove of Biden.

Biden's presidency in the long run

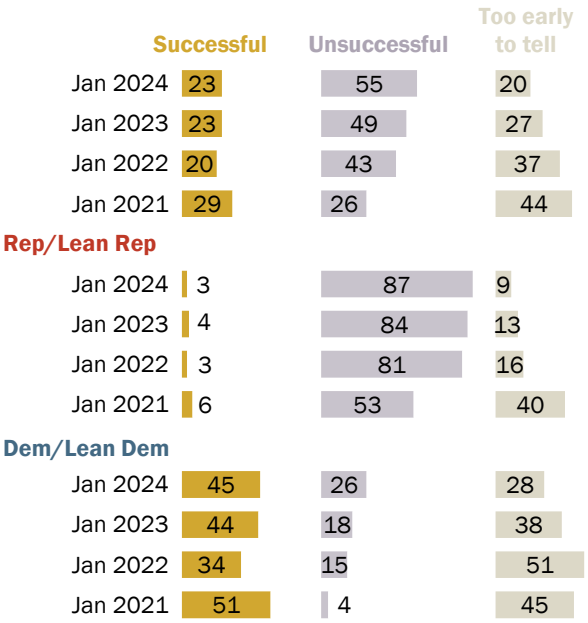
Since he took office in January 2021, the share of Americans who say Biden will be an unsuccessful president in the long run has grown. A narrow majority (55%) now say this (up 6 points from last year), including growing shares of both Republicans and Democrats.

Republicans overwhelmingly think Biden will be an unsuccessful president, with 87% saying this. Just 3% of Republicans say he will be a successful president; 9% say it is too early to tell.

Democrats' views, on balance, are more positive than negative, with 45% saying Biden will be a successful president in the long run. However, the share saying he will be an unsuccessful president has only grown since he first took office, rising 8 points in the last year (26% now say he will be an unsuccessful president, with 28% saying it is still too early to tell).

Will Biden's presidency be successful?

% who say Joe Biden will be a(n) ___ president in the long run



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Acknowledgments

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Methodology

The American Trends Panel survey methodology

Overview

The American Trends Panel (ATP), created by Pew Research Center, is a nationally representative panel of randomly selected U.S. adults. Panelists participate via self-administered web surveys. Panelists who do not have internet access at home are provided with a tablet and wireless internet connection. Interviews are conducted in both English and Spanish. The panel is being managed by Ipsos.

Data in this report is drawn from ATP Wave 140, conducted from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024, and includes an oversample of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men, and Hispanic men in order to provide more precise estimates of the opinions and experiences of these smaller demographic subgroups. These oversampled groups are weighted back to reflect their correct proportions in the population. A total of 5,140 panelists responded out of 5,604 who were sampled, for a response rate of 92%. The cumulative response rate accounting for nonresponse to the recruitment surveys and attrition is 3%. The break-off rate among panelists who logged on to the survey and completed at least one item is less than 1%. The margin of sampling error for the full sample of 5,140 respondents is plus or minus 1.7 percentage points.

Panel recruitment

The ATP was created in 2014, with the first cohort of panelists invited to join the panel at the end of a large, national, landline and cellphone random-digit-dial survey that was conducted in both English and Spanish. Two additional recruitments were conducted using the same method in 2015 and 2017, respectively. Across these three surveys, a total of 19,718 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 9,942 (50%) agreed to participate.

In August 2018, the ATP switched from telephone to address-based sampling (ABS) recruitment. A study cover letter and a pre-incentive are mailed to a stratified, random sample of households selected from the U.S. Postal Service's Delivery Sequence File. This Postal Service file has been estimated to cover as much as 98% of the population, although some studies suggest that the coverage could be in the low 90% range.[1] Within each sampled household, the adult with the next

[1] AAPOR Task Force on Address-based Sampling. 2016. "AAPOR Report: Address-based Sampling."

birthday is asked to participate. Other details of the ABS recruitment protocol have changed over time but are available upon request.[2]

We have recruited a national sample of U.S. adults to the ATP approximately once per year since 2014. In some years, the recruitment has included additional efforts (known as an "oversample") to boost sample size with underrepresented groups. For example, Hispanic adults, Black adults and Asian adults were oversampled in 2019, 2022 and 2023, respectively.

Across the six address-based recruitments, a total of 23,862 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 20,917 agreed to join the panel and completed an initial profile survey. Of the 30,859 individuals who have ever joined the ATP, 11,931 remained active panelists and continued to receive survey invitations at the time this survey was conducted.

American Trends Panel recruitment surveys

Recruitment dates	Mode	Invited	Joined	Active panelists remaining
Jan. 23 to March 16, 2014	Landline/ cell RDD	9,809	5,338	1,393
Aug. 27 to Oct. 4, 2015	Landline/ cell RDD	6,004	2,976	831
April 25 to June 4, 2017	Landline/ cell RDD	3,905	1,628	405
Aug. 8 to Oct. 31, 2018	ABS	9,396	8,778	3,850
Aug. 19 to Nov. 30, 2019	ABS	5,900	4,720	1,388
June 1 to July 19, 2020; Feb. 10 to March 31, 2021	ABS	3,197	2,812	1,441
May 29 to July 7, 2021; Sept. 16 to Nov. 1, 2021	ABS	1,329	1,162	731
May 24 to Sept. 29, 2022	ABS	3,354	2,869	1,457
April 17 to May 30, 2023	ABS	686	576	435
	Total	**43,580**	**30,859**	**11,931**

Note: RDD is random-digit dial; ABS is address-based sampling. Approximately once per year, panelists who have not participated in multiple consecutive waves or who did not complete an annual profiling survey are removed from the panel. Panelists also become inactive if they ask to be removed from the panel.

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The American Trends Panel never uses breakout routers or chains that direct respondents to additional surveys.

Sample design

The overall target population for this survey was noninstitutionalized persons ages 18 and older living in the U.S., including Alaska and Hawaii. It featured a stratified random sample from the ATP in which Hispanic men, non-Hispanic Black men and non-Hispanic Asian adults were selected with certainty. The remaining panelists were sampled at rates designed to ensure that the share of respondents in each stratum is proportional to its share of the U.S. adult population to the

[2] Email pewsurveys@pewresearch.org.

greatest extent possible. Respondent weights are adjusted to account for differential probabilities of selection as described in the Weighting section below.

Questionnaire development and testing

The questionnaire was developed by Pew Research Center in consultation with Ipsos. The web program was rigorously tested on both PC and mobile devices by the Ipsos project management team and Pew Research Center researchers. The Ipsos project management team also populated test data that was analyzed in SPSS to ensure the logic and randomizations were working as intended before launching the survey.

Incentives

All respondents were offered a post-paid incentive for their participation. Respondents could choose to receive the post-paid incentive in the form of a check or a gift code to Amazon.com or could choose to decline the incentive. Incentive amounts ranged from $5 to $20 depending on whether the respondent belongs to a part of the population that is harder or easier to reach. Differential incentive amounts were designed to increase panel survey participation among groups that traditionally have low survey response propensities.

Data collection protocol

The data collection field period for this survey was Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Postcard notifications were mailed to a subset of sampled ATP panelists[3] with a known residential address on Jan. 16.

Invitations were sent out in two separate launches: soft launch and full launch. Sixty panelists were included in the soft launch, which began with an initial invitation sent on Jan. 16. The ATP panelists chosen for the initial soft launch were known responders who had completed previous ATP surveys within one day of receiving their invitation. All remaining English- and Spanish-speaking sampled panelists were included in the full launch and were sent an invitation on Jan. 17.

All panelists with an email address received an email invitation and up to two email reminders if they did not respond to the survey. All ATP panelists who consented to SMS messages received an SMS invitation and up to two SMS reminders.

[3] Postcards notifications are sent to 1) panelists who have been provided with a tablet to take ATP surveys, 2) panelists who were recruited within the last two years, and 3) panelists recruited prior to the last two years who opt to continue receiving postcard notifications.

Invitation and reminder dates, ATP Wave 140

	Soft launch	Full launch
Initial invitation	Jan. 16, 2024	Jan. 17, 2024
First reminder	Jan. 18, 2024	Jan. 18, 2024
Final reminder	Jan. 20 2024	Jan. 20, 2024

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Data quality checks

To ensure high-quality data, the Center's researchers performed data quality checks to identify any respondents showing clear patterns of satisficing. This includes checking for whether respondents left questions blank at very high rates or always selected the first or last answer presented. As a result of this checking, four ATP respondents were removed from the survey dataset prior to weighting and analysis.

Weighting

The ATP data is weighted in a multistep process that accounts for multiple stages of sampling and nonresponse that occur at different points in the survey process. First, each panelist begins with a base weight that reflects their probability of selection for their initial recruitment survey. These weights are then rescaled and adjusted to account for changes in the design of ATP recruitment surveys from year to year. Finally, the weights are calibrated to align with the population benchmarks in the accompanying table to correct for nonresponse to recruitment surveys and panel attrition. If only a subsample of panelists was invited to participate in the wave, this weight is adjusted to account for any differential probabilities of selection.

American Trends Panel weighting dimensions

Variable	Benchmark source
Age (detailed) Age x Gender Education x Gender Education x Age Race/Ethnicity x Education Black (alone or in combination) x Hispanic Born inside vs. outside the U.S. among Hispanics and Asian Americans Years lived in the U.S. Census region x Metropolitan status	2022 American Community Survey (ACS)
Volunteerism	2021 CPS Volunteering & Civic Life Supplement
Voter registration	2022 CPS Voting and Registration Supplement
Party affiliation x Race/Ethnicity Frequency of internet use Religious affiliation	2023 National Public Opinion Reference Survey (NPORS)

Note: Estimates from the ACS are based on noninstitutionalized adults. Voter registration is calculated using procedures from Hur, Achen (2013) and rescaled to include the total U.S. adult population.

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Among the panelists who completed the survey, this weight is then calibrated again to align with the population benchmarks identified in the accompanying table and trimmed at the 2nd and 98th percentiles to reduce the loss in precision stemming from variance in the weights. This trimming is performed separately among non-Hispanic Black, non-Hispanic Asian, Hispanic and all other respondents. Sampling errors and tests of statistical significance take into account the effect of weighting.

The following table shows the unweighted sample sizes and the error attributable to sampling that would be expected at the 95% level of confidence for different groups in the survey.

Sample sizes and margins of error, ATP Wave 140

Group	Unweighted sample size	Weighted %	Plus or minus ...
Total sample	5,140		1.7 percentage points
Half form	At least 2,569		2.5 percentage points
Rep/Lean Rep	2,210	45	2.5 percentage points
Half form	At least 1,088		3.6 percentage points
Dem/Lean Dem	2,710	47	2.4 percentage points
Half form	At least 1,352		3.5 percentage points

Note: This survey includes oversamples of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men, and Hispanic men. Unweighted sample sizes do not account for the sample design or weighting and do not describe a group's contribution to weighted estimates. Refer to the Sample design and Weighting sections above for details.

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Sample sizes and sampling errors for other subgroups are available upon request. In addition to sampling error, one should bear in mind that question wording and practical difficulties in conducting surveys can introduce error or bias into the findings of opinion polls.

Dispositions and response rates

Final dispositions, ATP Wave 140

	AAPOR code	Total
Completed interview	1.1	5,140
Logged on to survey; broke off	2.12	23
Logged on to survey; did not complete any items	2.1121	49
Never logged on (implicit refusal)	2.11	387
Survey completed after close of the field period	2.27	1
Completed interview but was removed for data quality	2.3	4
Screened out	4.7	0
Total panelists sampled for the survey		**5,604**
Completed interviews	I	5,140
Partial interviews	P	0
Refusals	R	459
Non-contact	NC	1
Other	O	4
Unknown household	UH	0
Unknown other	UO	0
Not eligible	NE	0
Total		**5,604**
AAPOR RR1 = I / (I+P+R+NC+O+UH+UO)		92%

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Cumulative response rate as of ATP Wave 140

	Total
Weighted response rate to recruitment surveys	11%
% of recruitment survey respondents who agreed to join the panel, among those invited	71%
% of those agreeing to join who were active panelists at start of Wave 140	46%
Response rate to Wave 140 survey	92%
Cumulative response rate	**3%**

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How family income tiers are calculated

Family income data reported in this study is adjusted for household size and cost-of-living differences by geography. Panelists then are assigned to income tiers that are based on the median adjusted family income of all American Trends Panel members. The process uses the following steps:

1. First, panelists are assigned to the midpoint of the income range they selected in a family income question that was measured on either the most recent annual profile survey or, for newly recruited panelists, their recruitment survey. This provides an approximate income value that can be used in calculations for the adjustment.

2. Next, these income values are adjusted for the cost of living in the geographic area where the panelist lives. This is calculated using price indexes published by the U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis. These indexes, known as Regional Price Parities (RPP), compare the prices of goods and services across all U.S. metropolitan statistical areas as well as non-metro areas with the national average prices for the same goods and services. The most recent available data at the time of the annual profile survey is from 2021. Those who fall outside of metropolitan statistical areas are assigned the overall RPP for their state's non-metropolitan area.

3. Family incomes are further adjusted for the number of people in a household using the methodology from Pew Research Center's previous work on the American middle class. This is done because a four-person household with an income of say, $50,000, faces a tighter budget constraint than a two-person household with the same income.

4. Panelists are then assigned an income tier. "Middle-income" adults are in families with adjusted family incomes that are between two-thirds and double the median adjusted family income for the full ATP at the time of the most recent annual profile survey. The median adjusted family income for the panel is roughly $71,800. Using this median income, the middle-income range is about $47,900 to $143,600. Lower-income families have adjusted incomes less than $47,900 and upper-income families have adjusted incomes greater than $143,600 (all figures expressed in 2022 dollars and scaled to a household size of three). If a panelist did not provide their income and/or their household size, they are assigned "no answer" in the income tier variable.

Two examples of how a given area's cost-of-living adjustment was calculated are as follows: the Anniston-Oxford metropolitan area in Alabama is a relatively inexpensive area, with a price level that is 16.2% less than the national average. The San Francisco-Oakland-Berkeley metropolitan

area in California is one of the most expensive areas, with a price level that is 19.8% higher than the national average. Income in the sample is adjusted to make up for this difference. As a result, a family with an income of $41,900 in the Anniston-Oxford area is as well off financially as a family of the same size with an income of $59,900 in San Francisco.

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2024 PEW RESEARCH CENTER'S AMERICAN TRENDS PANEL
WAVE 140 JANUARY 2024

FINAL TOPLINE
JANUARY 16–21, 2024
N=5,140

ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]:
SATIS All in all, are you satisfied or dissatisfied with the way things are going in this country today?

	Satisfied	Dissatisfied	No answer
Jan 16-21, 2024	21	78	1
Nov 27-Dec 3, 2023	22	77	1
Jul 10-16, 2023	22	77	1
Jun 5-11, 2023	21	78	1
Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	19	80	1
Jan 18-24, 2023	22	78	*
Nov 16-27, 2022	24	75	1
Oct 10-16, 2022	21	79	1
Aug 1-14, 2022	18	81	1
Apr 25-May 1, 2022	24	75	1
Jan 10-17, 2022	21	78	1
Sep 20-26, 2021	25	74	1
Sep 13-19, 2021	26	74	*
Mar 1-7, 2021	33	66	1
Nov 12-17, 2020	22	77	1
Sep 30-Oct 5, 2020	18	82	1
Jul 27-Aug 2, 2020	12	87	1
Jun 16-22, 2020	12	87	1
Apr 7-12, 2020	31	68	1
Mar 19-24, 2020	33	66	1
Oct 29-Nov 11, 2019	31	69	1
Oct 1-13, 2019	28	71	1
Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019	27	72	1
Nov 27-Dec 10, 2018	34	65	1
Jan 29-Feb 13, 2018	36	63	1
Feb 28-Mar 12, 2017[4]	32	68	0
Sep 27-Oct 10, 2016	23	75	2
Jun 7-Jul 5, 2016	19	80	1
Sep 15-Oct 3, 2014	25	75	0

ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]:
YEARAHEAD Looking ahead, as far as you are concerned, do you think that 2024 will be … **[RANDOMIZE]**

	Better than 2023	Worse than 2023	No answer
Jan 16-21, 2024	55	45	1
Jan 18-24, 2023	57	43	*
Jan 10-17, 2022	61	38	1
Jan 8-12, 2021	67	32	1
Jan 6-19, 2020	55	43	2

[4] The W24.5 Mode Study survey was administered by web and phone. Results reported here are from web mode only.

YEARAHEAD PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON:
Looking ahead, as far as you are concerned, do you think that [coming year] will be better or worse than [prior year]?

	Better	Worse	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Jan 8-13, 2020	55	34	11
Jan 9-14, 2019	47	43	10
Jan 10-15, 2018	61	29	11
Jan 4-9, 2017	49	42	9
Jan 7-14, 2016	56	30	14
Dec 3-7, 2014 (U)	49	42	9
Jan 15-19, 2014	56	35	9
Dec 5-9, 2012	55	36	9
Jan 11-16, 2012	57	29	14
Dec 1-5, 2010	55	31	14
Jan 6-10, 2010	67	26	8
Jan 7-11, 2009	52	37	11
Dec, 2007	50	34	16
Dec, 2006	57	28	15
Dec, 1999	66	19	15
Dec, 1998	59	25	16
Dec, 1994	59	28	13
Gallup: Dec, 1993	64	20	16
Gallup: Dec, 1992	61	11	28
Gallup: Dec, 1991	61	31	8
Gallup: Dec, 1990	48	42	10
Gallup: Dec, 1986	53	25	22
Gallup: Dec, 1985	64	20	17
Gallup: Dec, 1984	61	20	19
Gallup: Dec, 1982	50	32	18
Gallup: Dec, 1981	41	44	15

ASK ALL:
POL1JB Do you approve or disapprove of the way Joe Biden is handling his job as president?
ASK IF POL1JB=1,2:
POL1JBSTR Do you **[IF POL1JB=1:** approve**; IF POL1JB=2:** disapprove**]** of the way Joe Biden is handling his job as president…

	NET Approve	*Very strongly*	*Not so strongly*	*No answer*	**NET Disapprove**	*Very strongly*	*Not so strongly*	*No answer*	No answer
Jan 16-21, 2024	**33**	*16*	*16*	*	**65**	*44*	*20*	*	1
Nov 27-Dec 3, 2023	**33**	*17*	*16*	*	**64**	*44*	*19*	*1*	1
Jun 5-11, 2023	**35**	*17*	*17*	*1*	**62**	*41*	*20*	*	3
Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	**37**	*18*	*18*	*	**60**	*41*	*19*	*1*	3
Jan 18-24, 2023	**38**	*18*	*19*	*1*	**60**	*41*	*18*	*	3
Oct 10-16, 2022	**38**	*19*	*19*	*1*	**59**	*40*	*18*	*1*	3
Aug 1-14, 2022	**37**	*17*	*19*	*1*	**60**	*39*	*20*	*	3
Jun 27-Jul 4, 2022	**37**	*18*	*18*	*1*	**62**	*45*	*16*	*1*	2
Mar 7-13, 2022	**43**	*n/a*	*n/a*	*n/a*	**55**	*n/a*	*n/a*	*n/a*	2
Jan 10-17, 2022	**41**	*21*	*19*	*1*	**56**	*39*	*18*	*	3
Sep 13-19, 2021	**44**	*27*	*17*	*	**53**	*38*	*15*	*1*	3
Jul 8-18, 2021	**55**	*n/a*	*n/a*	*n/a*	**43**	*n/a*	*n/a*	*n/a*	2
Apr 5-11, 2021	**59**	*n/a*	*n/a*	*n/a*	**39**	*n/a*	*n/a*	*n/a*	2

POL1JB/POL1JBSTR CONTINUED…	NET Approve	*Very strongly*	*Not so strongly*	*No answer*	NET Disapprove	*Very strongly*	*Not so strongly*	*No answer*	No answer
Mar 1-7, 2021	**54**	*38*	*15*	*1*	**42**	*29*	*12*	*1*	4

See past presidents' approval trends: Donald Trump, Barack Obama, George W. Bush, Bill Clinton

ASK ALL:

JBSUCCESS In the long run, do you think Joe Biden will be… **[RANDOMIZE 1 AND 2 WITH OPTION 3 ALWAYS LAST]**

Jan 16-21, 2024		Jan 18-24, 2023	Jan 10-17, 2022	Jan 8-12, 2021
23	A successful president	23	20	29
55	An unsuccessful president	49	43	26
20	Too early to tell	27	37	44
1	No answer	1	1	1

TREND FOR COMPARISON:

In the long run, do you think Donald Trump will be…

	Jan 6-19, 2020
A successful president	34
An unsuccessful president	48
Too early to tell	18
No answer	1

PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON

In the long run, do you think Donald Trump will be a successful or unsuccessful president, or do you think it is too early to tell?

	Successful	Unsuccessful	Too early to tell	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
Trump				
Jan 8-13, 2020	36	37	26	1
Jan 9-14, 2019	29	47	23	1
Jan 10-15, 2018	23	41	34	1
Jan 4-9, 2017	21	20	58	1
Obama				
Jan 7-14, 2016	37	34	26	3
Jan 7-11, 2015	32	38	29	2
Jan 15-19, 2014	28	34	35	3
Jun 12-16, 2013	34	31	33	2
Jan 9-13, 2013	33	26	39	2
Jan 11-16, 2012	27	32	39	2
Jan 5-9, 2011	25	26	47	2
Jan 6-10, 2010	24	21	52	3
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	27	18	54	2
Jan 7-11, 2009	30	4	65	1
Bush				
Jan, 2007	24	45	27	4
Jan, 2006	27	37	32	4

PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON CONTINUED

	Successful	Unsuccessful	Too early to tell	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Early Oct, 2005	26	41	30	3
Jan, 2005	36	27	35	2
Dec, 2003	39	20	38	3
Early Oct, 2002	40	15	44	1
Jan, 2001	26	15	58	1
Clinton				
Jan, 1999	44	24	29	3
Early Sep, 1998	38	24	35	3
Feb, 1995	18	34	43	5
Oct, 1994	14	35	48	3
May, 1994	21	26	52	1
Jan, 1994	21	19	57	3
Oct, 1993	18	25	56	1

ASK ALL:

BIDENDESC How well does each of the following describe Joe Biden? **[RANDOMIZE ITEMS]**

		Very well	Fairly well	Not too well	Not at all well	No answer
ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]:						
ORD	Cares about the needs of ordinary people					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	18	26	23	33	1
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	18	28	21	33	1
	Aug 1-14, 2022	20	28	20	31	1
	Sep 13-19, 2021	24	29	19	27	1
	Mar 1-7, 2021	32	30	15	23	*
	Jun 16-22, 2020	20	33	22	23	2
MENT	Mentally sharp					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	7	22	26	44	1
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	7	24	24	44	1
	Aug 1-14, 2022	9	26	23	41	1
	Sep 13-19, 2021	14	30	21	35	1
	Mar 1-7, 2021	20	34	17	29	*
	Sep 30-Oct 5, 2020	13	33	22	31	1
STND	Stands up for what he believes in					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	19	31	25	24	1
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	18	35	23	22	1
	Aug 1-14, 2022	20	34	23	21	2
	Sep 13-19, 2021	28	33	19	20	1
	Mar 1-7, 2021	32	34	17	16	1
	Sep 30-Oct 5, 2020	26	35	21	16	2
HON	Honest					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	15	27	24	33	1
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	14	30	21	34	1
	Aug 1-14, 2022	18	30	21	30	2
	Sep 13-19, 2021	20	30	21	28	1

BIDENDESC CONTINUED…		Very well	Fairly well	Not too well	Not at all well	No answer
	Mar 1-7, 2021	25	32	20	23	1
	Sep 30-Oct 5, 2020	20	32	23	24	2
	Jun 16-22, 2020	13	33	25	28	2
	Feb 4-15, 2020	12	24	19	44	1
INSP	Inspiring					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	7	19	30	43	1
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	8	19	30	41	2
	Aug 1-14, 2022	9	22	28	40	1
ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]:						
GETDN	Able to get things done					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	9	27	30	33	1
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	8	30	31	31	1
ENER	Energetic					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	5	19	28	48	1
	Jun 16-22, 2020	8	33	28	29	2
STRN	Strong leader					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	10	23	26	39	1
MDL	A good role model					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	15	25	24	35	1
	Aug 1-14, 2022	17	28	22	33	1
	Sep 13-19, 2021	21	27	20	31	1
	Mar 1-7, 2021	29	29	18	23	1
	Sep 30-Oct 5, 2020	22	30	23	23	2
	Jun 16-22, 2020	14	31	24	28	2
TEMP	Even-tempered					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	22	40	18	20	1
	Jun 16-22, 2020	16	43	20	18	2

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

[ASK FORM 1 (XFORM=1) PRESWITHOP FIRST AND OPWITHPRES SECOND ON SEPARATE SCREENS; ASK FORM 2 (XFORM=2) OPWITHPRES FIRST AND PRESWITHOP SECOND ON SEPARATE SCREENS]

ASK FORM 1 [N=2,569]:
PRESWITHOP This year, do you think Joe Biden should... **[RANDOMIZE]**

Jan 16-21 2024		Jan 18-24, 2023	Jan 10-17, 2022	Jan 8-12, 2021[5]
74	Try as best he can to work with Republican congressional leaders to accomplish things, even if it means disappointing some people who voted for him	73	67	74
24	Stand up to Republican congressional leaders on issues that are important to the people who voted for him, even if it means it's harder to address critical problems facing the country	25	29	23
2	No answer	2	4	3

ASK FORM 2 [N=2,571]:
OPWITHPRES This year, do you think Republican congressional leaders should... **[RANDOMIZE]**

Jan 16-21 2024		Jan 18-24, 2023	Jan 10-17, 2022	Jan 8-12, 2021
60	Try as best they can to work with Joe Biden to accomplish things, even if it means disappointing some Republican voters	63	61	66
37	Stand up to Joe Biden on issues that are important to Republican voters, even if it means it's harder to address critical problems facing the country	35	37	31
3	No answer	2	2	3

ASK ALL:
ECON1 Thinking about the nation's economy…

How would you rate economic conditions in this country today?

	Excellent	Good	Only fair	Poor	No answer
Jan 16-21, 2024	3	25	41	31	*
Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	1	18	46	35	1
Jan 18-24, 2023	1	20	47	32	*
Oct 10-16, 2022	2	16	46	36	*
Jun 27-Jul 4, 2022	1	12	38	49	*
Jan 10-17, 2022	2	25	47	24	1
Sep 13-19, 2021	2	24	50	24	*
Apr 20-29, 2021	2	35	49	14	*
Mar 1-7, 2021	2	21	53	24	*
Nov 12-17, 2020	5	31	44	20	*
Sep 30-Oct 5, 2020	4	29	42	25	*
Jun 16-22, 2020	4	22	44	30	1
Apr 7-12, 2020	4	19	38	38	1
Jan 6-19, 2020	16	42	33	9	*
Sep 16-29, 2019	10	46	35	8	*
Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019	14	43	32	11	*

[5] In January 2021, second response option was worded as "… on issues that are important to his supporters …"

ECON1 TREND CONTINUED…	Excellent	Good	Only fair	Poor	No answer
Nov 7-16, 2018	13	46	31	9	1
Sep 24-Oct 7, 2018	12	45	32	11	*
Feb 28-Mar 12, 2017	2	37	43	17	0
Oct 25-Nov 8, 2016	2	30	47	21	*
Apr 29-May 27, 2014	1	18	50	30	1

ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]

ECON1B A year from now, do you expect that economic conditions in the country as a whole will be…

	Better	Worse	About the same as now	No answer
Jan 16-21, 2024	26	33	41	1
March 27-Apr 2, 2023	17	46	36	*
Jan 18-24, 2023	23	40	36	1
Oct 10-16, 2022	23	41	35	1
Jun 27-Jul 4, 2022	22	47	30	1
Jan 10-17, 2022	27	35	37	1
Sep 13-19, 2021	29	37	34	1
Apr 20-29, 2021	45	28	27	1
Mar 1-7, 2021	44	31	24	*
Nov 12-17, 2020	42	32	24	2
Sep 30-Oct 5, 2020	52	17	30	1
Jun 16-22. 2020	50	22	27	1
Apr 7-12, 2020	55	22	22	1
Jan 6-19, 2020	29	26	45	1
Sep 16-29, 2019	20	32	48	*
Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019	28	28	44	*

ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]
ECONOE In a few words, what are the main reasons why you think economic conditions in the country are **[IF ECON1=1:** excellent**; IF ECON1=2** good**; IF ECON1=3:** only fair**; IF ECON1=4:** poor**]**?[6]

BASED ON THOSE WHO SAID EXCELLENT OR GOOD (ECON1=1,2) [N=796]
Jan 16-21,
2024

43	Low unemployment
18	Inflation is down
10	Wage growth
9	Positive mentions of the stock market
5	U.S. is outperforming expectations
4	General mentions of economic growth or improvement
3	Lower gas prices
2	Positive mentions of Biden or Democratic policies
4	Other positive responses
2	Other neutral responses
10	NET Negative responses
33	No answer

Total exceeds 100% because of multiple responses

BASED ON THOSE WHO SAID ONLY FAIR OR POOR (ECON1=3,4) [N=1,763]
Jan 16-21,
2024

28	High Inflation
21	High cost of living
15	Lack of good paying jobs / wages low
7	National debt / Government spending
6	High cost of food and groceries
6	High cost of housing
6	Negative mentions of Biden or Democratic policies
6	High interest rates
5	Illegal immigration
5	Wealth inequality
4	High gas prices
3	Corporations or Corporate greed
3	Specific mentions of poverty or homelessness
2	Mentions of layoffs, people losing their jobs
1	High taxes
1	Negative mentions of politicians
1	People are lazy / don't want to work
3	Other negative responses
0	Other neutral responses
1	NET Positive responses
24	No answer

Total exceeds 100% because of multiple responses

[6] Responses that were offered by less than 1% of respondents are not shown.

ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]

ECONCONC How concerned, if at all, are you personally about each of the following economic issues in the country today? **[RANDOMIZE ITEMS]**

		Very concerned	Somewhat concerned	Not too concerned	Not at all concerned	No answer
PRICE	The price of food and consumer goods					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	72	21	5	1	*
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	72	22	4	1	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	75	20	4	1	*
	Oct 10-16, 2022	73	22	4	1	*
	TREND FOR COMPARISON:					
	Rising prices for food and consumer goods					
	Jun 27-Jul 4, 2022	75	21	3	1	*
	Sep 13-19, 2021	63	30	6	1	*
UNEM	People who want to work being unable to find jobs					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	31	35	25	8	*
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	27	34	27	11	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	30	34	26	10	*
	Oct 10-16, 2022	29	31	28	11	1
	Jun 27-Jul 4, 2022	27	32	28	12	1
	Sep 13-19, 2021	29	32	23	15	*
REAL	The cost of housing					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	64	25	9	1	1
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	61	27	9	2	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	60	27	10	2	*
	Oct 10-16, 2022	60	27	10	3	*
	Jun 27-Jul 4, 2022	60	27	10	3	*
STCK	How the stock market is doing					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	18	38	32	11	1
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	24	41	25	10	1
	Jan 18-24, 2023	26	38	26	9	1
	Oct 10-16, 2022	32	37	21	9	1
	Jun 27-Jul 4, 2022	31	36	22	10	1
ENG2	The price of gasoline and energy					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	51	34	13	2	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	60	30	8	1	*
	Oct 10-16, 2022	69	24	6	1	*

ECONCONC CONTINUED…		Very concerned	Somewhat concerned	Not too concerned	Not at all concerned	No answer
	TREND FOR COMPARISON					
	Rising prices for gasoline and energy					
	Jun 27-Jul 4, 2022	75	19	4	2	*
BANK	The stability of banks and financial institutions					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	27	43	25	4	1
	Mar 27-Apr 2, 2023	36	43	17	4	*

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

ASK ALL:

IMPEACHFOLL_JB As you may know, the House of Representatives has begun an impeachment inquiry into Joe Biden's conduct and his possible connections to his son Hunter's business dealings.

How closely have you been following news about the impeachment inquiry?
[RANDOMIZE ORDER OF RESPONSES 1-5 and 5-1]

Jan 16-21, 2024	
6	Extremely closely
10	Very closely
28	Somewhat closely
28	Not too closely
28	Not at all closely

ASK ALL:

IMPEACHAPP_JB Do you approve or disapprove of the House of Representatives' decision to conduct an impeachment inquiry into Joe Biden?

	----------**Approve--**---------			----------**Disapprove---------**			
	NET	*Strongly*	*Somewhat*	**NET**	*Strongly*	*Somewhat*	No answer
Jan 16-21, 2024	**52**	*30*	*22*	**45**	*26*	*19*	3

TREND FOR COMPARISON

IMPEACHAPP Do you approve or disapprove of the House of Representatives' decision to conduct an impeachment inquiry into Donald Trump?

	Oct 1-13 2019
Approve	54
Disapprove	44
No answer	1

ASK ALL:

IMPEACHREM_JB Regardless of your view of the House of Representatives' decision to conduct an inquiry…

Do you think Joe Biden has done things that are grounds for his impeachment?

	----------Has----------			----------Has not---------			
	NET	*Definitely*	*Probably*	**NET**	*Definitely*	*Probably*	No answer
Jan 16-21, 2024	**52**	*28*	*24*	**46**	*21*	*25*	2

TREND FOR COMPARISON

IMPEACHREM Regardless of your view of the House of Representatives' decision to conduct an inquiry…

Do you think Donald Trump has done things that are grounds for his impeachment?

	Oct 1-13 2019
Definitely	40
Probably	19
Probably not	19
Definitely not	22
No answer	1

ASK ALL:

PARTY In politics today, do you consider yourself a:

ASK IF INDEP/SOMETHING ELSE (PARTY=3 or 4) OR MISSING:

PARTYLN As of today do you lean more to…[7]

Republican	Democrat	Independent	Something else	No answer	*Lean Rep*	*Lean Dem*
28	29	27	13	3	17	18

Key to Pew Research trends noted in the topline:

(U) Pew Research Center/USA Today polls

[7] PARTY and PARTYLN asked in a prior survey.

Pew Research Center

FOR RELEASE FEBRUARY 1, 2024

From Businesses and Banks to Colleges and Churches: Americans' Views of U.S. Institutions

Continued partisan divides on schools, unions, churches

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About Pew Research Center

Pew Research Center is a nonpartisan, nonadvocacy fact tank that informs the public about the issues, attitudes and trends shaping the world. It does not take policy positions. The Center conducts public opinion polling, demographic research, computational social science research and other data-driven research. It studies politics and policy; news habits and media; the internet and technology; religion; race and ethnicity; international affairs; social, demographic and economic trends; science; research methodology and data science; and immigration and migration. Pew Research Center is a subsidiary of The Pew Charitable Trusts, its primary funder.

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How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to examine Americans' views of different national institutions. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 U.S. adults from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this report, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

From Businesses and Banks to Colleges and Churches: Americans' Views of U.S. Institutions

Continued partisan divides on schools, unions, churches

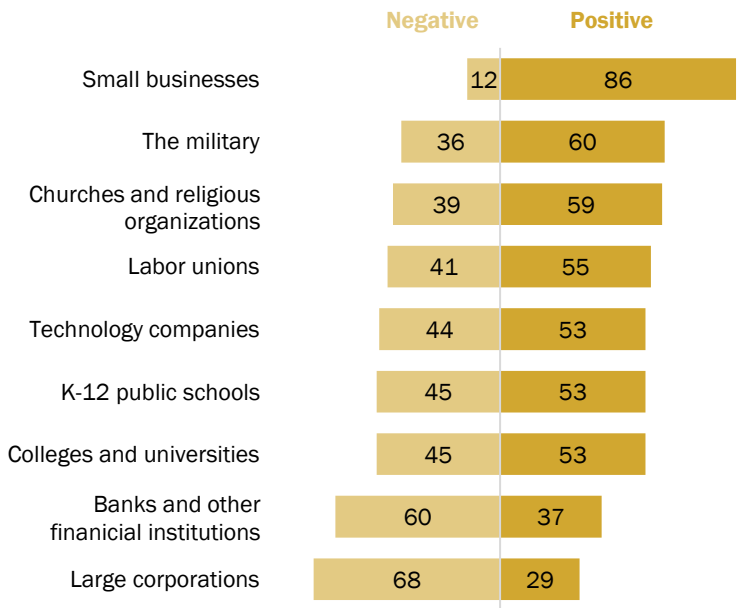
Americans overwhelmingly see small businesses as having a positive effect on the way things are going in the country.

By contrast, their views of large corporations are broadly negative. Most people – including identical shares in both parties – also are critical of the impact of banks and financial institutions.

A new national survey conducted by Pew Research Center from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21 among 5,140 adults also finds:

Most Americans say small businesses have a positive impact; large corporations, banks viewed negatively

% who say each of the following has a ____ effect on the way things are going in the country these days



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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The **U.S. military** is viewed positively by 60% of Americans, and these views are similar across most demographic and political groups.

There are wide partisan divides on the impact of **educational institutions**, both K-12 public schools and colleges and universities:

- About three-quarters of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents view **colleges and universities** positively, but only about three-in-ten Republicans and Republican leaners give these institutions positive marks. The partisan divide on **K-12 public schools** is about as wide.

Churches and religious organizations are viewed positively by about six-in-ten Americans, but there are sizable differences in these views between Republicans and Democrats, as well as between the religiously affiliated and the religiously unaffiliated:

- Nearly three-quarters of Republicans (73%) say churches and religious institutions have a positive impact. Democrats' opinions are more divided: 45% say their effect is positive, 53% say it is negative.

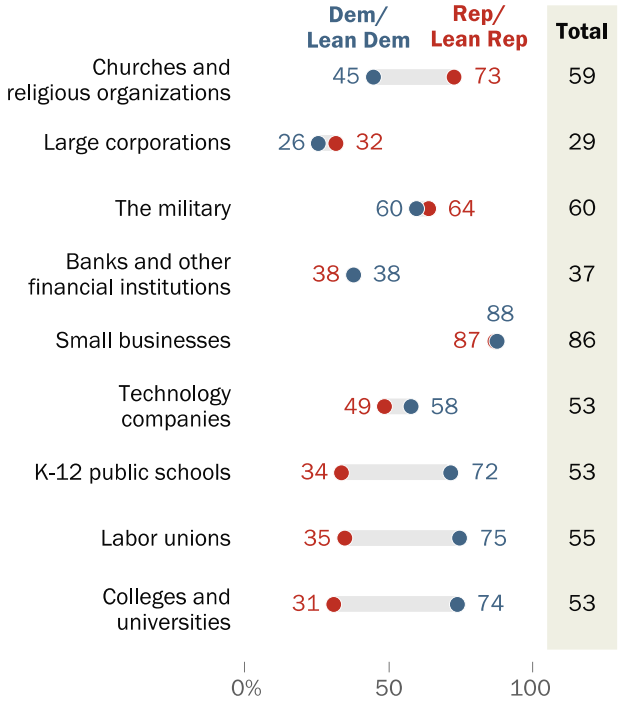
- And while religiously affiliated Americans generally rate the impact of organized religion positively, the views of unaffiliated Americans are more negative.

Views of the effect of **labor unions** also differ considerably by party:

- Three-quarters of Democrats, compared with just 35% of Republicans, say unions have a positive impact on how things are going in the United States these days.

Wide partisan differences in views of churches, schools and labor unions

*% who say each of the following has a **positive** effect on the way things are going in the country these days*



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Explore more detailed looks at demographic and political differences in Americans' views of the impact of each of these institutions:

- **Educational institutions:** Colleges and universities, K-12 public schools
- **Business:** Small and large businesses, banks, and technology companies
- **Labor unions**
- **Churches and religious organizations**
- **The U.S. military**

1. Colleges and universities, K-12 public schools

Americans' views of whether educational institutions are having a positive or negative impact on the country are essentially unchanged since late 2022. About half (53%) say colleges and universities are having a positive impact, while 45% say they're having a negative impact.

Views of the impact of K-12 public schools are identical (53% positive, 45% negative). These also are little changed from 2022, though somewhat less positive than in 2021 (when 61% had a positive opinion).

Partisanship and ideology

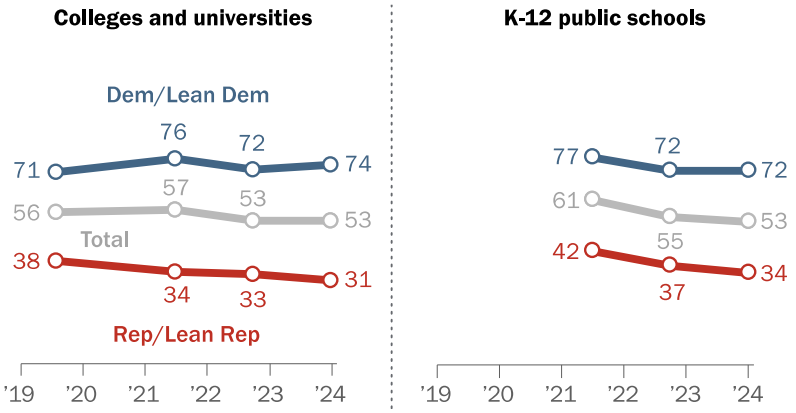
Democrats are about twice as likely as Republicans to view both colleges and K-12 schools positively.

Roughly three-quarters (74%) of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents say colleges have a positive impact – nearly as many (72%) say the same of K-12 public schools.

Only about a third of Republicans and Republican leaners express positive opinions about the impact of colleges (31%) or K-12 public schools (34%).

Democrats about twice as likely as Republicans to have positive views of colleges, K-12 public schools

*% who say each of the following has a **positive** effect on the way things are going in the country these days*



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Age, education

Younger adults and those with more formal education are more likely than older adults and those with less education to view educational institutions positively.

Colleges and universities

- Roughly six-in-ten of those ages 18 to 29 (63%) say that colleges and universities are having a positive impact, compared with 56% of those 30 to 49 and 52% of those 50 to 64.

- Among those ages 65 and older, more say that colleges are having a negative impact (56%) than say they are having a positive impact (40%).

- 59% of those with at least a bachelor's degree view colleges and universities positively, compared with 50% of those without a bachelor's degree.

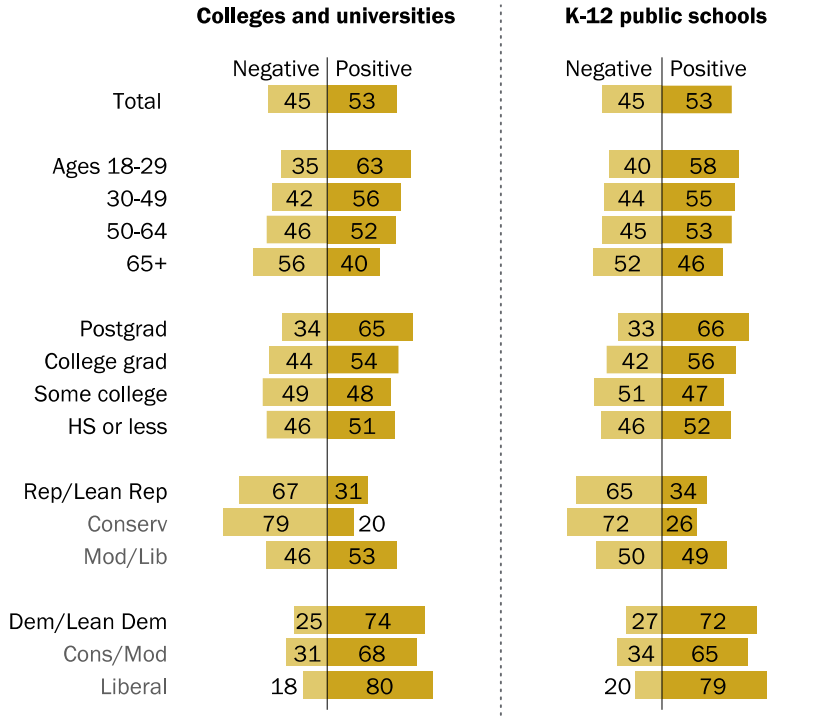
K-12 public schools

- 58% of adults under 30 say that K-12 schools are having a positive impact, as do 54% of adults ages 30 to 64. This drops to 46% among those ages 65 and older.

- Six-in-ten college graduates say that K-12 public schools are having a positive impact, compared with 49% of those without college degrees.

Wide age, educational and ideological gaps in views of colleges and K-12 public schools

% who say each of the following has a ____ effect on the way things are going in the country these days



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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2. Small and large businesses, banks, and technology companies

Small businesses

Americans' views of small businesses have become more positive over the past year: 86% now say that small businesses are having a positive effect on the way things are going in the country these days, up from 80% in October 2022.

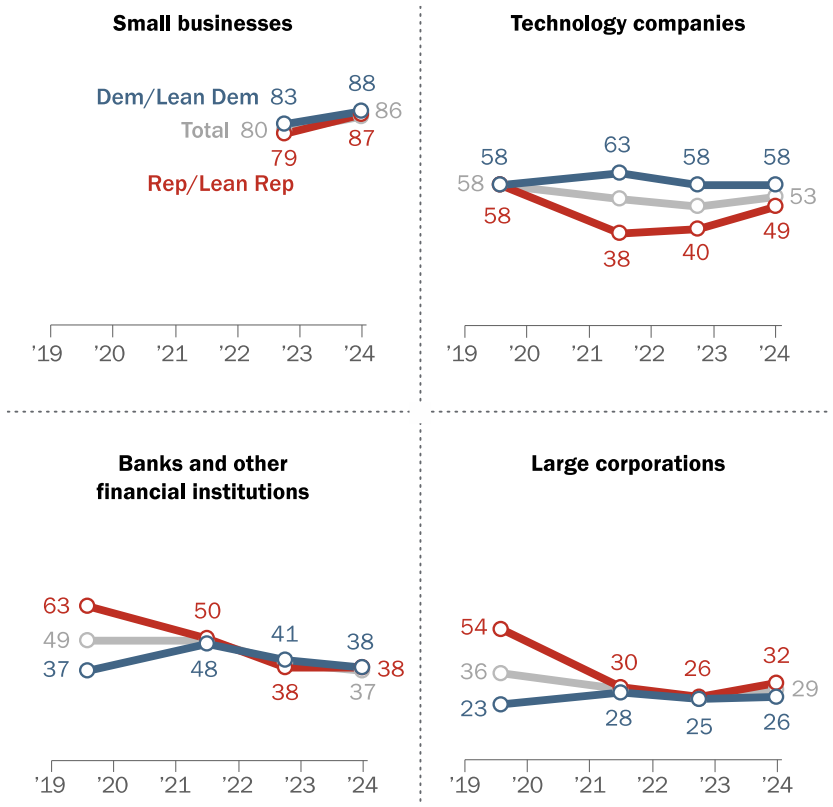
Overwhelming majorities of both Democrats (88%) and Republicans (87%) view small businesses positively.

Large corporations, banks and financial institutions

Members of both partisan coalitions also have nearly identical – and mostly negative – opinions of banks and financial institutions and large corporations.

Modest partisan differences in views of big businesses and technology companies

*% who say each of the following has a **positive** effect on the way things are going in the country these days*



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Just 38% each among Republicans and Democrats view banks positively. Republicans have become notably less positive toward banks in recent years; in 2019, a 63% majority of Republicans had a positive opinion of how banks affected the country. Democrats' attitudes are mostly unchanged over this period.

Republicans and Democrats have similarly negative opinions of large corporations – just 32% of Republicans and 26% of Democrats view their impact positively. As is the case with banks,

Republicans are less positive toward large corporations than they were five years ago (54% in 2019).

Technology companies

Democrats are somewhat more positive than Republicans toward technology companies (58% vs. 49%). While Democrats' opinions are little changed over the past five years, Republicans' views turned less positive between 2019 and 2021, declining 20 percentage points (from 58% to 38%). Republicans have become more positive since then.

3. Labor unions

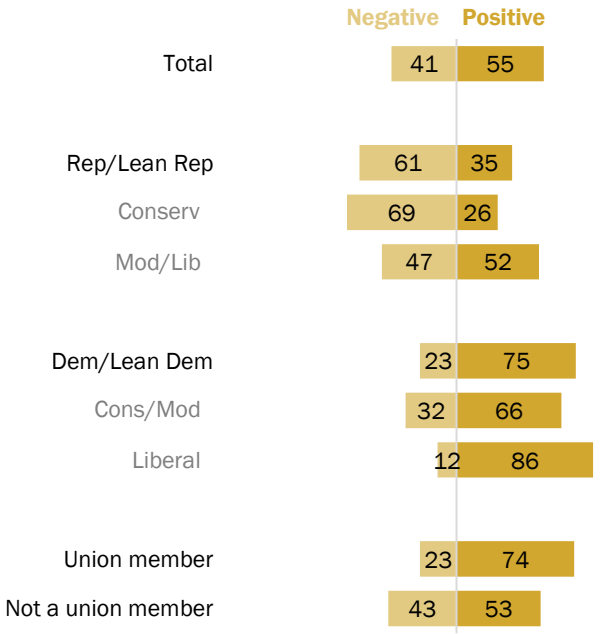
There are sharp partisan divisions in views of labor unions. Overall, 55% of Americans say labor unions positively affect the country, while 41% say they have a negative impact. These views are little changed in recent years.

By roughly three-to-one (75% positive to 23% negative), Democrats have a positive view of labor unions. Republicans are about half as likely as Democrats to view unions positively; 35% of Republicans say unions are having a positive impact, compared with 61% who view unions negatively.

Within each party, there are ideological differences in evaluations of labor unions. Liberal Democrats are 20 percentage points more likely than moderate and conservative Democrats to say unions are having a positive effect (86% vs. 66%). And moderate and liberal Republicans are 26 points more likely than conservative Republicans to say this (52% vs. 26%).

Democrats are more than twice as likely as Republicans to say labor unions have a positive impact on the country

*% who say **labor unions** have a ____ effect on the way things are going in the country these days*



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Union members

Union members (74%) are far more likely than those who do not belong to a union (53%) to view labor unions positively.

Last year, a majority of Americans (58%) said the long-term decline in union membership was a bad thing for the country. Union membership has fallen by roughly half over the last four decades. Currently, about one-in-ten adults (11%) report being members of a union.

4. Churches and religious organizations

Opinions about churches and religious organizations have become somewhat more positive in recent years (59% today vs. 53% in late 2022).

Religious affiliation

Large majorities of Protestants and Catholics say that churches and religious organizations are having a positive effect on the country today, though White evangelical Protestants are particularly likely to say this.

Eight-in-ten White evangelical Protestants view churches positively, compared with 73% of historically Black Protestants, 67% of Catholics and 64% of White non-evangelicals.

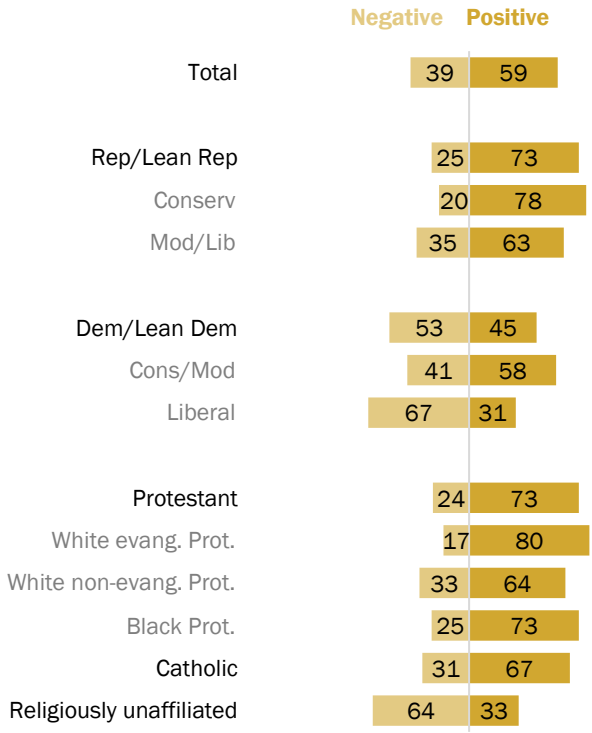
Those who give their religion as atheist, agnostic or "nothing in particular" are much less likely to say that churches and religious organizations are having a positive effect, with just one-third saying this.

Partisanship, ideology

A majority of conservative and moderate Democrats (58%) have a positive impression of the impact of churches, compared with just 31% of liberal Democrats.

Wide ideological gap over the impact of churches, religious orgs on the country

*% who say **churches and religious organizations** have a ____ effect on the way things are going in the country these days*



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Differences are more modest among Republicans: 78% of conservative Republicans say churches and religious organizations have a positive impact, as do 63% of moderate and liberal Republicans.

5. The U.S. military

Most Americans continue to express positive views of the military: 60% say it has a positive effect, while 36% say its effect is negative.

Age

Older Americans are more likely than younger Americans to hold a positive view of the military.

Adults under 30 are the only age group in which a larger share says the military has a negative (53%) than positive (43%) impact.

Seven-in-ten adults ages 50 and older say that the military is having a positive impact, as do 57% of those ages 30 to 49.

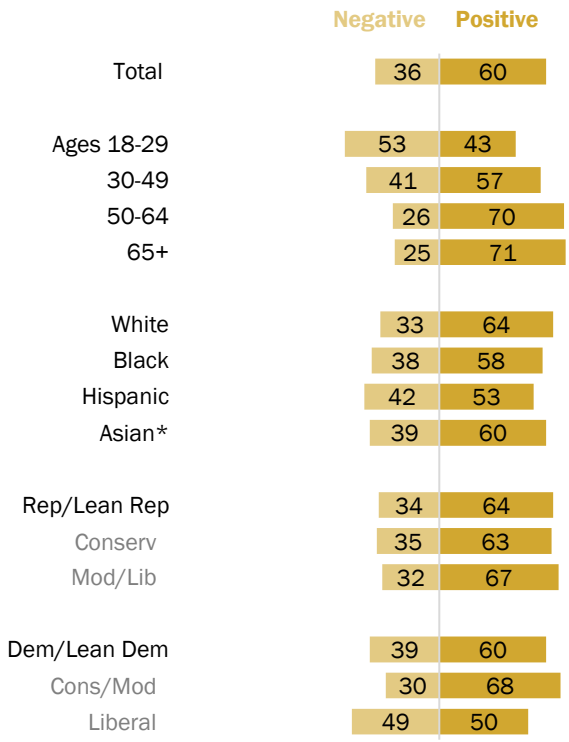
Partisanship

Similar shares of Republicans (64%) and Democrats (60%) view the military positively. However, there are ideological differences in these views among Democrats.

By a wide margin (68% positive to 30% negative), conservative and moderate Democrats express a positive view of the military. Liberal Democrats are roughly evenly divided (50% positive to 49% negative).

Americans ages 18 to 29 more negative than positive toward the U.S. military

*% who say **the military** has a ____ effect on the way things are going in the country these days*



* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanic adults are of any race. No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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The military is seen positively by 67% of moderate and liberal Republicans and 63% of conservative Republicans.

Race and ethnicity

Half or more across racial and ethnic groups also view the military positively: 64% of White adults, 60% of Asian adults, 58% of Black adults and 53% of Hispanic adults say this.

Acknowledgments

This report is a collaborative effort based on the input and analysis of the following individuals:

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Methodology

The American Trends Panel survey methodology

Overview

The American Trends Panel (ATP), created by Pew Research Center, is a nationally representative panel of randomly selected U.S. adults. Panelists participate via self-administered web surveys. Panelists who do not have internet access at home are provided with a tablet and wireless internet connection. Interviews are conducted in both English and Spanish. The panel is being managed by Ipsos.

Data in this report is drawn from ATP Wave 140, conducted from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024, and includes an oversample of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men and Hispanic men in order to provide more precise estimates of the opinions and experiences of these smaller demographic subgroups. These oversampled groups are weighted back to reflect their correct proportions in the population. A total of 5,140 panelists responded out of 5,604 who were sampled, for a response rate of 92%. The cumulative response rate accounting for nonresponse to the recruitment surveys and attrition is 3%. The break-off rate among panelists who logged on to the survey and completed at least one item is less than 1%. The margin of sampling error for the full sample of 5,140 respondents is plus or minus 1.7 percentage points.

Panel recruitment

The ATP was created in 2014, with the first cohort of panelists invited to join the panel at the end of a large, national, landline and cellphone random-digit-dial survey that was conducted in both English and Spanish. Two additional recruitments were conducted using the same method in 2015 and 2017, respectively. Across these three surveys, a total of 19,718 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 9,942 (50%) agreed to participate.

In August 2018, the ATP switched from telephone to address-based sampling (ABS) recruitment. A study cover letter and a pre-incentive are mailed to a stratified, random sample of households selected from the U.S. Postal Service's Delivery Sequence File. This Postal Service file has been estimated to cover as much as 98% of the population, although some studies suggest that the coverage could be in the low 90% range.[1] Within each sampled household, the adult with the next

[1] AAPOR Task Force on Address-based Sampling. 2016. "AAPOR Report: Address-based Sampling."

birthday is asked to participate. Other details of the ABS recruitment protocol have changed over time but are available upon request.[2]

We have recruited a national sample of U.S. adults to the ATP approximately once per year since 2014. In some years, the recruitment has included additional efforts (known as an "oversample") to boost sample size with underrepresented groups. For example, Hispanic adults, Black adults and Asian adults were oversampled in 2019, 2022 and 2023, respectively.

American Trends Panel recruitment surveys

Recruitment dates	Mode	Invited	Joined	Active panelists remaining
Jan. 23 to March 16, 2014	Landline/ cell RDD	9,809	5,338	1,393
Aug. 27 to Oct. 4, 2015	Landline/ cell RDD	6,004	2,976	831
April 25 to June 4, 2017	Landline/ cell RDD	3,905	1,628	405
Aug. 8 to Oct. 31, 2018	ABS	9,396	8,778	3,850
Aug. 19 to Nov. 30, 2019	ABS	5,900	4,720	1,388
June 1 to July 19, 2020; Feb. 10 to March 31, 2021	ABS	3,197	2,812	1,441
May 29 to July 7, 2021; Sept. 16 to Nov. 1, 2021	ABS	1,329	1,162	731
May 24 to Sept. 29, 2022	ABS	3,354	2,869	1,457
April 17 to May 30, 2023	ABS	686	576	435
	Total	**43,580**	**30,859**	**11,931**

Note: RDD is random-digit dial; ABS is address-based sampling. Approximately once per year, panelists who have not participated in multiple consecutive waves or who did not complete an annual profiling survey are removed from the panel. Panelists also become inactive if they ask to be removed from the panel.

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Across the six address-based recruitments, a total of 23,862 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 20,917 agreed to join the panel and completed an initial profile survey. Of the 30,859 individuals who have ever joined the ATP, 11,931 remained active panelists and continued to receive survey invitations at the time this survey was conducted.

The American Trends Panel never uses breakout routers or chains that direct respondents to additional surveys.

Sample design

The overall target population for this survey was noninstitutionalized persons ages 18 and older living in the U.S., including Alaska and Hawaii. It featured a stratified random sample from the ATP in which Hispanic men, non-Hispanic Black men and non-Hispanic Asian adults were selected with certainty. The remaining panelists were sampled at rates designed to ensure that the share of respondents in each stratum is proportional to its share of the U.S. adult population to the

[2] Email pewsurveys@pewresearch.org.

greatest extent possible. Respondent weights are adjusted to account for differential probabilities of selection as described in the Weighting section below.

Questionnaire development and testing

The questionnaire was developed by Pew Research Center in consultation with Ipsos. The web program was rigorously tested on both PC and mobile devices by the Ipsos project management team and Pew Research Center researchers. The Ipsos project management team also populated test data that was analyzed in SPSS to ensure the logic and randomizations were working as intended before launching the survey.

Incentives

All respondents were offered a post-paid incentive for their participation. Respondents could choose to receive the post-paid incentive in the form of a check or a gift code to Amazon.com or could choose to decline the incentive. Incentive amounts ranged from $5 to $20 depending on whether the respondent belongs to a part of the population that is harder or easier to reach. Differential incentive amounts were designed to increase panel survey participation among groups that traditionally have low survey response propensities.

Data collection protocol

The data collection field period for this survey was Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Postcard notifications were mailed to a subset of sampled ATP panelists[3] with a known residential address on Jan. 16.

Invitations were sent out in two separate launches: soft launch and full launch. Sixty panelists were included in the soft launch, which began with an initial invitation sent on Jan. 16. The ATP panelists chosen for the initial soft launch were known responders who had completed previous ATP surveys within one day of receiving their invitation. All remaining English- and Spanish-speaking sampled panelists were included in the full launch and were sent an invitation on Jan. 17.

All panelists with an email address received an email invitation and up to two email reminders if they did not respond to the survey. All ATP panelists who consented to SMS messages received an SMS invitation and up to two SMS reminders.

[3] Postcard notifications are sent to 1) panelists who have been provided with a tablet to take ATP surveys, 2) panelists who were recruited within the last two years, and 3) panelists recruited prior to the last two years who opt to continue receiving postcard notifications.

Invitation and reminder dates, ATP Wave 140

	Soft launch	Full launch
Initial invitation	January 16, 2024	January 17, 2024
First reminder	January 18, 2024	January 18, 2024
Final reminder	January 20 2024	January 20, 2024

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Data quality checks

To ensure high-quality data, the Center's researchers performed data quality checks to identify any respondents showing clear patterns of satisficing. This includes checking for whether respondents left questions blank at very high rates or always selected the first or last answer presented. As a result of this checking, four ATP respondents were removed from the survey dataset prior to weighting and analysis.

Weighting

The ATP data is weighted in a multistep process that accounts for multiple stages of sampling and nonresponse that occur at different points in the survey process. First, each panelist begins with a base weight that reflects their probability of selection for their initial recruitment survey. These weights are then rescaled and adjusted to account for changes in the design of ATP recruitment surveys from year to year. Finally, the weights are calibrated to align with the population benchmarks in the accompanying table to correct for nonresponse to recruitment surveys and panel attrition. If only a subsample of panelists was invited to participate in the wave, this weight is adjusted to account for any differential probabilities of selection.

American Trends Panel weighting dimensions

Variable	Benchmark source
Age (detailed) Age x Gender Education x Gender Education x Age Race/Ethnicity x Education Black (alone or in combination) x Hispanic Born inside vs. outside the U.S. among Hispanics and Asian Americans Years lived in the U.S. Census region x Metropolitan status	2022 American Community Survey (ACS)
Volunteerism	2021 CPS Volunteering & Civic Life Supplement
Voter registration	2022 CPS Voting and Registration Supplement
Party affiliation x Race/Ethnicity Frequency of internet use Religious affiliation	2023 National Public Opinion Reference Survey (NPORS)

Note: Estimates from the ACS are based on noninstitutionalized adults. Voter registration is calculated using procedures from Hur, Achen (2013) and rescaled to include the total U.S. adult population.

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Among the panelists who completed the survey, this weight is then calibrated again to align with the population benchmarks identified in the accompanying table and trimmed at the 2nd and 98th percentiles to reduce the loss in precision stemming from variance in the weights. This trimming is performed separately among non-Hispanic Black, non-Hispanic Asian Hispanic and all other respondents. Sampling errors and tests of statistical significance take into account the effect of weighting.

The following table shows the unweighted sample sizes and the error attributable to sampling that would be expected at the 95% level of confidence for different groups in the survey.

Sample sizes and margins of error, ATP Wave 140

Group	Unweighted sample size	Weighted %	Plus or minus ...
Total sample	5,140		1.7 percentage points
Half form	2,569		2.5 percentage points
Rep/Lean Rep	2,210	45	2.5 percentage points
Half form	1,088		3.6 percentage points
Dem/Lean Dem	2,710	47	2.4 percentage points
Half form	1,358		3.5 percentage points

Note: This survey includes oversamples of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men and Hispanic men. Unweighted sample sizes do not account for the sample design or weighting and do not describe a group's contribution to weighted estimates. Refer to the Sample design and Weighting sections above for details.

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Sample sizes and sampling errors for other subgroups are available upon request. In addition to sampling error, one should bear in mind that question wording and practical difficulties in conducting surveys can introduce error or bias into the findings of opinion polls.

Dispositions and response rates

Final dispositions, ATP Wave 140

	AAPOR code	Total
Completed interview	1.1	5,140
Logged on to survey; broke off	2.12	23
Logged on to survey; did not complete any items	2.1121	49
Never logged on (implicit refusal)	2.11	387
Survey completed after close of the field period	2.27	1
Completed interview but was removed for data quality	2.3	4
Screened out	4.7	0
Total panelists sampled for the survey		**5,604**
Completed interviews	I	5,140
Partial interviews	P	0
Refusals	R	459
Non-contact	NC	1
Other	O	4
Unknown household	UH	0
Unknown other	UO	0
Not eligible	NE	0
Total		**5,604**
AAPOR RR1 = I / (I+P+R+NC+O+UH+UO)		92%

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Cumulative response rate as of ATP Wave 140

	Total
Weighted response rate to recruitment surveys	11%
% of recruitment survey respondents who agreed to join the panel, among those invited	71%
% of those agreeing to join who were active panelists at start of Wave 140	46%
Response rate to Wave 140 survey	92%
Cumulative response rate	**3%**

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2024 PEW RESEARCH CENTER'S AMERICAN TRENDS PANEL
WAVE 140 JANUARY 2024
FINAL TOPLINE
JANUARY 16–21, 2024
N=5,140

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]:
INSTN Are each of the following having a positive or negative effect on the way things are going in the country these days? **[RANDOMIZE ITEMS]**

		Positive effect	Negative effect		No answer
INSTN_CHR	Churches and religious organizations				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	59	39		2
	Oct 10-16, 2022	53	44		4
	Jul 8-18, 2021	62	35		3
	Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019	58	39		3
PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON:				**(VOL.)** Neither/ No influence/ Mixed	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
	Jul 10-15, 2019	52	29	15	4
	Jun 8-18, 2017	59	26	10	5
	Aug 23-Sep 2, 2016	57	27	11	5
	Sep 16-Oct 4, 2015	61	28	8	3
	Feb 8-12, 2012	57	26	8	9
	Mar 11-21, 2010	63	22	7	8

		Positive effect	Negative effect		No answer
INSTN_CLGS	Colleges and universities				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	53	45		2
	Oct 10-16, 2022	53	45		3
	Jul 8-18, 2021	57	41		2
	Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019	56	42		2
PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON:				**(VOL.)** Neither/ No influence/ Mixed	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
	Jul 10-15, 2019	50	38	8	5
	Jun 8-18, 2017	55	36	4	4
	Aug 23-Sep 2, 2016	57	30	7	5
	Sep 16-Oct 4, 2015	63	28	6	3
	Feb 8-12, 2012	60	26	5	8
	Mar 11-21, 2010	61	26	4	9

		Positive effect	Negative effect		No answer
INSTN_LBRUN	Labor unions				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	55	41		4
	Oct 10-16, 2022	54	41		4

INSTN_LBRUN CONTINUED …:			**(VOL.) Neither/ No influence/ Mixed**	**(VOL.) DK/Ref**
Jul 8-18, 2021	55	41		4
Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019	55	41		4

PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON:			**(VOL.) Neither/ No influence/ Mixed**	**(VOL.) DK/Ref**
Jul 10-15, 2019	45	28	13	14
Jun 8-18, 2017	47	32	8	13
Aug 23-Sep 2, 2016	43	36	10	10
Sep 16-Oct 4, 2015	45	40	7	8
Feb 8-12, 2012	37	45	5	14
Mar 11-21, 2010	32	49	4	14

		Positive effect	Negative effect		No answer
INSTN_TECHCMP	Technology companies				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	53	44		2
	Oct 10-16, 2022	49	47		3
	Jul 8-18, 2021	52	46		2
	Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019	58	40		2

PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON:			**(VOL.) Neither/ No influence/ Mixed**	**(VOL.) DK/Ref**
Jul 10-15, 2019	50	33	13	4
Sep 16-Oct 4, 2015	71	17	7	4
Feb 8-12, 2012	70	18	5	7
Mar 11-21, 2010	68	18	4	10

		Positive effect	Negative effect		No answer
INSTN_SMBUS	Small businesses				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	86	12		1
	Oct 10-16, 2022	80	18		2

PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON:			**(VOL.) Neither/ No influence/ Mixed**	**(VOL.) DK/Ref**
Sep 16-Oct 4, 2015	82	13	3	2
Feb 8-12, 2012	75	18	3	5
Mar 11-21, 2010	71	19	3	7

INSTN CONTINUED …		Positive effect	Negative effect		No answer
INSTN_K12	K-12 public schools				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	53	45		2
	Oct 10-16, 2022	55	42		3
	Ju 8-18, 2021	61	38		1

PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON:				**(VOL.)** Neither/ No influence/ Mixed	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
	Sep 16-Oct 4, 2015	82	13	3	2
	Feb 8-12, 2012	75	18	3	5
	Mar 11-21, 2010	71	19	3	7

		Positive effect	Negative effect		No answer
INSTN_BNKS	Banks and other financial institutions				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	37	60		3
	Oct 10-16, 2022	40	56		4
	Jul 8-18, 2021	49	48		3
	Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019	49	48		3

PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON:				**(VOL.)** Neither/ No influence/ Mixed	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
	Jul 10-15, 2019	39	39	15	8
	Jun 8-18, 2017	39	46	8	7
	Aug 23-Sep 2, 2016	34	50	9	6
	Sep 16-Oct 4, 2015	40	47	8	5
	Feb 8-12, 2012	22	68	5	6
	Mar 11-21, 2010	22	69	4	6

		Positive effect	Negative effect		No answer
INSTN_MIL	The military				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	60	36		3
	Oct 10-16, 2022	62	34		4

		Positive effect	Negative effect		No answer
INSTN_LGECRP	Large corporations				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	29	68		3
	Oct 10-16, 2022	25	71		4
	Jul 8-18, 2021	29	68		3
	Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019	36	61		3

PHONE TREND FOR COMPARISON:				**(VOL.)** Neither/ No influence/ Mixed	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
	Jul 10-15, 2019	32	53	9	6
	Aug 23-Sep 2, 2016	28	56	10	6
	Sep 16-Oct 4, 2015	33	56	7	4
	Feb 8-12, 2012	28	57	7	7
	Mar 11-21, 2010	25	64	4	8

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ASK ALL:
PARTY In politics today, do you consider yourself a:
ASK IF INDEP/SOMETHING ELSE (PARTY=3 or 4) OR MISSING:
PARTYLN As of today do you lean more to…[1]

Republican	Democrat	Independent	Something else	No answer	*Lean Rep*	*Lean Dem*
28	29	27	13	3	17	18

[1] PARTY and PARTYLN asked in a prior survey.

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FOR RELEASE FEBRUARY 7, 2024

Bipartisan Support for Early In-Person Voting, Voter ID, Election Day National Holiday

Widening partisan divides over vote-by-mail and registration policies

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How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand Americans' views of voting policies and procedures in the United States. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16-21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

Bipartisan Support for Early In-Person Voting, Voter ID, Election Day National Holiday

Widening partisan divides over vote-by-mail and registration policies

Americans generally believe that voting is an effective way to bring about positive change in the country. But in recent years, there have been contentious debates in a number of states over the rules around voting and elections.

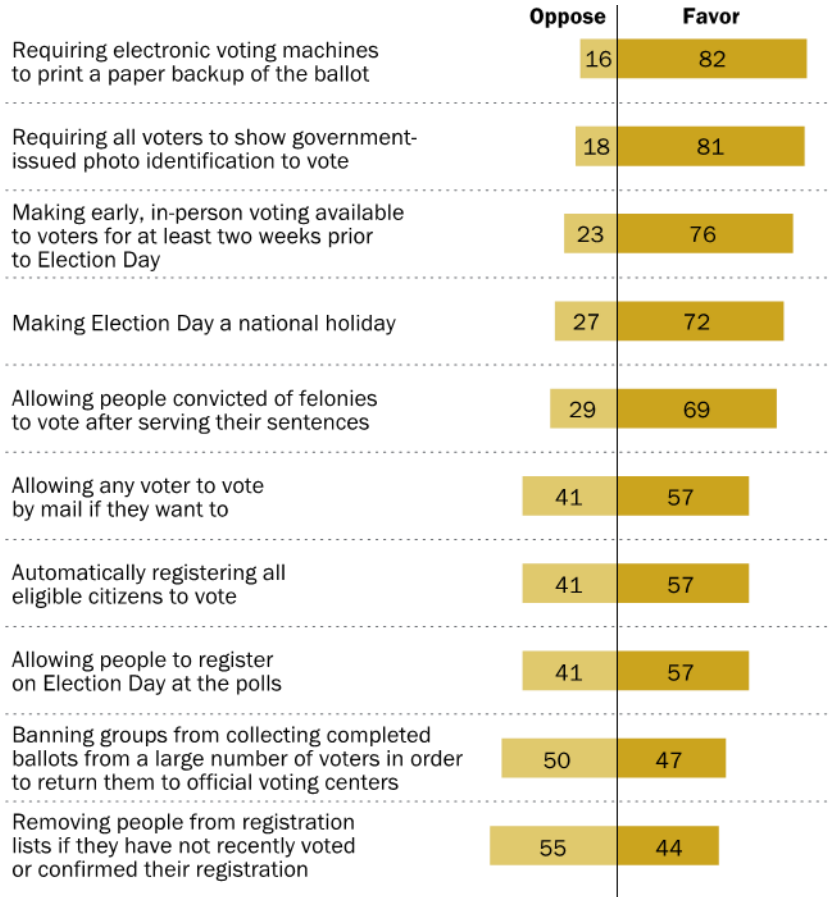
A new national survey finds deep partisan divisions over some voting policies, especially voting by mail.

Yet other proposals draw widespread public support, including from majorities in both partisan coalitions:

- Requiring paper ballot backups for electronic voting machines (82% favor this),
- Requiring people to show government-issued photo identification to vote (81%),
- Making early voting available for two weeks prior to Election Day (76%),
- Making Election Day a national holiday (72%) and
- Allowing convicted felons to vote after serving their sentences (69%).

Most Americans favor paper ballot backups, voter ID, weeks of early voting, making Election Day a holiday

% who __ each of the following



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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The Pew Research Center survey, conducted Jan. 16-21 among 5,140 adults, also finds smaller majorities supporting allowing anyone to vote by mail if they want to (57%), as well as automatic and Election Day voter registration (57% each).

Americans are more divided on whether groups should be banned from collecting completed ballots to return to official voting centers (47% favor, 50% oppose) and whether people should be removed from registration lists if they have not voted recently or confirmed their registration (44% favor, 55% oppose).

Proposals with broad bipartisan support

More than eight-in-ten Republicans and those who lean to the Republican Party (85%), and a similar share of Democrats and Democratic leaners (82%), favor paper ballot backups for electronic voting machines.

While there is substantial support in both parties for requiring a photo ID to vote, there is a sizable partisan divide in these views: Nearly all Republicans (95%), compared with 69% of Democrats, favor this requirement.

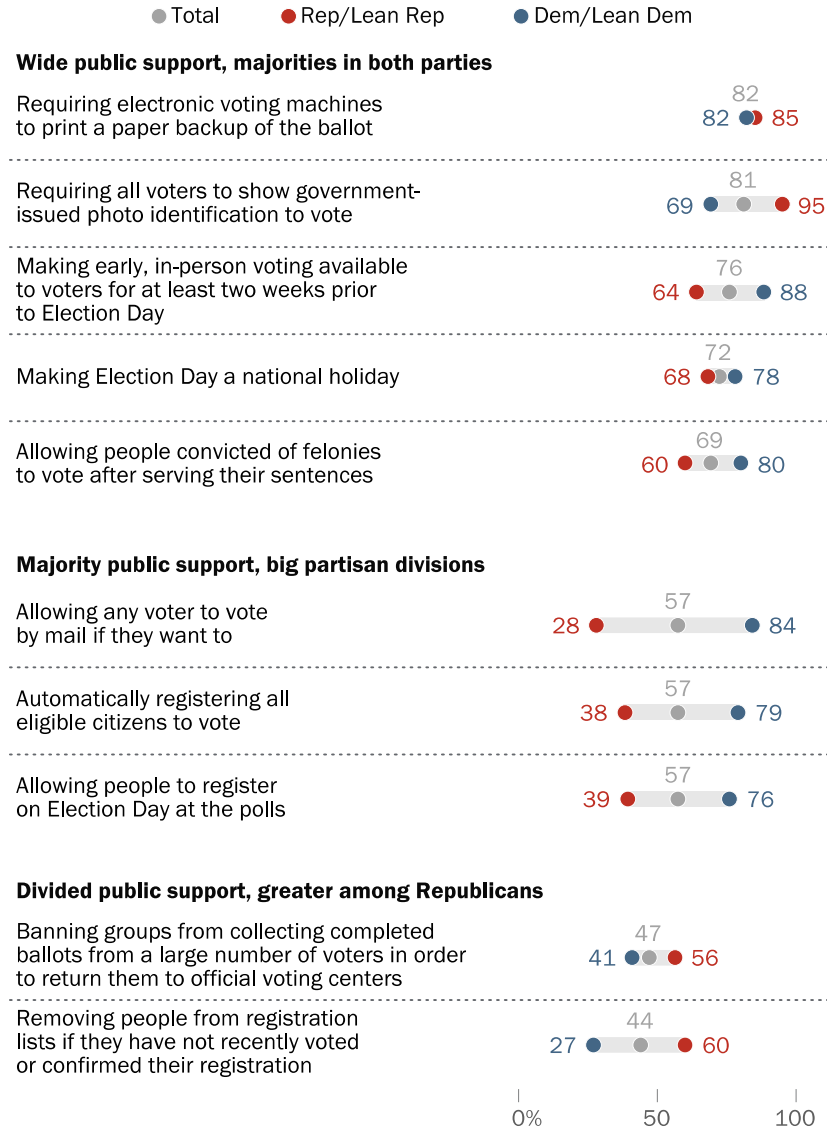
At least six-in-ten among both parties also favor allowing two weeks of early in-person voting, making Election Day a national holiday and allowing convicted felons to vote after serving their sentences. Yet support for each of these policies is higher among Democrats than Republicans.

Proposals with narrow majority public support, and wide partisan differences

About six-in-ten adults (57% each) support allowing anyone to vote by mail if they want, automatically registering eligible citizens to vote and allowing registration on Election Day.

Bipartisan support for some voting policy proposals, wide partisan gaps on others

% who favor ...



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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However, Democrats are far more supportive of these proposals than Republicans. At least three-quarters of Democrats support each of them, while there is more opposition than support for them among Republicans.

Proposals that divide the public

Nearly half of Americans (47%) favor banning groups from collecting completed ballots to return to official voting centers, while roughly the same share (50%) oppose this. The public is also relatively divided over removing people from voter registration lists if they have not voted recently or confirmed their registration, with slightly more opposing this (55%) than supporting it (44%).

Republicans are about twice as likely as Democrats (60% vs. 27%) to support the removal of inactive records from registration lists. Republicans are also more likely than Democrats (56% vs. 41%) to favor banning groups from collecting and returning ballots.

Shifts in support for some election policy proposals

Support for – and opposition to – many election policy proposals is similar to views in recent years, though there have been some notable shifts.

Election Day policies

Americans have long supported **making Election Day a national holiday.** But support for this has risen in recent years, from 65% in 2018 to 72% today. Currently, 78% of Democrats and 68% of Republicans favor this.

By contrast, support for **allowing Election Day voter registration** has dropped over the last several years –from 64% in 2018 to 57% now.

- This decrease is largely driven by declining support among Republicans: 39% currently favor Election Day voter registration, down from 49% four years ago.
- 76% of Democrats favor allowing Election Day registration, little different from the 78% who said this in 2018.

Voting by mail

The single widest partisan gap on the voting policies asked about in this survey is over “allowing any voter to vote by mail if they want to.” And that gap is now substantially wider than it was in April 2020, the result of a sharp decline in support among Republicans:

- Today, just 28% of Republicans say any voter should be allowed to vote by mail if they want to. Four years ago, 49% of Republicans said this.
- An overwhelming share of Democrats (84%) continue to say voting by mail should be available to all voters. Democratic support is essentially unchanged over this period.

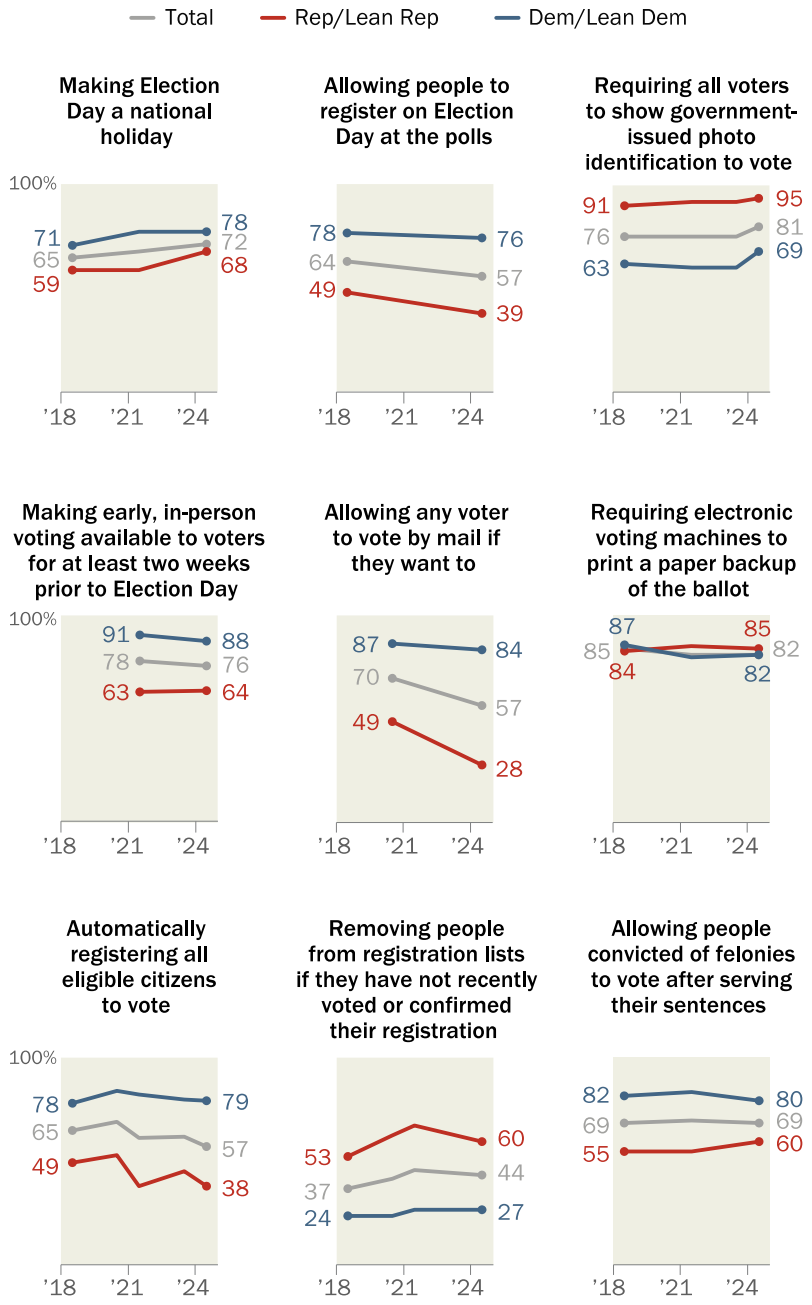
Voter ID

Majorities in both parties continue to back requiring all voters to show government-issued photo ID to vote.

- The share of Democrats supporting this has risen from 61% to 69% since last year.
- Support for voter ID remains nearly universal among Republicans (95% favor).

Partisans grow further apart on automatic and Election Day voter registration, voting by mail

% who favor ...



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Age differences on voter registration policies

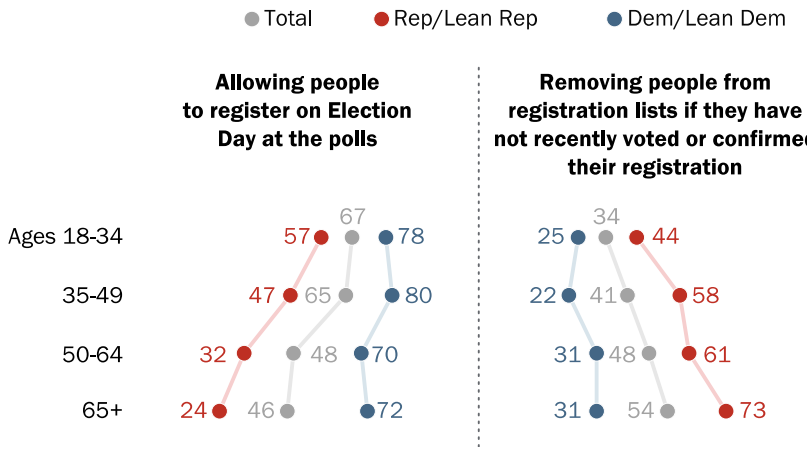
While there are only modest age differences on many of the voting policies asked about in the survey, there are wider gaps on two policies related to voter registration.

Older adults are far less supportive than younger adults of same-day voter registration. They are also more supportive of removing people from registration lists if they have not voted recently.

These differences are particularly pronounced among Republicans.

Wide age gaps, especially within GOP, on same-day registration and removal of inactive voter records

% who favor ...



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Election Day registration

- About six-in-ten Republicans ages 18 to 34 (57%) favor same-day voter registration. The share backing this drops among older age groups. Just 24% of Republicans ages 65 and older support allowing Election Day registration.
- There are only modest age differences on this question among Democrats, with about seven-in-ten of those 50 and older supporting same-day voter registration, along with about eight-in-ten of those under 50.

Removing inactive registration records

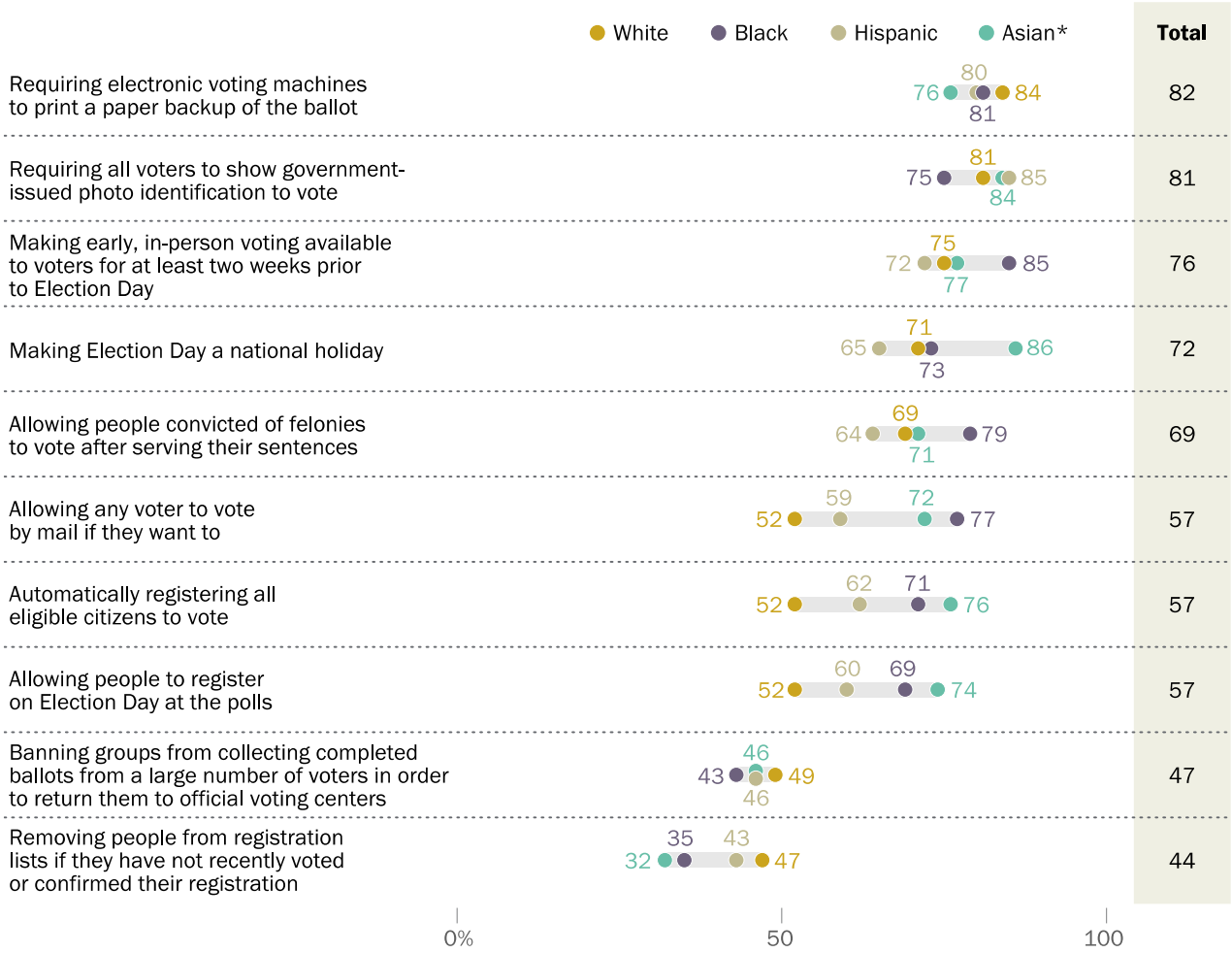
- Nearly three-quarters of Republicans ages 65 and older (73%) support removing people from registration lists if they have not recently voted or confirmed their registration, as do 61% of Republicans 50 to 64 and 58% of Republicans 35 to 49. Republicans ages 18 to 34 are less likely (44%) to say this.
- Among Democrats, age differences are far more modest: 24% of those under 50 and 31% of those 50 and older favor the removal of registration records for inactivity.

Views of voting proposals among racial and ethnic groups

Across racial and ethnic groups, large majorities favor requiring paper ballot backups for electronic voting machines, photo ID requirements for voting and making Election Day a national holiday.

White Americans are less supportive of allowing anyone to vote by mail if they want to, automatic voter registration and same-day registration

% who favor ...



* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.

Note: White, Black and Asian adults include only those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race.

Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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- Majorities also favor allowing two weeks of early in-person voting and allowing convicted felons to vote after serving their sentences, with Black adults more likely than any other group to *strongly* favor these policies.
- While about half of White adults (52%) favor policy proposals that would allow anyone to vote by mail if they want, automatically register all citizens to vote, or allow people to register on Election Day, they are far less supportive of these policies than other racial and ethnic groups. About three-quarters of Asian adults favor these policies, as do similar shares of Black adults and about six-in-ten Hispanic adults.

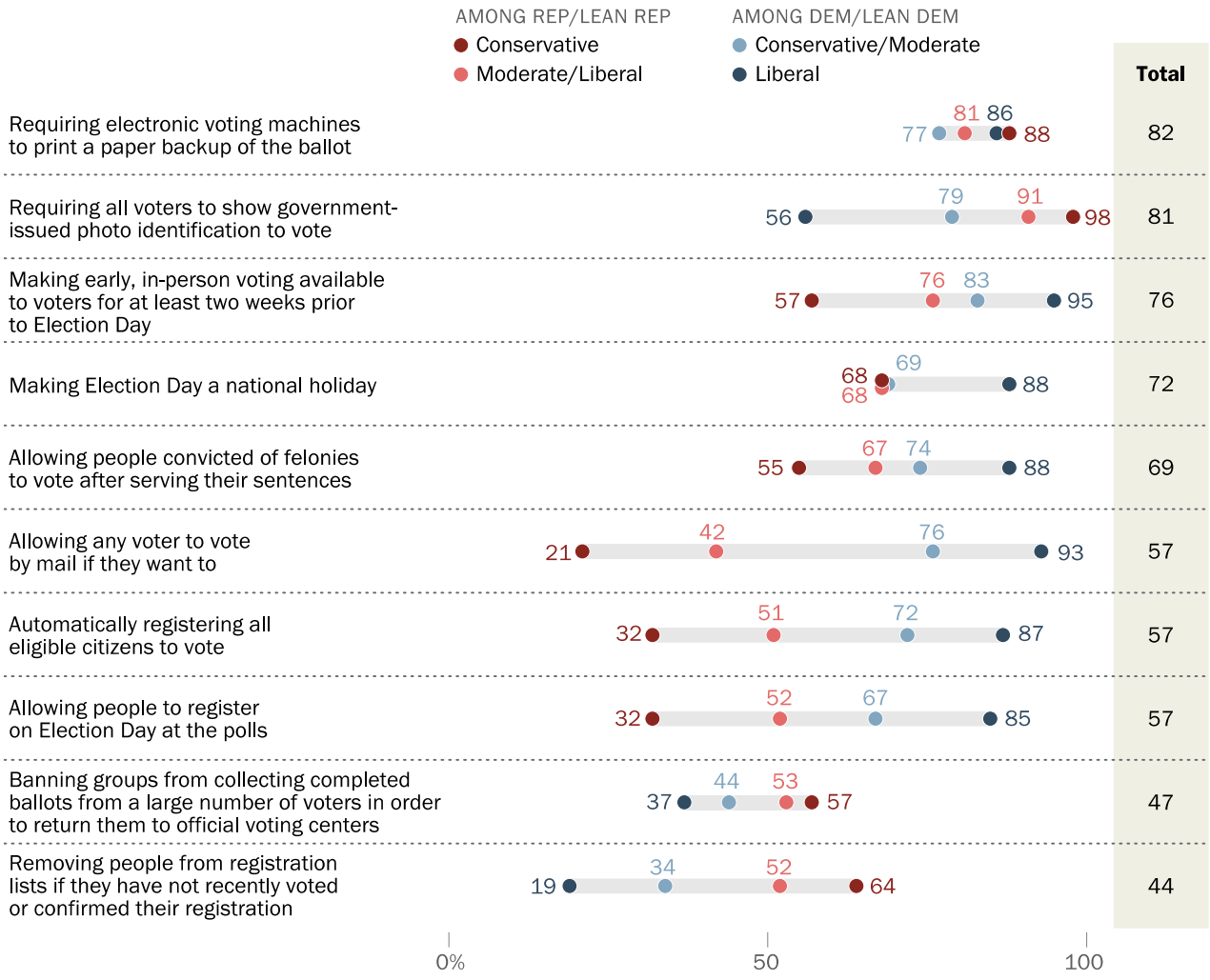
Views of election policies across ideological groups

For the most part, partisan and ideological differences in support or opposition to voting policies find wide gaps between liberal Democrats and conservative Republicans, with moderates in both parties falling somewhere in between. But there are a few exceptions:

- Liberal Democrats are particularly likely to support making Election Day a national holiday. But there is no gap in opinion between other groups: 88% of liberals favor this, compared with about seven-in-ten of those in other ideological groups.
- Wide majorities across all groups favor requiring paper backup ballots – with nearly identical shares of conservative Republicans (88%) and liberal Democrats (86%) saying this.

Substantial ideological differences within both parties on some election policies

% who favor ...



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Acknowledgments

This report is a collaborative effort based on the input and analysis of the following individuals:

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Methodology

The American Trends Panel survey methodology

Overview

The American Trends Panel (ATP), created by Pew Research Center, is a nationally representative panel of randomly selected U.S. adults. Panelists participate via self-administered web surveys. Panelists who do not have internet access at home are provided with a tablet and wireless internet connection. Interviews are conducted in both English and Spanish. The panel is being managed by Ipsos.

Data in this report is drawn from ATP Wave 140, conducted from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024, and includes an oversample of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men and Hispanic men in order to provide more precise estimates of the opinions and experiences of these smaller demographic subgroups. These oversampled groups are weighted back to reflect their correct proportions in the population. A total of 5,140 panelists responded out of 5,604 who were sampled, for a response rate of 92%. The cumulative response rate accounting for nonresponse to the recruitment surveys and attrition is 3%. The break-off rate among panelists who logged on to the survey and completed at least one item is less than 1%. The margin of sampling error for the full sample of 5,140 respondents is plus or minus 1.7 percentage points.

Panel recruitment

The ATP was created in 2014, with the first cohort of panelists invited to join the panel at the end of a large, national, landline and cellphone random-digit-dial survey that was conducted in both English and Spanish. Two additional recruitments were conducted using the same method in 2015 and 2017, respectively. Across these three surveys, a total of 19,718 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 9,942 (50%) agreed to participate.

In August 2018, the ATP switched from telephone to address-based sampling (ABS) recruitment. A study cover letter and a pre-incentive are mailed to a stratified, random sample of households selected from the U.S. Postal Service's Delivery Sequence File. This Postal Service file has been estimated to cover as much as 98% of the population, although some studies suggest that the coverage could be in the low 90% range.[1] Within each sampled household, the adult with the next

[1] AAPOR Task Force on Address-based Sampling. 2016. "AAPOR Report: Address-based Sampling."

birthday is asked to participate. Other details of the ABS recruitment protocol have changed over time but are available upon request.[2]

We have recruited a national sample of U.S. adults to the ATP approximately once per year since 2014. In some years, the recruitment has included additional efforts (known as an "oversample") to boost sample size with underrepresented groups. For example, Hispanic adults, Black adults and Asian adults were oversampled in 2019, 2022 and 2023, respectively.

American Trends Panel recruitment surveys

Recruitment dates	Mode	Invited	Joined	Active panelists remaining
Jan. 23 to March 16, 2014	Landline/ cell RDD	9,809	5,338	1,393
Aug. 27 to Oct. 4, 2015	Landline/ cell RDD	6,004	2,976	831
April 25 to June 4, 2017	Landline/ cell RDD	3,905	1,628	405
Aug. 8 to Oct. 31, 2018	ABS	9,396	8,778	3,850
Aug. 19 to Nov. 30, 2019	ABS	5,900	4,720	1,388
June 1 to July 19, 2020; Feb. 10 to March 31, 2021	ABS	3,197	2,812	1,441
May 29 to July 7, 2021; Sept. 16 to Nov. 1, 2021	ABS	1,329	1,162	731
May 24 to Sept. 29, 2022	ABS	3,354	2,869	1,457
April 17 to May 30, 2023	ABS	686	576	435
	Total	**43,580**	**30,859**	**11,931**

Note: RDD is random-digit dial; ABS is address-based sampling. Approximately once per year, panelists who have not participated in multiple consecutive waves or who did not complete an annual profiling survey are removed from the panel. Panelists also become inactive if they ask to be removed from the panel.

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Across the six address-based recruitments, a total of 23,862 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 20,917 agreed to join the panel and completed an initial profile survey. Of the 30,859 individuals who have ever joined the ATP, 11,931 remained active panelists and continued to receive survey invitations at the time this survey was conducted.

The American Trends Panel never uses breakout routers or chains that direct respondents to additional surveys.

Sample design

The overall target population for this survey was noninstitutionalized persons ages 18 and older living in the U.S., including Alaska and Hawaii. It featured a stratified random sample from the ATP in which Hispanic men, non-Hispanic Black men and non-Hispanic Asian adults were selected with certainty. The remaining panelists were sampled at rates designed to ensure that the share of respondents in each stratum is proportional to its share of the U.S. adult population to the

[2] Email pewsurveys@pewresearch.org.

greatest extent possible. Respondent weights are adjusted to account for differential probabilities of selection as described in the Weighting section below.

Questionnaire development and testing

The questionnaire was developed by Pew Research Center in consultation with Ipsos. The web program was rigorously tested on both PC and mobile devices by the Ipsos project management team and Pew Research Center researchers. The Ipsos project management team also populated test data that was analyzed in SPSS to ensure the logic and randomizations were working as intended before launching the survey.

Incentives

All respondents were offered a post-paid incentive for their participation. Respondents could choose to receive the post-paid incentive in the form of a check or a gift code to Amazon.com or could choose to decline the incentive. Incentive amounts ranged from $5 to $20 depending on whether the respondent belongs to a part of the population that is harder or easier to reach. Differential incentive amounts were designed to increase panel survey participation among groups that traditionally have low survey response propensities.

Data collection protocol

The data collection field period for this survey was Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Postcard notifications were mailed to a subset of sampled ATP panelists[3] with a known residential address on Jan. 16.

Invitations were sent out in two separate launches: soft launch and full launch. Sixty panelists were included in the soft launch, which began with an initial invitation sent on Jan. 16. The ATP panelists chosen for the initial soft launch were known responders who had completed previous ATP surveys within one day of receiving their invitation. All remaining English- and Spanish-speaking sampled panelists were included in the full launch and were sent an invitation on Jan. 17.

All panelists with an email address received an email invitation and up to two email reminders if they did not respond to the survey. All ATP panelists who consented to SMS messages received an SMS invitation and up to two SMS reminders.

[3] Postcard notifications are sent to 1) panelists who have been provided with a tablet to take ATP surveys, 2) panelists who were recruited within the last two years, and 3) panelists recruited prior to the last two years who opt to continue receiving postcard notifications.

Invitation and reminder dates, ATP Wave 140

	Soft launch	Full launch
Initial invitation	January 16, 2024	January 17, 2024
First reminder	January 18, 2024	January 18, 2024
Final reminder	January 20 2024	January 20, 2024

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Data quality checks

To ensure high-quality data, the Center's researchers performed data quality checks to identify any respondents showing clear patterns of satisficing. This includes checking for whether respondents left questions blank at very high rates or always selected the first or last answer presented. As a result of this checking, four ATP respondents were removed from the survey dataset prior to weighting and analysis.

Weighting

The ATP data is weighted in a multistep process that accounts for multiple stages of sampling and nonresponse that occur at different points in the survey process. First, each panelist begins with a base weight that reflects their probability of selection for their initial recruitment survey. These weights are then rescaled and adjusted to account for changes in the design of ATP recruitment surveys from year to year. Finally, the weights are calibrated to align with the population benchmarks in the accompanying table to correct for nonresponse to recruitment surveys and panel attrition. If only a subsample of panelists was invited to participate in the wave, this weight is adjusted to account for any differential probabilities of selection.

American Trends Panel weighting dimensions

Variable	Benchmark source
Age (detailed) Age x Gender Education x Gender Education x Age Race/Ethnicity x Education Black (alone or in combination) x Hispanic Born inside vs. outside the U.S. among Hispanics and Asian Americans Years lived in the U.S. Census region x Metropolitan status	2022 American Community Survey (ACS)
Volunteerism	2021 CPS Volunteering & Civic Life Supplement
Voter registration	2022 CPS Voting and Registration Supplement
Party affiliation x Race/Ethnicity Frequency of internet use Religious affiliation	2023 National Public Opinion Reference Survey (NPORS)

Note: Estimates from the ACS are based on noninstitutionalized adults. Voter registration is calculated using procedures from Hur, Achen (2013) and rescaled to include the total U.S. adult population.

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Among the panelists who completed the survey, this weight is then calibrated again to align with the population benchmarks identified in the accompanying table and trimmed at the 2nd and 98th percentiles to reduce the loss in precision stemming from variance in the weights. This trimming is performed separately among non-Hispanic Black, non-Hispanic Asian Hispanic and all other respondents. Sampling errors and tests of statistical significance take into account the effect of weighting.

The following table shows the unweighted sample sizes and the error attributable to sampling that would be expected at the 95% level of confidence for different groups in the survey.

Sample sizes and margins of error, ATP Wave 140

Group	Unweighted sample size	Weighted %	Plus or minus ...
Total sample	5,140		1.7 percentage points
Half form	2,569		2.5 percentage points
Rep/Lean Rep	2,210	45	2.5 percentage points
Half form	1,088		3.6 percentage points
Dem/Lean Dem	2,710	47	2.4 percentage points
Half form	1,358		3.5 percentage points

Note: This survey includes oversamples of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men and Hispanic men. Unweighted sample sizes do not account for the sample design or weighting and do not describe a group's contribution to weighted estimates. Refer to the Sample design and Weighting sections above for details.

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Sample sizes and sampling errors for other subgroups are available upon request. In addition to sampling error, one should bear in mind that question wording and practical difficulties in conducting surveys can introduce error or bias into the findings of opinion polls.

Dispositions and response rates

Final dispositions, ATP Wave 140

	AAPOR code	Total
Completed interview	1.1	5,140
Logged on to survey; broke off	2.12	23
Logged on to survey; did not complete any items	2.1121	49
Never logged on (implicit refusal)	2.11	387
Survey completed after close of the field period	2.27	1
Completed interview but was removed for data quality	2.3	4
Screened out	4.7	0
Total panelists sampled for the survey		**5,604**
Completed interviews	I	5,140
Partial interviews	P	0
Refusals	R	459
Non-contact	NC	1
Other	O	4
Unknown household	UH	0
Unknown other	UO	0
Not eligible	NE	0
Total		**5,604**
AAPOR RR1 = I / (I+P+R+NC+O+UH+UO)		92%

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Cumulative response rate as of ATP Wave 140

	Total
Weighted response rate to recruitment surveys	11%
% of recruitment survey respondents who agreed to join the panel, among those invited	71%
% of those agreeing to join who were active panelists at start of Wave 140	46%
Response rate to Wave 140 survey	92%
Cumulative response rate	**3%**

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2024 PEW RESEARCH CENTER'S AMERICAN TRENDS PANEL
WAVE 140 JANUARY 2024
FINAL TOPLINE
JANUARY 16–21, 2024
N=5,140

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ADDITIONAL QUESTION HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

ASK ALL:

VTPRIORITY Please indicate whether you would favor or oppose the following ideas about election policy.
[RANDOMIZE ITEMS; RANDOMLY DISPLAY RESPONSES 1-4 OR 4-1]

		Strongly favor	Somewhat favor	Somewhat oppose	Strongly oppose	No answer
ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]						
ATO	Automatically registering all eligible citizens to vote					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	33	24	18	24	1
	Jul 10-16, 2023	34	28	17	20	1
	Apr 5-11, 2021	36	25	18	19	2
	Apr 7-12, 2020	42	27	15	15	*
	Sep 24-Oct 7, 2018	34	31	17	17	1
HLDY	Making Election Day a national holiday					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	44	28	15	12	1
	Apr 5-11, 2021	42	27	16	13	2
	Sep 24-Oct 7, 2018	36	29	18	17	1
FLN	Allowing people convicted of felonies to vote after serving their sentences					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	32	37	17	13	1
	Apr 5-11, 2021	36	35	16	12	1
	Sep 24-Oct 7, 2018	33	37	15	14	1
RMVVT	Removing people from registration lists if they have not recently voted or confirmed their registration					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	20	24	28	28	1
	Apr 5-11, 2021	21	25	24	27	2
	Apr 7-12, 2020	17	25	26	31	2
	Sep 24-Oct 7, 2018	15	22	27	35	1
BLT_CL	Banning groups from collecting completed ballots from a large number of voters in order to return them to official voting centers					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	28	19	26	24	3

VTPRIORITY CONTINUED…		Strongly favor	Somewhat favor	Somewhat oppose	Strongly oppose	No answer
ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]						
GOVID	Requiring all voters to show government issued photo identification to vote					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	61	20	11	7	1
	Jul 10-16, 2023	53	23	14	9	1
	Apr 5-11, 2021	53	23	13	10	1
	Sep 24-Oct 7, 2018	54	22	13	11	1
PPR	Requiring electronic voting machines to print a paper backup of the ballot					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	43	39	11	5	2
	Apr 5-11, 2021	43	39	10	5	2
	Sep 24-Oct 7, 2018	49	36	10	4	1
ERLY	Making early, in-person voting available to voters for at least two weeks prior to Election Day					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	43	33	13	11	1
	Apr 5-11, 2021	47	31	12	9	2
ML	Allowing any voter to vote by mail if they want to					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	35	23	15	26	1
	Apr 7-12, 2020	44	26	13	16	1
REGED	Allowing people to register on Election Day at the polls					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	30	27	20	22	1
	Sep 24-Oct 7, 2018	36	28	17	18	1

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ASK ALL:

PARTY In politics today, do you consider yourself a:

ASK IF INDEP/SOMETHING ELSE (PARTY=3 or 4) OR MISSING:

PARTYLN As of today do you lean more to…[7]

Republican	Democrat	Independent	Something else	No answer	*Lean Rep*	*Lean Dem*
28	29	27	13	3	17	18

[7] PARTY and PARTYLN asked in a prior survey.

Pew Research Center

FOR RELEASE FEBRUARY 15, 2024

How Americans View the Situation at the U.S.-Mexico Border, Its Causes and Consequences

80% say the U.S. government is doing a bad job handling the migrant influx

FOR MEDIA OR OTHER INQUIRIES:

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RECOMMENDED CITATION

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How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand the public's views about the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16-21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

How Americans View the Situation at the U.S.-Mexico Border, Its Causes and Consequences

80% say the U.S. government is doing a bad job handling the migrant influx

The growing number of migrants seeking entry into the United States at its border with Mexico has strained government resources, divided Congress and emerged as a contentious issue in the 2024 presidential campaign.

Americans overwhelmingly fault the government for how it has handled the migrant situation. Beyond that, however, there are deep differences – over why the migrants are coming to the U.S., proposals for addressing the situation, and even whether it should be described as a "crisis."

Factors behind the migrant influx

Economic factors – **either poor conditions in migrants' home countries or better economic opportunities in the United States** – are widely viewed as major reasons for the migrant influx.

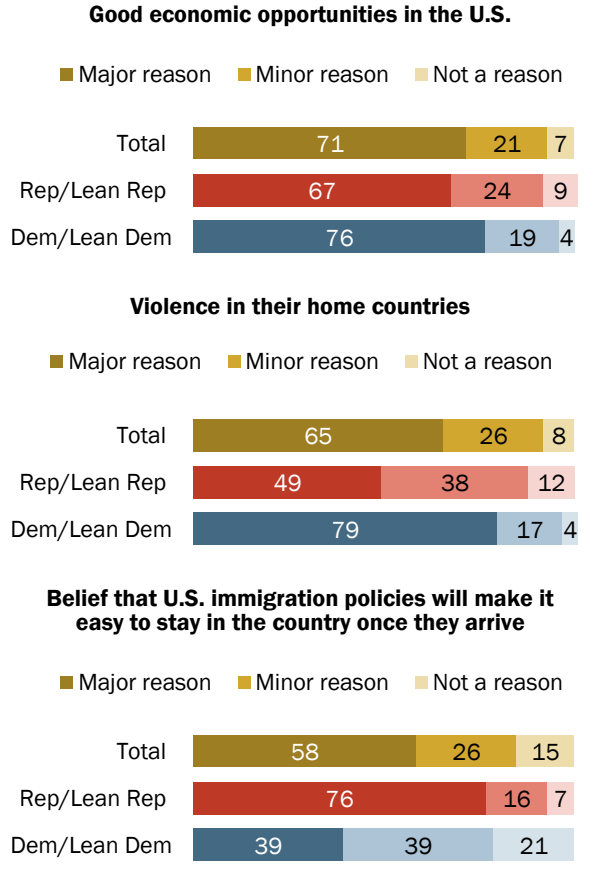
About seven-in-ten Americans (71%), including majorities in both parties, cite better economic opportunities in the U.S. as a major reason.

There are wider partisan differences over other factors.

About two-thirds of Americans (65%) say **violence in migrants' home countries** is a major reason for why a large number of immigrants have come to the border.

Why do Americans think there is an influx of migrants to the United States?

% who say each of the following is (a) ___ for why a large number of migrants are seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents are 30 percentage points more likely than Republicans and Republican leaners to cite this as a major reason (79% vs. 49%).

By contrast, 76% of Republicans say **the belief that U.S. immigration policies will make it easy to stay in the country once they arrive** is a major factor. About half as many Democrats (39%) say the same.

For more on Americans' views of these and other reasons, visit Chapter 2.

How serious is the situation at the border?

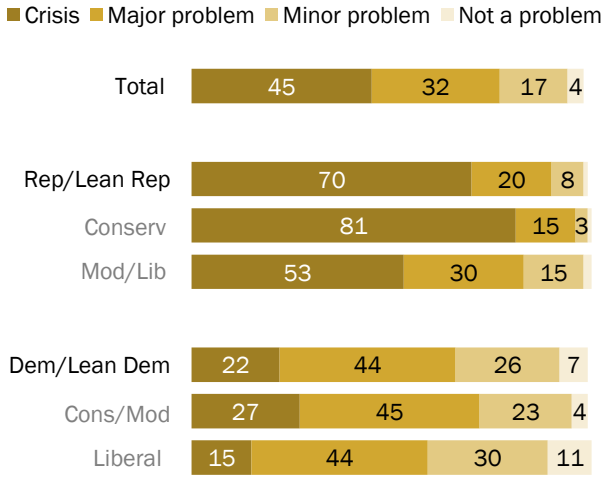
A sizable majority of Americans (78%) say the large number of migrants seeking to enter this country at the U.S.-Mexico border is either a crisis (45%) or a major problem (32%), according to the Pew Research Center survey, conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024, among 5,140 adults.

Related: *Migrant encounters at the U.S.-Mexico border hit a record high at the end of 2023.*

- Republicans are much more likely than Democrats to **describe the situation as a "crisis":** 70% of Republicans say this, compared with just 22% of Democrats.
- Democrats mostly **view the situation as a major problem** (44%) or minor problem (26%) for the U.S. Very few Democrats (7%) say it is not a problem.

Border situation viewed as a 'crisis' by most Republicans; Democrats are more likely to call it a 'problem'

% who say the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico is (a) ...



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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In an open-ended question, respondents voice their concerns about the migrant influx. They point to numerous issues, including worries about how the migrants are cared for and general problems with the immigration system.

Yet two concerns come up most frequently:

- 22% point to the **economic burdens** associated with the migrant influx, including the strains migrants place on social services and other government resources.

- 22% also cite **security concerns.** Many of these responses focus on crime (10%), terrorism (10%) and drugs (3%).

When asked specifically about the impact of the migrant influx on crime in the United States, a majority of Americans (57%) say **the large number of migrants seeking to enter the country leads to more crime.** Fewer (39%) say this does not have much of an impact on crime in this country.

Republicans (85%) overwhelmingly say the migrant surge leads to increased crime in the U.S. A far smaller share of Democrats (31%) say the same; 63% of Democrats instead say it does not have much of an impact.

Government widely criticized for its handling of migrant influx

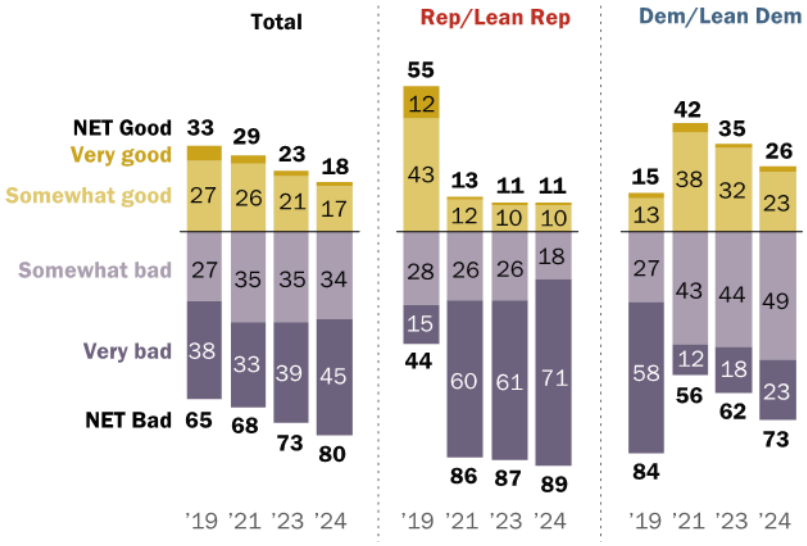
For the past several years, the federal government has gotten low ratings for its handling of the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border. *(Note: The wording of this question has been modified modestly to reflect circumstances at the time).*

However, the current ratings are extraordinarily low.

Just 18% say the U.S. government is doing a good job dealing with the large number of migrants at the border, while 80% say it is doing a bad job, including 45% who say it is doing a *very bad* job.

Only about a quarter of Democrats and even fewer Republicans say the government has done a good job dealing with large number of migrants at the border

% who say the U.S. government is doing a ___ job dealing with the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico



Note: No answer responses not shown. Surveys conducted in 2023 and prior were worded slightly differently than in 2024. Refer to the Topline for full question wording.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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- Republicans' views are overwhelmingly negative (89% say it's doing a bad job), as they have been since Joe Biden became president.

- 73% of Democrats also give the government negative ratings, the highest share recorded during Biden's presidency.

For more on Americans' evaluations of the situation, visit Chapter 1.

Which policies could improve the border situation?

There is no single policy proposal, among the nine included on the survey, that majorities of both Republicans and Democrats say would improve the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border. There are areas of *relative* agreement, however.

A 60% majority of Americans say that **increasing the number of immigration judges and staff in order to make decisions on asylum more quickly** would make the situation better. Only 11% say it would make things worse, while 14% think it would not make much difference.

Nearly as many (56%) say **creating more opportunities for people to legally immigrate to the U.S.** would make the situation better.

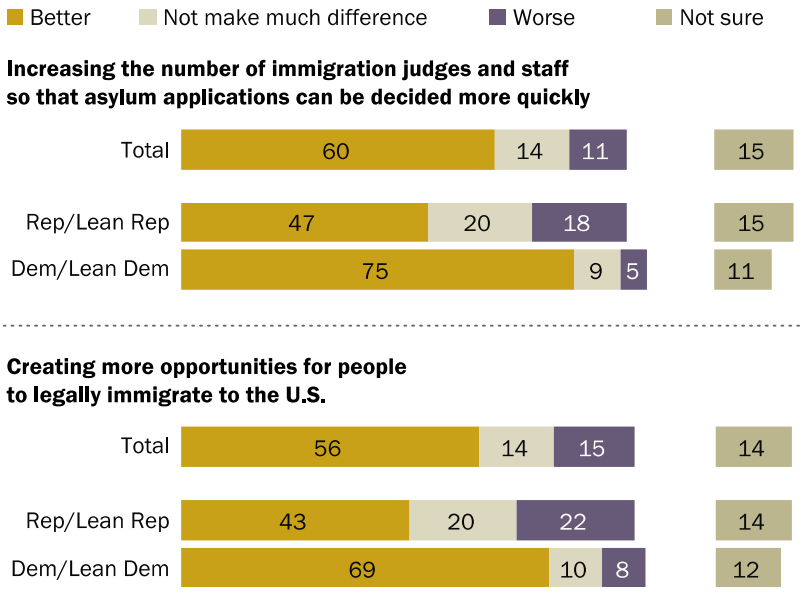
Majorities of Democrats say each of these proposals would make the border situation better.

Republicans are less positive than are Democrats; still, about 40% or more of Republicans say each would improve the situation, while far fewer say they would make things worse.

Opinions on other proposals are more polarized. For example, a 56% majority of Democrats say that **adding resources to provide safe and sanitary conditions for migrants arriving in the U.S.** would be a positive step forward.

Most Democrats and nearly half of Republicans say boosting resources for quicker decisions on asylum cases would improve situation at Mexico border

% who say each of the following proposals would make the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico ...



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Republicans not only are far less likely than Democrats to view this proposal positively, but far more say it would make the situation worse (43%) than better (17%).

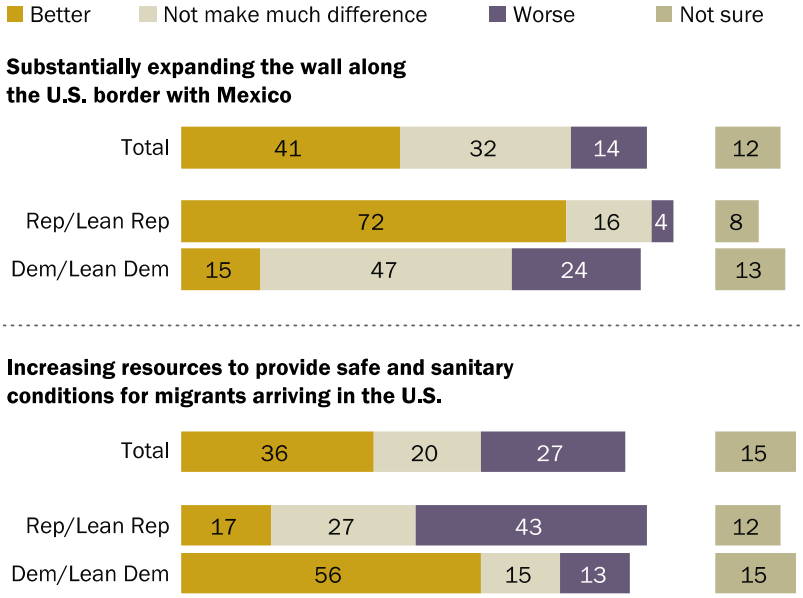
Building or expanding a wall along the U.S.-Mexico border was among the most divisive policies of Donald Trump's presidency. In 2019, 82% of Republicans favored expanding the border wall, compared with just 6% of Democrats.

Today, 72% of Republicans say **substantially expanding the wall along the U.S. border with Mexico** would make the situation better. Just 15% of Democrats concur, with most saying either it would not make much of a difference (47%) or it would make things worse (24%).

For more on Americans' reactions to policy proposals, visit Chapter 3.

Wide partisan gaps in views of expanding border wall, providing 'safe and sanitary conditions' for migrants

% who say each of the following proposals would make the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico ...



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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1. How Americans view the U.S.-Mexico border situation and the government's handling of the issue

Nearly all Americans say the large number of migrants seeking to enter the United States at the Mexican border is a problem. However, perceptions of the seriousness of the problem differ significantly:

- Most adults say the situation is either a *crisis* (45%) or a *major problem* (32%).
- Just 21% view it as a *minor problem* (17%) or *not a problem* (4%).

Views by age, race and ethnicity

Young adults are less likely than older people to say the situation at the border is a crisis. Only about a quarter (23%) of adults under 30 view it as a crisis, compared with 38% of those 30 to 49 and a 60% majority of adults ages 50 and older.

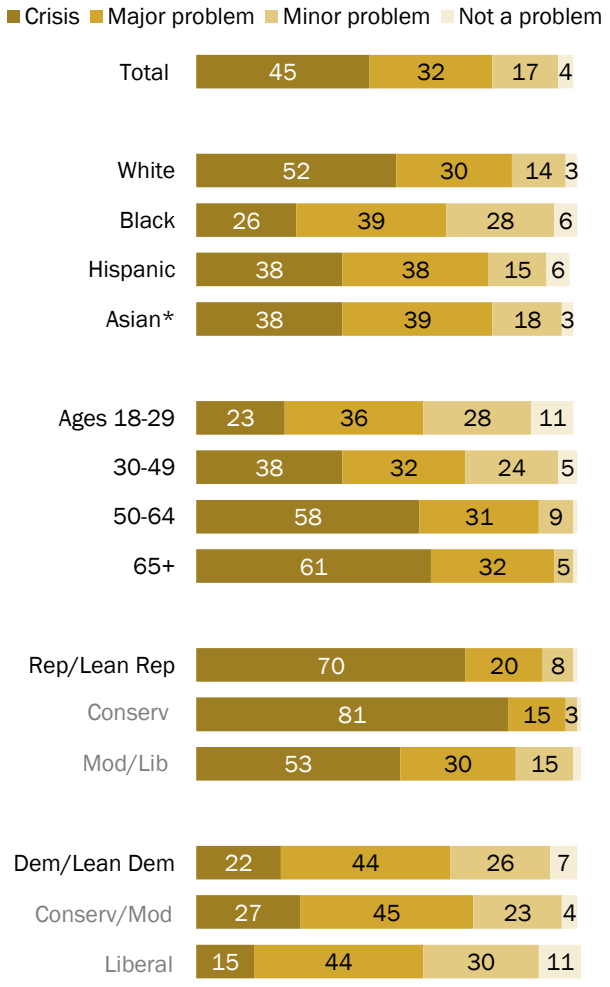
About half of White adults (52%) say the influx of migrants is a crisis, higher than the shares of Hispanic, Asian (38% each) and Black (26%) adults who say the same.

Views by partisanship, ideology

Republicans and Republican-leaning independents are far more likely than Democrats and Democratic leaners to say that the border situation is a crisis: 70% of Republicans describe it as a crisis, compared with 22% of Democrats.

Republicans, older adults more likely to view border situation as a 'crisis'

% who say the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico is (a) ...



* Asian adults interviewed in English only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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More Democrats, by contrast, view it as a major problem (44% vs. 20% of Republicans). And while a third of Democrats say the border situation is a minor problem or not a problem, just 9% of Republicans say the same.

Ideological differences are wider within the GOP. A sizable majority of conservative Republicans (81%) say the large number of migrants at the border seeking to enter the U.S. represents a crisis. About half of moderate and liberal Republicans (53%) say the same.

Democrats' differences are more modest. However, 41% of liberal Democrats say the border situation is a minor problem or not a problem, compared with 27% of moderate Democrats.

How is the U.S. government doing in handling the situation at the border?

As has been the case for the last few years, Americans express very negative views of the government's handling of the border situation:

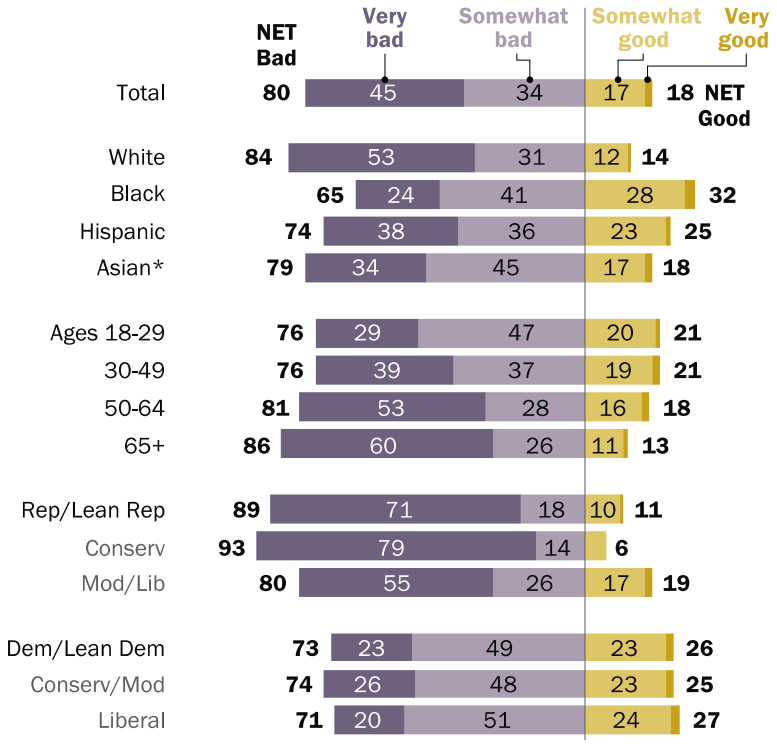
- 80% say the government is doing a very or somewhat bad job of dealing with the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S – including 45% who say it's doing a *very* bad job.
- Just 18% have a positive view of the government's handling of the situation.

Both partisan coalitions are broadly dissatisfied with the government's handling of the border situation.

About nine-in-ten (89%) Republicans say the government is doing a bad job, including 71% who say it is doing *very* badly. Nearly three-quarters (73%) of Democrats also rate the government's performance negatively.

Large majorities in both parties express negative views of the U.S. govt.'s handling of border situation

% who say the U.S. government is doing a ___ job dealing with the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico



* Asian adults interviewed in English only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Large majorities across age categories and all racial and ethnic groups say the government is doing a bad job dealing with the migrant situation at the U.S.-Mexico border.

Wide age, partisan differences in attention to border situation

Republicans are much more interested than Democrats in news about the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border.

- 43% of Republicans say they are following news about the border situation extremely or very closely, compared with 20% of Democrats.
- Conservative Republicans are especially interested in news about the border: 51% say they are following this news extremely or very closely while only 28% of moderate and liberal Republicans say the same.

Age differences

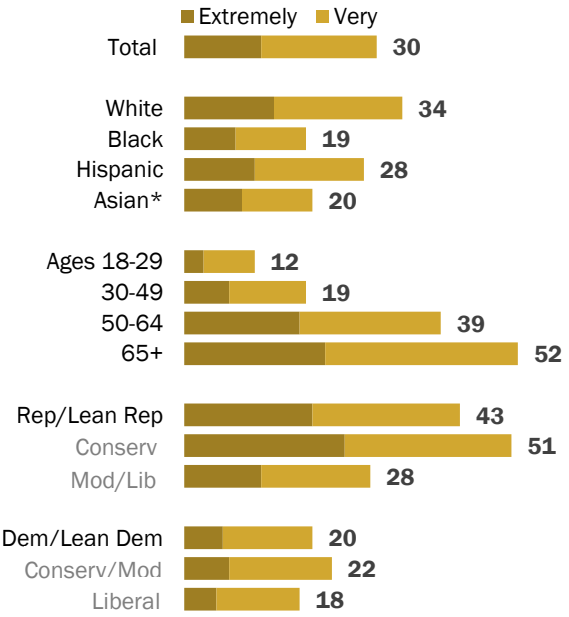
Young adults are far less engaged with news about the U.S.-Mexico border than are older people.

Just 12% of adults under 30 say they are following this news extremely or very closely; another 30% say they are following somewhat closely. A majority of young adults (57%) follow news about the border not too or not at all closely.

Interest is higher among older age groups: 45% of adults ages 50 and older are following news about the border extremely or very closely.

About twice as many Republicans as Democrats are following news about border extremely or very closely

% who say they have been following news about the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico __ closely



* Asian adults interviewed in English only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Does the migration surge have an impact on crime in the U.S.?

Republicans and Democrats have very different views about whether the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. has an impact on crime in the country.

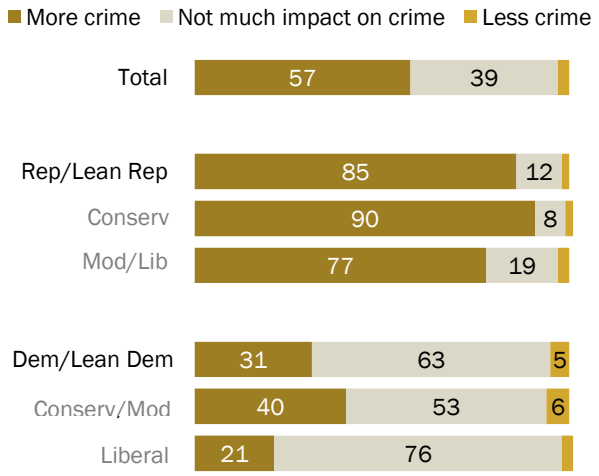
Republicans and Republican leaners overwhelmingly say the large number of migrants trying to enter the country is leading to more crime in the country: 85% say this, including 90% of conservative Republicans and 77% of moderate and liberal Republicans.

By comparison, a far smaller share of Democrats – 31% – say crime is increasing because of the migrant surge. Most Democrats (63%) say the number of migrants trying to enter the U.S. at the border doesn't have much effect on crime.

Moderate and conservative Democrats are more likely than liberals to say the number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. is leading to more crime (40% vs. 21%). Still, majorities in both groups say there isn't much relationship between the migrants and crime in the U.S.

Wide partisan gap over the impact of migrant situation on crime in the U.S.

% who say the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. is leading to __ in U.S.



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Few in either party (just 5% of Democrats and 2% of Republicans) say the migrant situation at the border is leading to *less* crime in the U.S.

How demographic groups view the relationship between the border surge and crime

Partisanship is, by far, the strongest predictor of whether someone thinks there is a relationship between the migration surge and crime in the U.S.

But there are also some differences in these views by age, race and education, even after accounting for partisanship.

Race and ethnicity

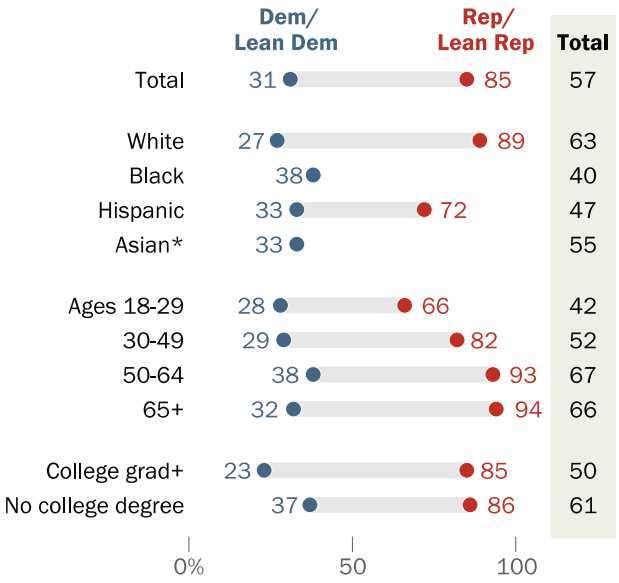
Overall, White and Asian Americans are more likely than Hispanic and Black Americans to say that the migrant surge is leading to increased crime in the U.S.

- Majorities of both White and Hispanic Republicans say the number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. is contributing to crime in the country, but this view is more widespread among White Republicans (89%) than Hispanic Republicans (72%). *(There is insufficient sample size of Black and Asian Republicans to separately report these views.)*

- Most Democrats – across racial and ethnic groups – do not think the migration situation is leading to more crime in the U.S. But Black Democrats (38%) are more likely than White Democrats (27%) to say that it is.

Differences by age, race, education in views of whether migrant situation at border is leading to more crime in U.S.

% who say the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. is leading to ***more crime in the U.S.***



* Asian adults were interviewed in English only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race. Insufficient sample sizes of Black and Asian Republicans to separately report. No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Age

Overall, younger adults are far less likely than older adults to say the migration situation is resulting in more crime.

This gap is particularly pronounced among Republicans: 66% of Republicans under 30 say the migration surge is leading to more crime, compared with 82% of those ages 30 to 49 and 93% of those 50 and older.

By comparison, there is a narrower age gap among Democrats: 28% of those under 50 and 35% of those 50 and older say crime is increasing due to the migrant situation.

Education

Overall, those with a bachelor's degree or more education are 11 percentage points less likely than those with less formal education to say crime in the U.S. has increased because of the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border.

There are no significant differences among Republicans by education. But Democrats without a bachelor's degree (37%) are more likely than those with a degree (23%) to say the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. is leading to more crime.

2. What Americans say is causing a migration surge at the U.S.-Mexico border

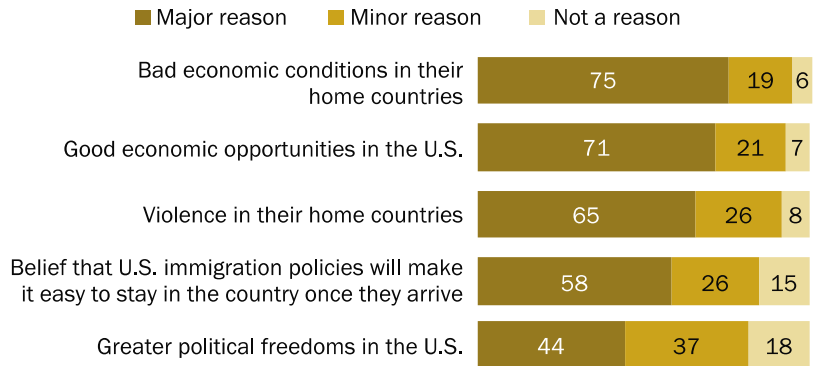
Americans see several factors as reasons why there are so many people seeking to migrate to the United States at the southwestern border.

Large bipartisan majorities point to economic factors as major reasons for the surge, with 75% of Americans saying bad economic conditions in migrants' home countries are a major reason, and 71% saying the same about *good* economic opportunities in the U.S.

Smaller majorities also say violence in migrants' home countries (65%), and migrants' belief that U.S. policies allow for them to easily stay once they arrive (58%) are major factors. But there are wide partisan differences in views about the importance of these two factors.

Economic factors widely seen as reasons why there are many migrants at the U.S.-Mexico border

% who say each of the following is (a) ___ for why a large number of migrants are seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Less than half of adults (44%) view greater political freedoms in the U.S. as a major reason for why people are seeking to migrate to the U.S.

Very few Americans say any of these factors is not a reason at all – fewer than two-in-ten say this about any of the five reasons asked about in the survey.

Republican, Democratic views of the reasons for the migration surge

U.S. immigration policy

Roughly three-quarters of Republicans and GOP leaners (76%) point to a belief among migrants that U.S. immigration policies will make it easy to stay in the country as a major reason for the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border. Of the five reasons asked about in this survey, this ranks highest among Republicans.

By contrast, a far smaller share of Democrats (39%) point to this as a major reason for the large number of migrants seeking to enter at the U.S.-Mexico border. It is the lowest-ranked item among Democrats.

Still, an additional 39% of Democrats say this is a minor reason. Another 21% say it is not a reason (compared with just 7% of Republicans).

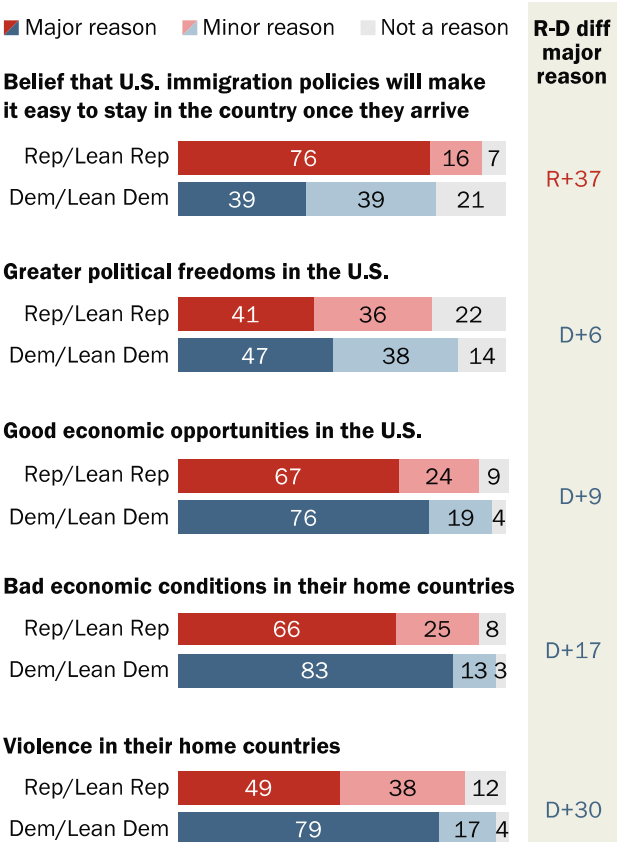
Violence in home countries

Nearly eight-in-ten Democrats (79%) say violence in migrants' home countries is a major reason for the number of migrants at the U.S.-Mexico border. This is among the top reasons (alongside economic factors) Democrats see for the migration surge.

Republicans are far less likely to see this as a major factor for the surge in migrants, though about half (49%) say that it is.

Wide partisan gaps over the role of home country violence, U.S. policy in migrant surge

% who say each of the following is (a) ___ for why a large number of migrants are seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Economic factors

Large majorities in both parties identify good economic opportunities in the U.S. and bad economic conditions in migrants' home countries as major reasons for the migrant situation at the border.

Democrats are slightly more likely than Republicans to say each of these are major reasons.

Political freedoms

About four-in-ten Republicans (41%) and nearly half of Democrats (47%) view greater political freedoms in the U.S. as a major reason for why large numbers of people are seeking to migrate to the U.S. at the southwestern border. More than a third in both parties view this as a minor reason.

Conservative Republicans, liberal Democrats diverge on reasons for the migrant surge

Conservative Republicans (81%) overwhelming say that migrants' beliefs that U.S. policy will make it easy to stay in the country once they arrive is a major reason for the large number of migrants at the U.S.-Mexico border.

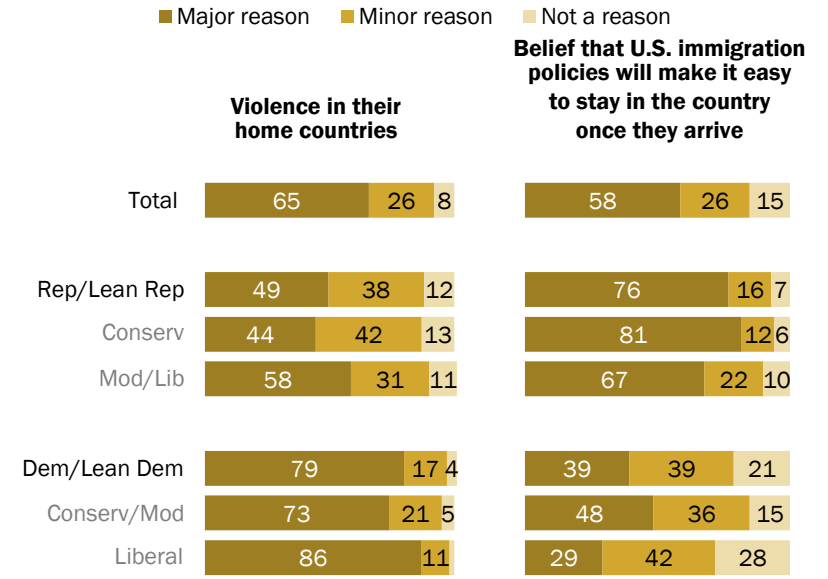
A smaller – though still substantial – majority of moderate and liberal Republicans (67%) also see this as a major reason for the buildup of migrants.

But Democrats – particularly liberal Democrats – are not nearly as likely to see the belief that U.S. immigration policy is loose as a factor. Just 29% of liberal Democrats say it is a major reason why migrants are seeking to enter, while another 42% say it is a minor factor. Nearly three-in-ten (28%) say this is not a reason at all.

By comparison, more than eight-in-ten liberal Democrats point to violence in the countries migrants are coming from as a major reason for their migration.

Partisans point to different factors for why there is a large influx of migrants at the border with Mexico

How much of a reason is each of the following for why a large number of migrants are seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico? (%)



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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About three-quarters of conservative and moderate Democrats (73%), and roughly six-in-ten moderate and liberal Republicans (58%) also view violence as a major factor behind why migrants are coming to the U.S.

But conservative Republicans are less likely to see this as a significant contributing factor: 44% say it is a major reason why migrants at the southwest border seek to enter the U.S., while another 42% say it is a minor reason.

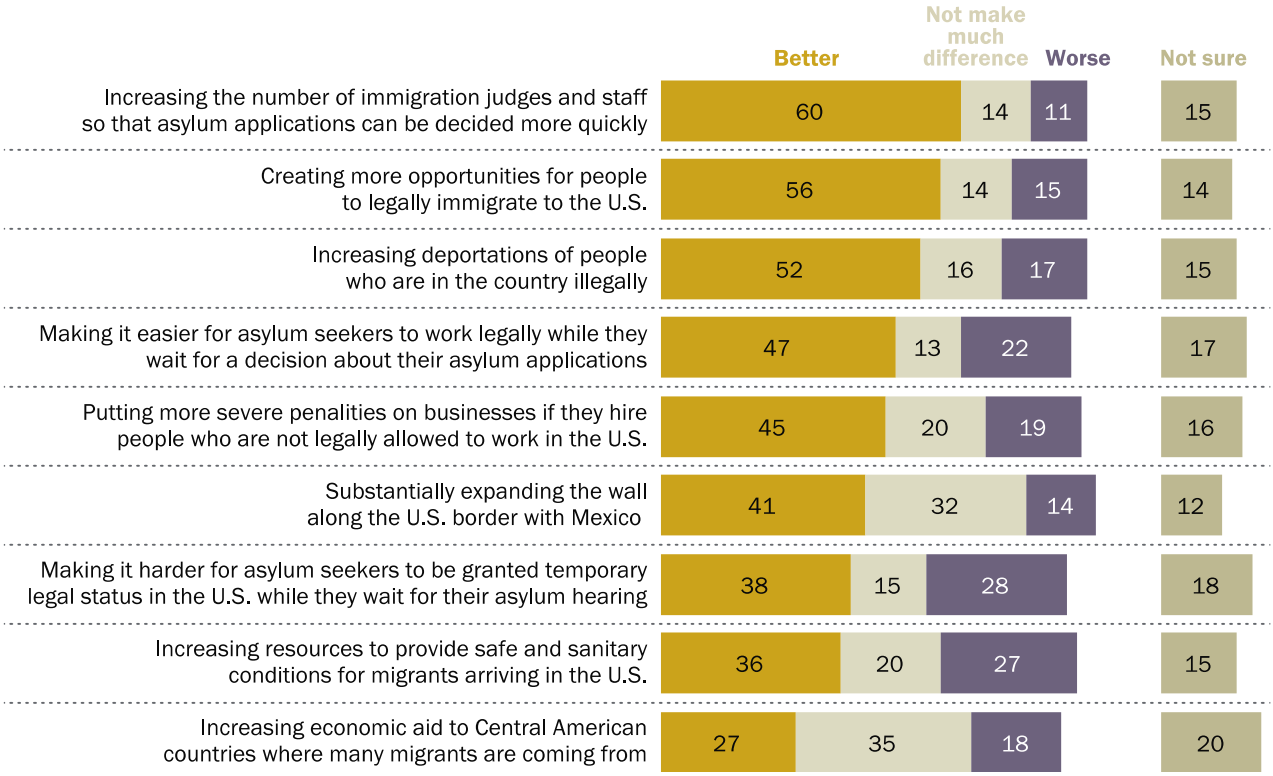
3. What would improve the U.S. immigration system?

When asked about policies that might address the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border, **several are seen by large shares of the public as ways to improve the situation:**

Half or more say increasing the number of judges to process asylum applications (60%), creating more opportunities for people to legally immigrate (56%), and increasing deportations of people who are in the country illegally (52%) would make the situation better. Fewer than two-in-ten Americans say any of these proposals would make the situation worse.

Majority of Americans say more asylum judges would help situation at border; substantial shares say several other proposals would also be effective

% who say each of the following proposals would make the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico ...



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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The public is less likely to say various other immigration proposals would make the situation better. **But by wide margins, Americans think several are more likely to improve than worsen the situation at the border:**

- 47% of Americans say making it easier for asylum seekers to work legally while they wait for a decision about their applications would make the situation better. Just 22% say this would make things worse.

- 45% say putting more severe penalties on businesses if they hire people who are not legally allowed to work in the U.S. would lead to an improvement. Only 19% say it would worsen the situation.

Public views are more mixed about the remaining four policy proposals included in the survey:

- When it comes to substantially expanding the wall along the U.S.-Mexico border, 41% say it would make things better, but 32% say it would not make a difference either way. A smaller share of adults (14%) say it would make things worse, and 12% are not sure.

- 38% of Americans say making it harder for asylum seekers to be granted temporary legal status would make the situation better, but 28% say this proposal would make things *worse*. Nearly two-in-ten say they aren't sure what impact this would have on immigration, while 15% say it wouldn't change things.

- 36% say making sure that asylum seekers have safe and sanitary conditions when they arrive to the U.S. would make the situation better, while 27% say it would make things worse. Two-in-ten say it would not make much difference.

- A 35% plurality of adults say that increasing economic aid to Central American countries would not have much of an impact on the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border. About a quarter (27%) say it would make things better, while 18% say it would make things worse.

Republican and Democratic views of immigration policy proposals

While there are a few immigration proposals where sizable shares of Republicans and Democrats see potential for improving the border situation, on most policies, there are wide partisan gaps.

Policies to address asylum seekers and the immediate situation at the border

Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents are more likely than Republicans and GOP leaners to say that increasing various resources at the border would make the immediate situation *better*. However, some of the partisan differences on these policies are wider than others.

Additional immigration judges

For example, three-quarters of Democrats say that increasing the number of judges and staff to process asylum applications would improve the situation at the border.

Republicans are less positive about the potential impact of more judges. Still, 47% say this would make things better, and just 18% say it would worsen the situation.

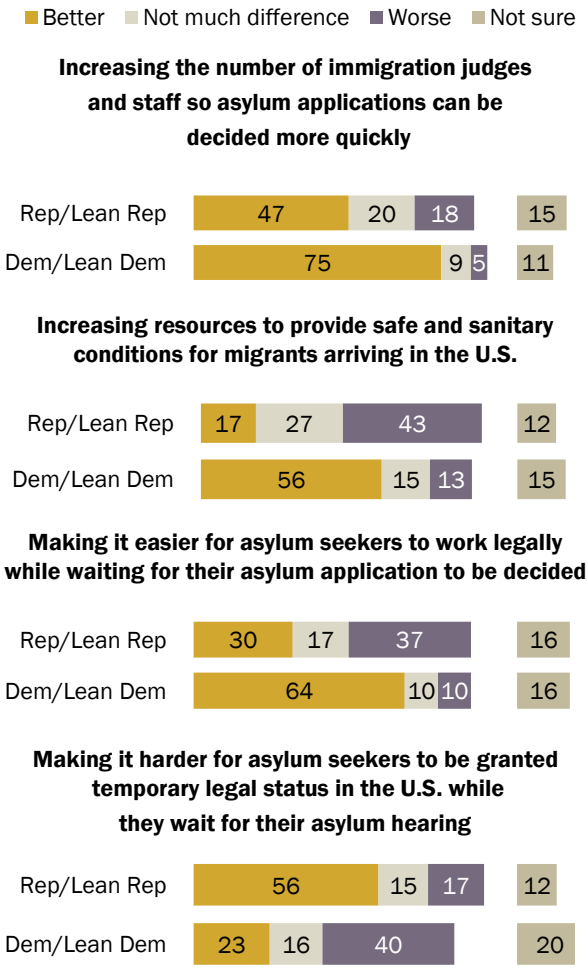
Resources to provide safe and sanitary conditions for migrants

When it comes to increasing resources to provide safe and sanitary conditions for migrants arriving at the border, a majority of Democrats (56%) say this would make things better.

But Republicans are more than twice as likely to say it would make things *worse* as they are to say it would improve things (43% vs. 17%).

Partisans see different solutions for handling situation at U.S.-Mexico border

% who say each of the following proposals would make the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico ...



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Temporary legal status and work eligibility for asylum seekers

Partisans take different positions on policies aimed at easing or restricting the ability of migrants to get temporary legal status, including work eligibility, while they wait for the next steps in their asylum applications.

For example, about two-thirds of Democrats say that making it *easier* for asylum seekers to work legally while they wait for a decision on their applications would improve the border situation. Just three-in-ten Republicans say the same. Slightly more Republicans instead say this policy would make things *worse* (37%).

The pattern is reversed for a policy that would make it *harder* for asylum seekers to be granted temporary legal status before their asylum hearing. A 56% majority of Republicans say this would make things better, while just 23% of Democrats agree. Democrats are far more likely to say this would make the border situation *worse* (40%).

Proposals to deport those in the U.S. illegally, expand the border wall

Republicans are far more likely than Democrats to say that increasing deportations and substantially expanding the wall along the U.S. border with Mexico would improve the situation.

Deportations

Nearly eight-in-ten Republicans (77%) say that increasing deportations of people who are in the country illegally would make the situation at the border better. Just 6% say that it would make things worse and 9% say it would not make much difference.

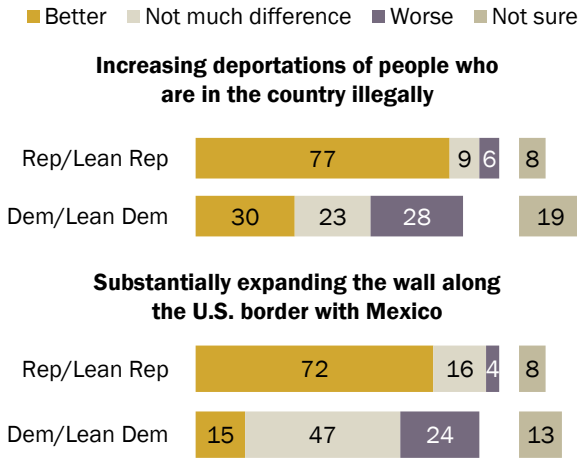
Democrats are far more divided on this proposal: 30% say increasing deportations would make things better, while a nearly identical share (28%) say it would make things *worse*. About a quarter (23%) say it would not make much difference, while 19% say they aren't sure what impact it would have.

Border wall

There is a similar pattern in views of expanding the border wall. Nearly three-quarters of Republicans say expanding the wall would make the situation at the border *better*.

Most Republicans say expanding wall, increasing deportations will improve the migrant situation at the border

% who say each of the following proposals would make the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico ...



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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In contrast, just 15% of Democrats say expanding the wall would improve the situation. About half (47%) say it would not have much of an impact, while about a quarter say it would make things *worse* (24%).

Proposals to address economic drivers of migration

Opinions are mixed when it comes to two policy proposals that aim to address potential economic drivers of immigration to the United States.

Severe penalties on businesses for hiring people who do not have legal work status

About six-in-ten Republicans (63%) say that putting penalties on businesses for hiring people who are not eligible to work in the U.S. would make the immigration situation better.

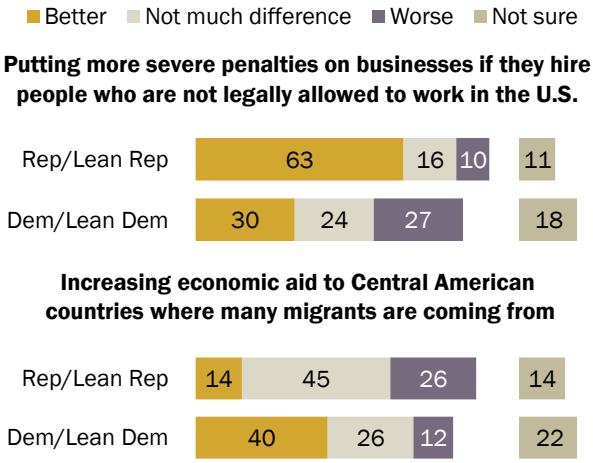
But Democrats are divided on this policy. They are about as likely to say severe business penalties would make things better (30%) as they are to say this would make things worse (27%). Another 24% say this proposal would not make much difference, and 18% say they are not sure.

More economic aid to countries migrants are coming from

But Republicans are far less likely than Democrats to say that increasing economic aid to Central American countries – where many migrants come from – would make the situation better.

Would more penalties for hiring people without legal status, aid to Central America improve the border situation?

% who say each of the following proposals would make the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico ...



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Just 14% of Republicans say this would improve the situation, while 26% say it would make it worse. And 45% say that increased foreign aid would not make much difference either way.

By a margin of about 3-1, Democrats say this policy would make things better: 40% say it would improve the situation, while 12% say it would make things worse. About a quarter (26%) say it would not make a difference, and nearly as many (22%) say they aren't sure.

Creating more opportunities for legal immigration

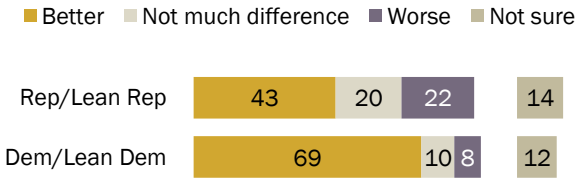
A majority of Democrats (69%), and a smaller but sizable share of Republicans (43%), say that creating more opportunities for people to legally immigrate to the U.S. would improve the current border situation.

Few Democrats say creating more legal options for migrants would make the border situation *worse* (8%) or that it would not have much of an impact (10%).

Republicans are more divided than Democrats, but nearly twice as many in the GOP say creating more legal opportunities for migrants would make things *better* (43%) rather than worse (22%). About two-in-ten say this would not make much of a difference.

Relatively large shares in both parties say more legal immigration options would make border situation better

*% who say **creating more opportunities for people to legally immigrate to the U.S.** would make the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico ...*



Note: No answer responses not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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4. In their own words: Americans' concerns, feelings about U.S.-Mexico border situation

When asked in an open-ended question about their top concerns regarding the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico, the most commonly cited concerns relate either to the **economic costs and burdens associated with the migration surge or concerns about security** (22% of concerns fall into each of these categories).

About one-in-ten adults (11%) express **concern for migrants' safety and treatment.** Smaller shares raise other concerns.

Economic burdens

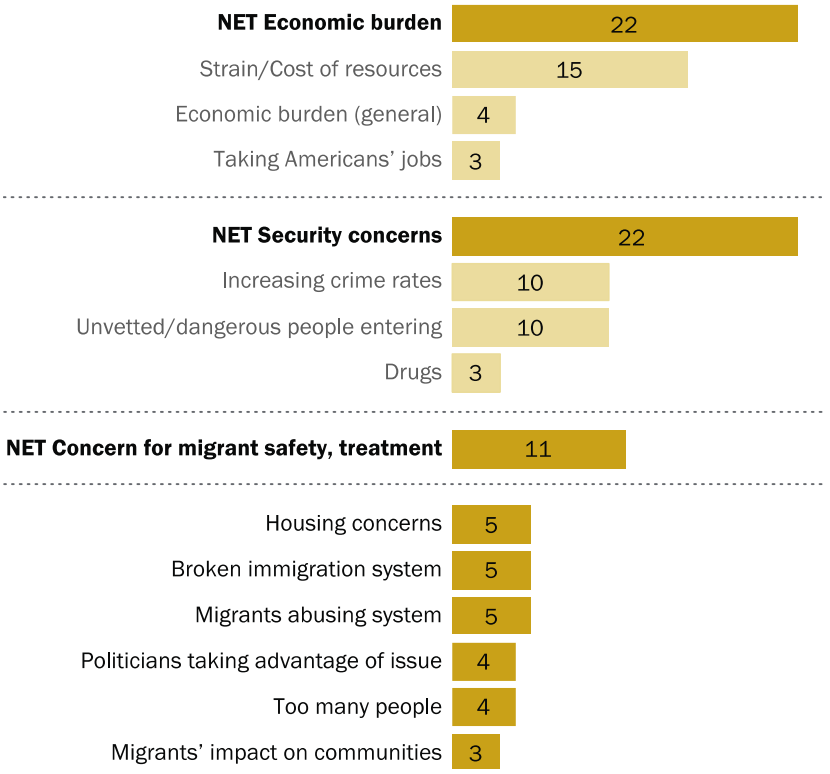
- Those that express economic concerns mainly mention strains on health care services and welfare. Some also point to the unfair impact on American taxpayers.
- 3% offer that they are concerned about migrants taking jobs from Americans.

Security concerns

- 10% say they are concerned about increasing crime rates, while an identical share mention the possibility of criminals or terrorists entering the country due to insufficient vetting.

Americans commonly cite economic, security concerns over situation at U.S. border with Mexico

What is your top concern, if any, about the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico? (%) ***[open-end]***



Note: Researchers coded up to three responses. Responses that were given by fewer than 3% of respondents not shown. Refer to the Topline for full details. Numbers may exceed 100% due to multiple responses. 64% of respondents who received this question provided a response.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Migrant safety, treatment

- Among the 11% of adults who say migrants' treatment is their top concern, 3% each cite poor conditions for those arriving at the U.S. border or concern for their safety . And 1% mention migrants' general well-being.

Other major concerns

- Other concerns mentioned by Americans included logistical concerns about where to house migrants (5%) and belief that migrants are abusing the system (5%).

- 4% remark that the sheer volume of migrants attempting to enter the U.S. is a major concern, while 5% offer more broadly that the immigration and asylum systems are broken.

Partisans differ in their concerns about influx of migrants at U.S.-Mexico border

Republicans and Democrats mention different considerations when asked about their top concerns related to the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border.

Republicans are more likely than Democrats to mention issues related to the economy or border security. Democrats are more likely to express concerns about migrants' safety and wellbeing.

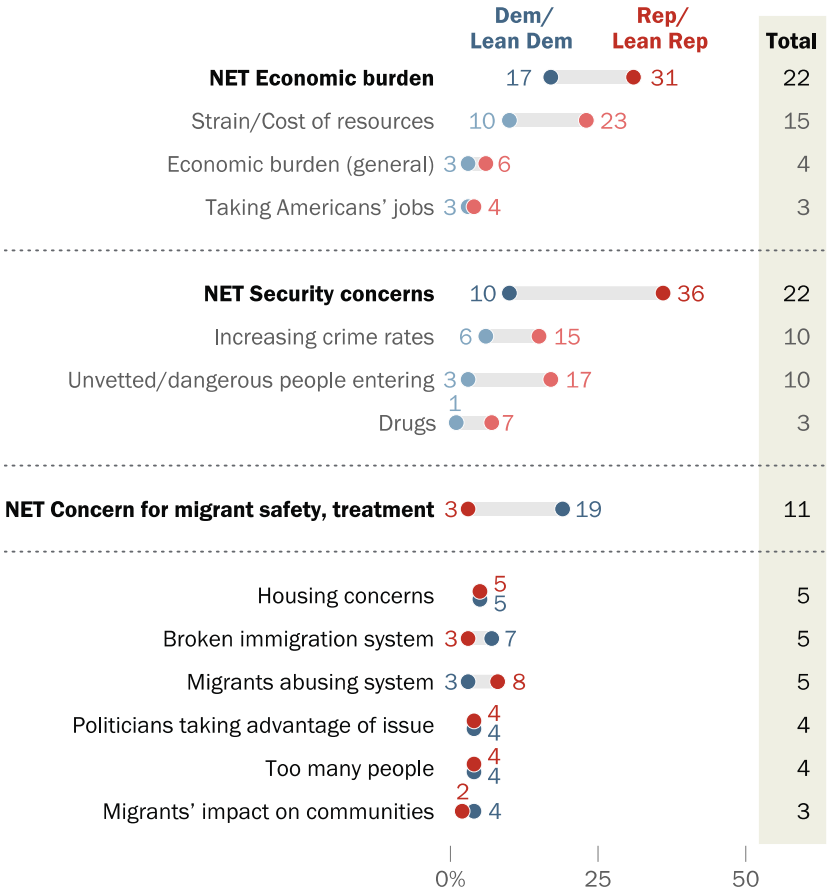
Among Republicans – who are more likely to offer a response to this question than Democrats – concerns about security are mentioned frequently (36%). Democrats are far less likely to cite a security concern (10%).

There is a somewhat smaller partisan gap in how often concerns about economic costs related to an influx of migrants come up: 31% of Republicans mention concerns related to the economy, as do 17% of Democrats.

Democrats are far more likely than Republicans to say their top concern is for the treatment, security and well-being of migrants attempting to enter the U.S. (19% vs. 3%, respectively).

Republicans, Democrats have differing top concerns about the migration surge at the U.S.-Mexico border

*What is your top concern, if any, about the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico? (%) [**open-end**]*



Note: Researchers coded up to three responses. Responses that were given by fewer than 3% of respondents among adults overall not shown. Refer to the Topline for full details. Numbers may exceed 100% due to multiple responses. 64% of respondents who received this question provided a response (70% of Rep/Lean Rep and 62% of Dem/Lean Dem). Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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What else do Americans want to share about their views on immigration?

In a separate open-ended question – which asked Americans to write any other thoughts they had about immigration – 45% offered a response while more than half skipped the question. Republicans were more likely than Democrats to take this opportunity to share additional thoughts (55% vs. 37%, respectively).

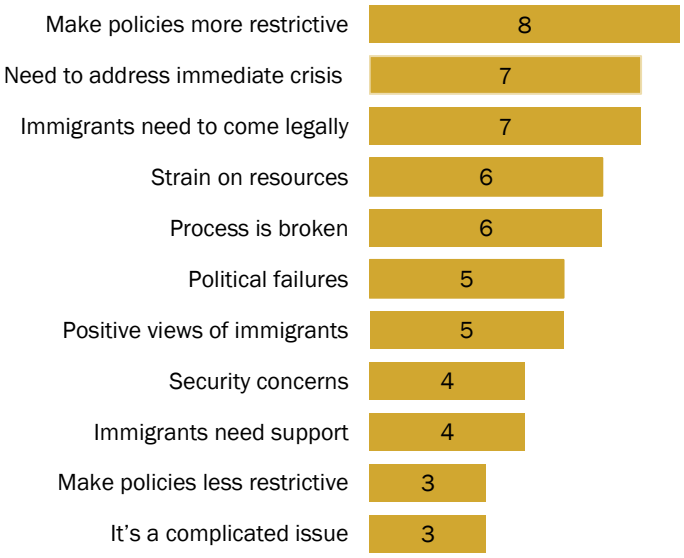
These responses vary widely, with many people mentioning multiple considerations in their responses.

For example, one respondent says, "It would be great if we could take everyone in, but we can't. The border needs to be secure and securing it a top priority. Those arriving at the border attempting to cross must be treated with care and compassion and a bipartisan solution needs to be found."

Some mention a **desire for immigration policies to be more restrictive** (8%), often citing concerns about the volume of people attempting to enter or the need for more selectivity about who is allowed to stay.

In their own words: Americans share their thoughts about immigration

*What other thoughts about immigration would you like to share? (%) **[open-end]***



Note: Researchers coded up to three responses. Responses that were given by fewer than 3% of respondents not shown. Refer to the Topline for full details. 45% of respondents who received this question provided a response.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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- One person offers that "we need to slam the door on immigration now just to give us time to develop a proper and competent system for dealing with it, because we don't have that now."

A similar share writes about **the need to address the immediate crisis through additional resources to border states or taking steps to secure the border more generally** (7%).

- One person responds: "[We] need to secure the border and increase budgets for customs to process these migrants properly. They can work if they pay taxes and go through [the] system to become citizens. But we need to overhaul the system first."

Others take the opportunity to share their own **positive views of immigrants** (5%) or mention the need for support for migrants (4%).

- One person writes, "Immigrants are an essential part of the United States' history and future. Politicians and the media have made them out to be villains, but they are a part of the U.S. fabric."

- From another respondent: "America should be honored that so many people want to come here. We should do what we can to support and foster immigrants' integration into American society."

Sizable shares talk about how **the system overall is broken and needs fixing** (6%) or that **politicians purposefully use the issue to gain partisan advantage** (5%).

- One person writes, "Congress has been kicking the can down the road for years. No one group wants to lose political capital by actually doing something concrete and credible with this issue."

Acknowledgments

This report is a collaborative effort based on the input and analysis of the following individuals:

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Methodology

The American Trends Panel survey methodology

Overview

The American Trends Panel (ATP), created by Pew Research Center, is a nationally representative panel of randomly selected U.S. adults. Panelists participate via self-administered web surveys. Panelists who do not have internet access at home are provided with a tablet and wireless internet connection. Interviews are conducted in both English and Spanish. The panel is being managed by Ipsos.

Data in this report is drawn from ATP Wave 140, conducted from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024, and includes an oversample of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men, and Hispanic men in order to provide more precise estimates of the opinions and experiences of these smaller demographic subgroups. These oversampled groups are weighted back to reflect their correct proportions in the population. A total of 5,140 panelists responded out of 5,604 who were sampled, for a response rate of 92%. The cumulative response rate accounting for nonresponse to the recruitment surveys and attrition is 3%. The break-off rate among panelists who logged on to the survey and completed at least one item is less than 1%. The margin of sampling error for the full sample of 5,140 respondents is plus or minus 1.7 percentage points.

Panel recruitment

The ATP was created in 2014, with the first cohort of panelists invited to join the panel at the end of a large, national, landline and cellphone random-digit-dial survey that was conducted in both English and Spanish. Two additional recruitments were conducted using the same method in 2015 and 2017, respectively. Across these three surveys, a total of 19,718 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 9,942 (50%) agreed to participate.

In August 2018, the ATP switched from telephone to address-based sampling (ABS) recruitment. A study cover letter and a pre-incentive are mailed to a stratified, random sample of households selected from the U.S. Postal Service's Delivery Sequence File. This Postal Service file has been estimated to cover as much as 98% of the population, although some studies suggest that the coverage could be in the low 90% range.[1] Within each sampled household, the adult with the next

[1] AAPOR Task Force on Address-based Sampling. 2016. "AAPOR Report: Address-based Sampling."

birthday is asked to participate. Other details of the ABS recruitment protocol have changed over time but are available upon request.[2]

We have recruited a national sample of U.S. adults to the ATP approximately once per year since 2014. In some years, the recruitment has included additional efforts (known as an "oversample") to boost sample size with underrepresented groups. For example, Hispanic adults, Black adults and Asian adults were oversampled in 2019, 2022 and 2023, respectively.

American Trends Panel recruitment surveys

Recruitment dates	Mode	Invited	Joined	Active panelists remaining
Jan. 23 to March 16, 2014	Landline/ cell RDD	9,809	5,338	1,393
Aug. 27 to Oct. 4, 2015	Landline/ cell RDD	6,004	2,976	831
April 25 to June 4, 2017	Landline/ cell RDD	3,905	1,628	405
Aug. 8 to Oct. 31, 2018	ABS	9,396	8,778	3,850
Aug. 19 to Nov. 30, 2019	ABS	5,900	4,720	1,388
June 1 to July 19, 2020; Feb. 10 to March 31, 2021	ABS	3,197	2,812	1,441
May 29 to July 7, 2021; Sept. 16 to Nov. 1, 2021	ABS	1,329	1,162	731
May 24 to Sept. 29, 2022	ABS	3,354	2,869	1,457
April 17 to May 30, 2023	ABS	686	576	435
	Total	**43,580**	**30,859**	**11,931**

Note: RDD is random-digit dial; ABS is address-based sampling. Approximately once per year, panelists who have not participated in multiple consecutive waves or who did not complete an annual profiling survey are removed from the panel. Panelists also become inactive if they ask to be removed from the panel.

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Across the six address-based recruitments, a total of 23,862 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 20,917 agreed to join the panel and completed an initial profile survey. Of the 30,859 individuals who have ever joined the ATP, 11,931 remained active panelists and continued to receive survey invitations at the time this survey was conducted.

The American Trends Panel never uses breakout routers or chains that direct respondents to additional surveys.

Sample design

The overall target population for this survey was noninstitutionalized persons ages 18 and older living in the U.S., including Alaska and Hawaii. It featured a stratified random sample from the ATP in which Hispanic men, non-Hispanic Black men and non-Hispanic Asian adults were selected with certainty. The remaining panelists were sampled at rates designed to ensure that the share of respondents in each stratum is proportional to its share of the U.S. adult population to the

[2] Email pewsurveys@pewresearch.org.

greatest extent possible. Respondent weights are adjusted to account for differential probabilities of selection as described in the Weighting section below.

Questionnaire development and testing

The questionnaire was developed by Pew Research Center in consultation with Ipsos. The web program was rigorously tested on both PC and mobile devices by the Ipsos project management team and Pew Research Center researchers. The Ipsos project management team also populated test data that was analyzed in SPSS to ensure the logic and randomizations were working as intended before launching the survey.

Incentives

All respondents were offered a post-paid incentive for their participation. Respondents could choose to receive the post-paid incentive in the form of a check or a gift code to Amazon.com or could choose to decline the incentive. Incentive amounts ranged from $5 to $20 depending on whether the respondent belongs to a part of the population that is harder or easier to reach. Differential incentive amounts were designed to increase panel survey participation among groups that traditionally have low survey response propensities.

Data collection protocol

The data collection field period for this survey was Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Postcard notifications were mailed to a subset of sampled ATP panelists[3] with a known residential address on Jan. 16.

Invitations were sent out in two separate launches: soft launch and full launch. Sixty panelists were included in the soft launch, which began with an initial invitation sent on Jan. 16. The ATP panelists chosen for the initial soft launch were known responders who had completed previous ATP surveys within one day of receiving their invitation. All remaining English- and Spanish-speaking sampled panelists were included in the full launch and were sent an invitation on Jan. 17.

All panelists with an email address received an email invitation and up to two email reminders if they did not respond to the survey. All ATP panelists who consented to SMS messages received an SMS invitation and up to two SMS reminders.

[3] Postcards notifications are sent to 1) panelists who have been provided with a tablet to take ATP surveys, 2) panelists who were recruited within the last two years, and 3) panelists recruited prior to the last two years who opt to continue receiving postcard notifications.

Invitation and reminder dates, ATP Wave 140

	Soft launch	Full launch
Initial invitation	January 16, 2024	January 17, 2024
First reminder	January 18, 2024	January 18, 2024
Final reminder	January 20 2024	January 20, 2024

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Data quality checks

To ensure high-quality data, the Center's researchers performed data quality checks to identify any respondents showing clear patterns of satisficing. This includes checking for whether respondents left questions blank at very high rates or always selected the first or last answer presented. As a result of this checking, four ATP respondents were removed from the survey dataset prior to weighting and analysis.

Weighting

The ATP data is weighted in a multistep process that accounts for multiple stages of sampling and nonresponse that occur at different points in the survey process. First, each panelist begins with a base weight that reflects their probability of selection for their initial recruitment survey. These weights are then rescaled and adjusted to account for changes in the design of ATP recruitment surveys from year to year. Finally, the weights are calibrated to align with the population benchmarks in the accompanying table to correct for nonresponse to recruitment surveys and panel attrition. If only a subsample of panelists was invited to participate in the wave, this weight is adjusted to account for any differential probabilities of selection.

American Trends Panel weighting dimensions

Variable	Benchmark source
Age (detailed) Age x Gender Education x Gender Education x Age Race/Ethnicity x Education Black (alone or in combination) x Hispanic Born inside vs. outside the U.S. among Hispanics and Asian Americans Years lived in the U.S. Census region x Metropolitan status	2022 American Community Survey (ACS)
Volunteerism	2021 CPS Volunteering & Civic Life Supplement
Voter registration	2022 CPS Voting and Registration Supplement
Party affiliation x Race/Ethnicity Frequency of internet use Religious affiliation	2023 National Public Opinion Reference Survey (NPORS)

Note: Estimates from the ACS are based on noninstitutionalized adults. Voter registration is calculated using procedures from Hur, Achen (2013) and rescaled to include the total U.S. adult population.

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Among the panelists who completed the survey, this weight is then calibrated again to align with the population benchmarks identified in the accompanying table and trimmed at the 2nd and 98th percentiles to reduce the loss in precision stemming from variance in the weights. This trimming is performed separately among non-Hispanic Black, non-Hispanic Asian, Hispanic and all other respondents. Sampling errors and tests of statistical significance take into account the effect of weighting.

The following table shows the unweighted sample sizes and the error attributable to sampling that would be expected at the 95% level of confidence for different groups in the survey.

Sample sizes and margins of error, ATP Wave 140

Group	Unweighted sample size	Weighted %	Plus or minus ...
Total sample	5,140		1.7 percentage points
Half form	At least 2,569		2.5 percentage points
Rep/Lean Rep	2,210	45	2.5 percentage points
Half form	At least 1,088		3.6 percentage points
Dem/Lean Dem	2,710	47	2.4 percentage points
Half form	At least 1,352		3.5 percentage points

Note: This survey includes oversamples of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men, and Hispanic men. Unweighted sample sizes do not account for the sample design or weighting and do not describe a group's contribution to weighted estimates. Refer to the Sample design and Weighting sections above for details.

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Sample sizes and sampling errors for other subgroups are available upon request. In addition to sampling error, one should bear in mind that question wording and practical difficulties in conducting surveys can introduce error or bias into the findings of opinion polls.

Dispositions and response rates

Final dispositions, ATP Wave 140

	AAPOR code	Total
Completed interview	1.1	5,140
Logged on to survey; broke off	2.12	23
Logged on to survey; did not complete any items	2.1121	49
Never logged on (implicit refusal)	2.11	387
Survey completed after close of the field period	2.27	1
Completed interview but was removed for data quality	2.3	4
Screened out	4.7	0
Total panelists sampled for the survey		**5,604**
Completed interviews	I	5,140
Partial interviews	P	0
Refusals	R	459
Non-contact	NC	1
Other	O	4
Unknown household	UH	0
Unknown other	UO	0
Not eligible	NE	0
Total		**5,604**
AAPOR RR1 = I / (I+P+R+NC+O+UH+UO)		92%

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Cumulative response rate as of ATP Wave 140

	Total
Weighted response rate to recruitment surveys	11%
% of recruitment survey respondents who agreed to join the panel, among those invited	71%
% of those agreeing to join who were active panelists at start of Wave 140	46%
Response rate to Wave 140 survey	92%
Cumulative response rate	**3%**

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2024 PEW RESEARCH CENTER'S AMERICAN TRENDS PANEL
WAVE 140 JANUARY 2024
FINAL TOPLINE
JANUARY 16–21, 2024
N=5,140

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ADDITIONAL QUESTION HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

DISPLAY FOR ALL:
On another topic…
ASK ALL
BORDER_CL How closely have you been following news about the current situation at the U.S. border with Mexico and the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S.? **[RANDOMIZE ORDER OF OPTIONS 1-5 AND 5-1 FOR RANDOM HALF SAMPLE]**

Jan 16-21, 2024		Jun 5-11, 2023[4]
12	Extremely closely	6
18	Very closely	12
34	Somewhat closely	33
22	Not too closely	27
14	Not at all closely	21
1	No answer	*

ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]:
BRDERJOB How would you rate the job the U.S. government is doing dealing with the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico?

			TREND FOR COMPARISON[6]	
Jan 16-21, 2024		Jun 5-11, 2023[5]	Apr 5-11, 2021	Jul 22-Aug 4, 2019
2	Very good job	2	3	6
17	Somewhat good job	21	26	27
34	Somewhat bad job	35	35	27
45	Very bad job	39	33	38
2	No answer	4	3	2

[4] Question previously asked, "How closely have you been following news about the number of people seeking asylum at the United States border with Mexico?"
[5] Question previously asked, "How would you rate the job the U.S. government is doing dealing with the large number of people seeking asylum at the U.S. border with Mexico?"
[6] Previous versions of this question were worded slightly differently. For surveys conducted 2021 and earlier, the question was worded "How would you rate the job the U.S. government is doing dealing with the increased number of people seeking asylum at the U.S. border with Mexico?"

ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]:

IMM_CRISIS Would you say the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico is… **[RANDOMIZE ORDER OF OPTIONS 1-4 AND 4-1 FOR RANDOM HALF SAMPLE]**

Jan 16-21, 2024	
45	A crisis for the U.S.
32	A major problem for the U.S., but not a crisis
17	A minor problem for the U.S.
4	Not a problem for the U.S.
1	No answer

ASK ALL:

IMMFACT How much of a reason is each of the following for why a large number of migrants are seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico? **[RANDOMIZE ITEMS**]

		Major reason	Minor reason	Not a reason	No answer
NOOPP	Bad economic conditions in their home countries				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	75	19	6	1
USOPP	Good economic opportunities in the U.S.				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	71	21	7	1
VIOL	Violence in their home countries				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	65	26	8	1
FRDM	Greater political freedoms in the U.S.				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	44	37	18	1
POL	Belief that U.S. immigration policies will make it easy to stay in the country once they arrive				
	Jan 16-21, 2024	58	26	15	1

ASK ALL:

IMMCRIMM Do you think the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico, with a large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S., is leading to… **[RANDOMIZE OPTIONS 1-2; ALWAYS ASK OPTION 3 LAST]**

Jan 16-21, 2024	
57	More crime in the U.S.
3	Less crime in the U.S.
39	Doesn't have much impact on crime in the U.S.
1	No answer

ASK ALL:

IMMPOLIMPCT Thinking about some proposed policies to address immigration and the situation at the U.S. border with Mexico, do you think each of the following proposals would make the situation better or worse? **[RANDOMIZE ITEMS; RANDOMIZE RESPONSES 1-2 WITH 3 AND 4 ALWAYS LAST]**

		Better	Worse	Not make much difference	Not sure	No answer
ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]						
DPRT	Increasing deportations of people who are in the country illegally					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	52	17	16	15	*
BUS	Putting more severe penalties on businesses if they hire people who are not legally allowed to work in the U.S.					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	45	19	20	16	1
AID	Increasing economic aid to Central American countries where many migrants are coming from					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	27	18	35	20	1
HRD	Making it harder for asylum seekers to be granted temporary legal status in the U.S. while they wait for their asylum hearing					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	38	28	15	18	1
COND	Increasing resources to provide safe and sanitary conditions for migrants arriving in the U.S.					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	36	27	20	15	1
ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]						
RCS	Increasing the number of judges and staff so that asylum applications can be decided more quickly					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	60	11	14	15	*
OPP	Creating more opportunities for people to legally immigrate to the U.S.					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	56	15	14	14	1
WALL	Substantially expanding the wall along the U.S. border with Mexico					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	41	14	32	12	*

IMMPOLIMPCT CONTINUED…

WORK	Making it easier for asylum seekers to work legally while they wait for a decision about their asylum applications					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	47	22	13	17	*

ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]:

IMMIG_OE What other thoughts about immigration would you like to share?

[PROGRAMMING NOTE: OPEN END TEXT BOX]

Jan 16-21, 2024	
8	**NET Make policies more restrictive**
4	*Need stricter laws*
3	*Close the border*
2	*Deport illegal immigrants*
7	**NET: Need to address immediate crisis**
4	*Secure the border*
3	*Too many people/system overwhelmed*
*	*Send more resources to border states*
*	*Send them to empty states/we have room*
7	Immigrants need to come legally
6	**NET: Strain on resources**
2	*We need to focus on our citizens first*
2	*Hurting the economy*
2	*Don't deserve welfare*
6	Process is broken
5	**NET: Political failures**
2	*Current administration is failing*
2	*Political interests/failures*
1	*Need bipartisan solution/everyone's problem*
5	**NET: Positive view of immigrants**
3	*Immigrants are good for society*
2	*Immigrants are good for the economy*
4	**NET: Security concerns**
2	*Illegal immigrants are dangerous*
1	*Unvetted immigrants are a risk*
1	*Citizens should feel safe and protected*
4	Immigrants need support
3	**NET: Make policies less restrictive**
2	*Need easier laws*
1	*Open the border*
3	Complicated issue
2	Other
1	Need humane system

IMMIG_OE CONTINUED…

Jan 16-21, 2024	
1	Current system works fine
1	Not just U.S. problem/countries of origin should also be involved
1	America is changing for the worse
55	No answer/skipped

ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]:

IMMIG_OE2 What is your top concern, if any, about the large number of migrants seeking to enter the U.S. at the border with Mexico?

[PROGRAMMING NOTE: OPEN END TEXT BOX]

Jan 16-21, 2024	
22	**NET: Economic burden**
15	*Strain/cost of resources*
4	*Economic burden (general)*
3	*Taking Americans jobs*
2	*Increased poverty/homelessness*
1	*Migrants lazy/cannot provide for themselves/not skilled*
22	**NET: Security Concerns**
10	*Unvetted/dangerous people entering*
10	*Increasing crime rates*
3	*Security*
3	*Drugs*
1	*Trafficking*
1	*Cartels/Gangs/organized crime*
11	**NET: Concern for migrant safety, treatment**
6	*Human rights, safety, health and wellbeing of migrants*
4	*Concern for migrants (general)*
2	*Policies do not allow them to work/not fair to migrants*
5	Housing concerns
5	No concerns
5	**NET Broken immigration system**
4	*Inefficient system*
1	*Problems with immigration policies/system*
5	**NET: Migrants abusing system**
3	*Policies not strict enough*
2	*Migrants are not following laws/not legitimate*
4	**NET: Politicians taking advantage of issue**
2	*Blames politicians/parties*
1	*Problems with political system*
1	*Republican/Democratic Party use to their advantage*
1	*Influence on voting/political process*
4	Too many people

IMMIG_OE2 CONTINUED…

Jan 16-21, 2024	
3	**NET: Migrants impact on communities**
2	*Negative effects on communities they migrate to*
1	*Direct effect on border communities*
2	**NET: Changing composition of U.S./assimilation issues**
1	*Ethnic/cultural composition of U.S.*
1	*Struggles to/do not try hard enough to assimilate*
1	U.S. responsibility for home countries of migrants
1	Disease/health concerns
1	General mentions of it being bad
1	Other/No substantive answer
36	No answer/Skipped

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ASK ALL:
PARTY In politics today, do you consider yourself a:
ASK IF INDEP/SOMETHING ELSE (PARTY=3 or 4) OR MISSING:
PARTYLN As of today do you lean more to…[7]

Republican	Democrat	Independent	Something else	No answer	*Lean Rep*	*Lean Dem*
28	29	27	13	3	17	18

Key to Pew Research trends noted in the topline:

(U) Pew Research Center/USA Today polls

[7] PARTY and PARTYLN asked in a prior survey.

Pew Research Center

FOR RELEASE FEBRUARY 29, 2024

Americans' Top Policy Priority for 2024: Strengthening the Economy

Growing shares of Republicans rate immigration and terrorism as top priorities

FOR MEDIA OR OTHER INQUIRIES:

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RECOMMENDED CITATION

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About Pew Research Center

Pew Research Center is a nonpartisan, nonadvocacy fact tank that informs the public about the issues, attitudes and trends shaping the world. It does not take policy positions. The Center conducts public opinion polling, demographic research, computational social science research and other data-driven research. It studies politics and policy; news habits and media; the internet and technology; religion; race and ethnicity; international affairs; social, demographic and economic trends; science; research methodology and data science; and immigration and migration. Pew Research Center is a subsidiary of The Pew Charitable Trusts, its primary funder.

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How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand the American public's views as the most important priorities for the president and Congress to prioritize in the coming year. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16-21, 2024.

Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

Americans' Top Policy Priority for 2024: Strengthening the Economy

Growing shares of Republicans rate immigration and terrorism as top priorities

As President Joe Biden prepares to deliver his third State of the Union address on March 7, Americans view strengthening the economy as the top policy priority for Biden and Congress to address this year.

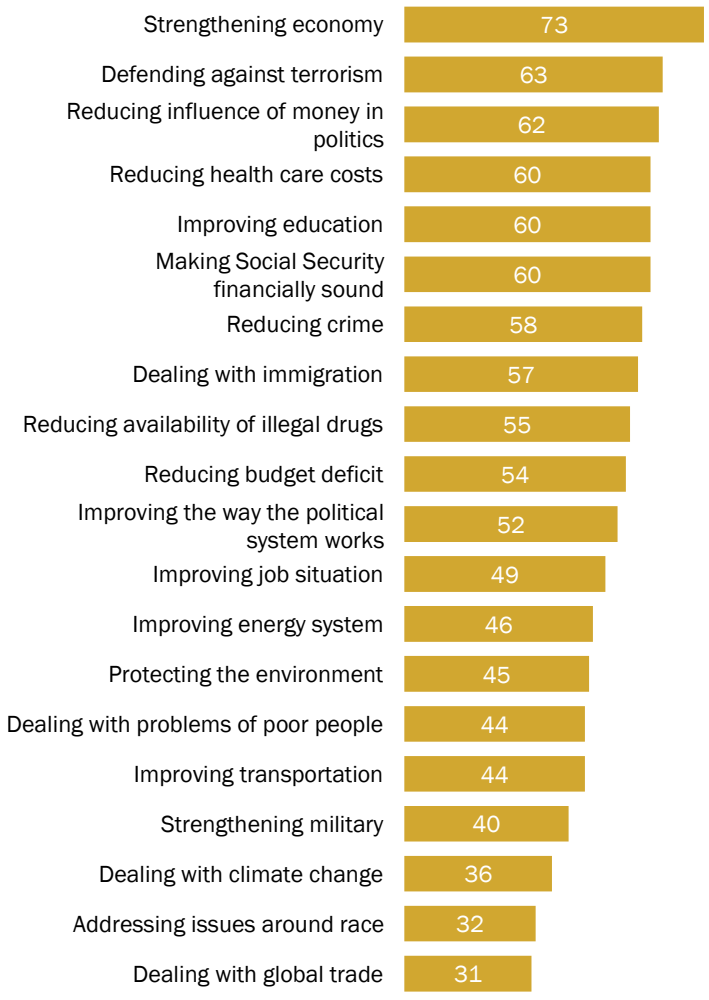
The public's to-do list is little changed from the past two years, though it differs greatly from 2021, when dealing with the coronavirus ranked nearly as high as strengthening the economy on the policy agenda.

These are among the highlights of Pew Research Center's annual policy priorities survey, conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024, among 5,140 adults:

No single issue stands out after the economy. Nearly three-quarters of Americans (73%) rate strengthening the economy as a top priority. That is considerably larger than the shares citing any other policy goal.

Americans' top policy priority this year? Strengthening the economy

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Republicans are increasingly concerned over immigration. Over the course of Biden's presidency, the share of Americans citing immigration as a top priority has increased 18 percentage points – from 39% to 57% – with the change coming almost entirely among Republicans and Republican-leaning independents. Republicans have also grown more concerned over terrorism, especially in the past year.

Related: *How Americans View the Situation at the U.S.-Mexico Border, Its Causes and Consequences*

Crime is also a growing concern among Republicans. Nearly seven-in-ten Republicans and Republican leaners (68%) and 47% of Democrats and Democratic leaners say reducing crime should be a top policy priority. GOP concerns have risen steadily each year since 2021. Democratic views have been stable over the last few years after rising between 2021 and 2022.

There is bipartisan support for reducing the influence of money in politics. About six-in-ten Americans (62%) say reducing the influence of money in politics should be a top goal for the president and Congress. While there are wide partisan differences on most policy goals, 65% of Democrats and 60% of Republicans rate this as a top priority.

Related: *Americans' Dismal Views of the Nation's Politics*

Ongoing concerns: The economy, budget deficit and job situation

Large shares of Republicans and Republican-leaning independents (84%) and Democrats and Democratic leaners (63%) view **strengthening the nation's economy** as a top priority this year, as they have for the past several years.

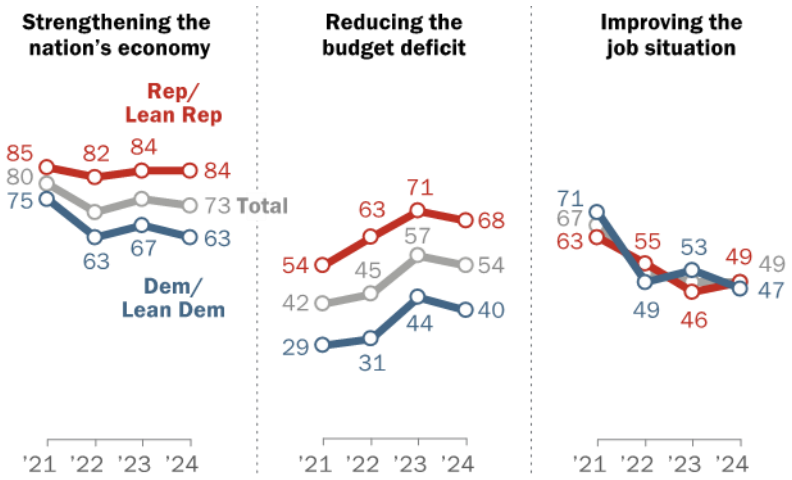
And while more Americans say **the budget deficit** is a top priority now than did when Biden first took office in 2021, their views are similar compared with last year (54% now vs. 57% then).

Republicans (68%) remain more concerned about the deficit than Democrats (40%).

By comparison, about half of the public (49%) – including nearly identical shares in both parties – view **improving the job situation** as a top priority. Concerns over the job situation have declined sharply since 2021, during Biden's first year in office and when the coronavirus pandemic was ravaging the country.

Public concern over job situation has changed little in recent years but is much lower than in 2021; concern over budget deficit has risen since then

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Growing concerns: National security, crime and immigration

About six-in-ten Americans view defending the country from future terror attacks (63%), dealing with immigration (57%) and reducing crime (58%) as top political priorities for the upcoming year. And while Americans' overall views of these policy areas are largely unchanged over the past year, Republicans are more concerned than Democrats about each.

Terrorism

Among Republicans, concern about terrorism has risen 11 percentage points since last year (76% vs. 65%).

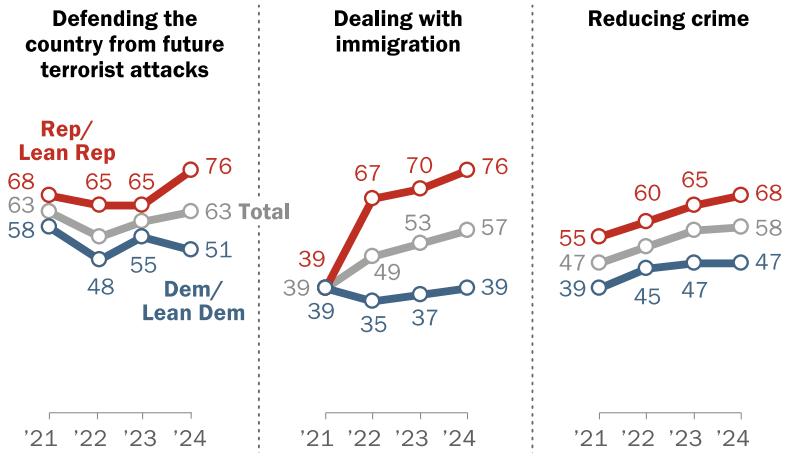
By comparison, about half of Democrats (51%) also view terrorism as a top priority this year (55% did so last year).

Immigration

Between 2021 and 2022, the share of Republicans citing immigration as a top policy priority rose sharply, from 39% to 67%.

Since 2021, immigration concerns have surged among Republicans while holding steady among Democrats

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Since then, it increased another 9 points, to 76%. Over this period, Democrats' views have been fairly stable; today, 39% rate dealing with immigration as a top priority.

Reducing crime

While reducing crime has changed little as a priority since last year, both parties have become more concerned about it since the start of Biden's presidency.

About seven-in-ten Republicans (68%) rate crime reduction as a top political priority, up 13 points since 2021. And roughly half of Democrats (47%) do the same (up 8 points over this period).

Wide partisan differences over most policy goals

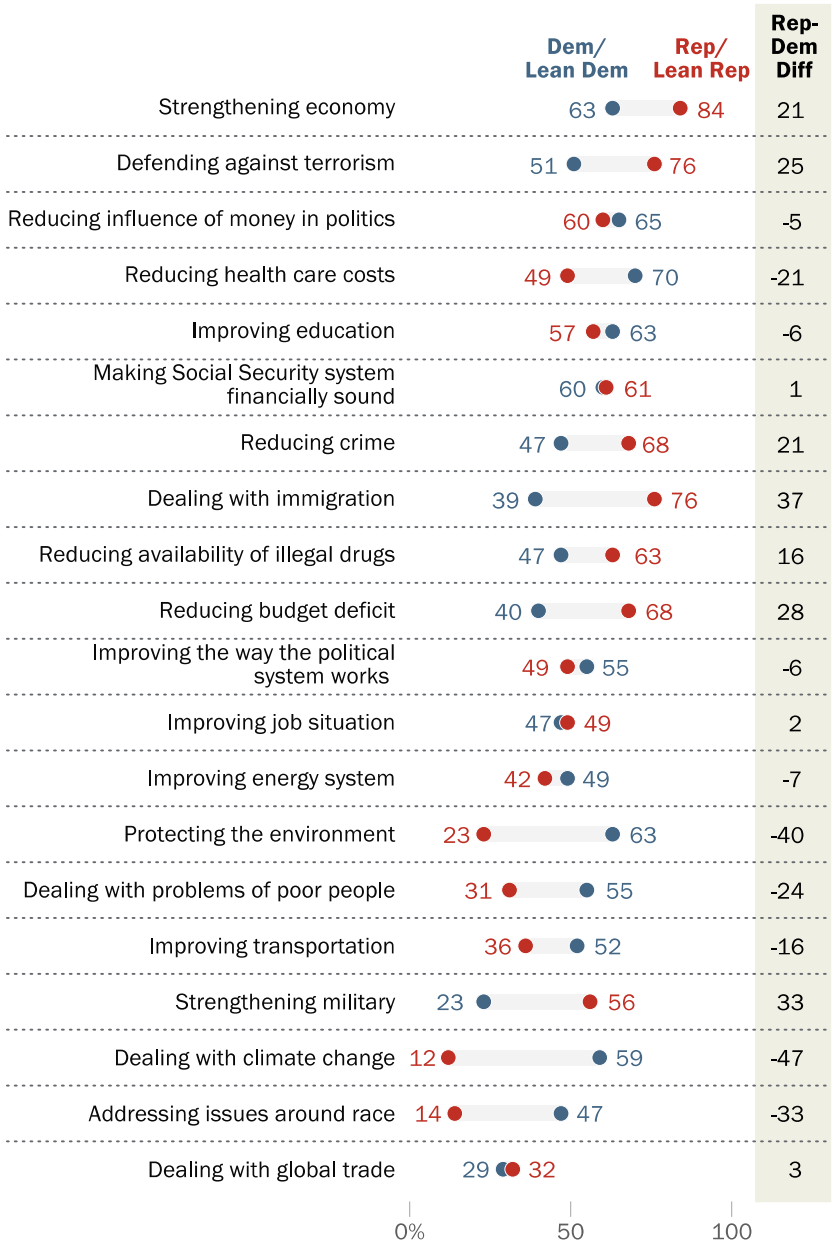
Although majorities in both major parties share several top priorities – such as strengthening the economy, reducing the role of money in politics and ensuring Social Security is financially sound – there are large differences on others.

For instance, Democrats are substantially more likely than Republicans to prioritize protecting the environment (63% vs. 23%) and dealing with climate change (59% vs. 12%).

By comparison, Republicans are much more likely to prioritize dealing with immigration (76% vs. 39%) and strengthening the military (56% vs. 23).

Top priorities for Republicans are the economy, terrorism and immigration; for Democrats, health care costs, the economy, education and the environment

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Differences by race and ethnicity

Clear majorities across racial and ethnic groups – about three-quarters each – view strengthening the economy as a top political priority this year.

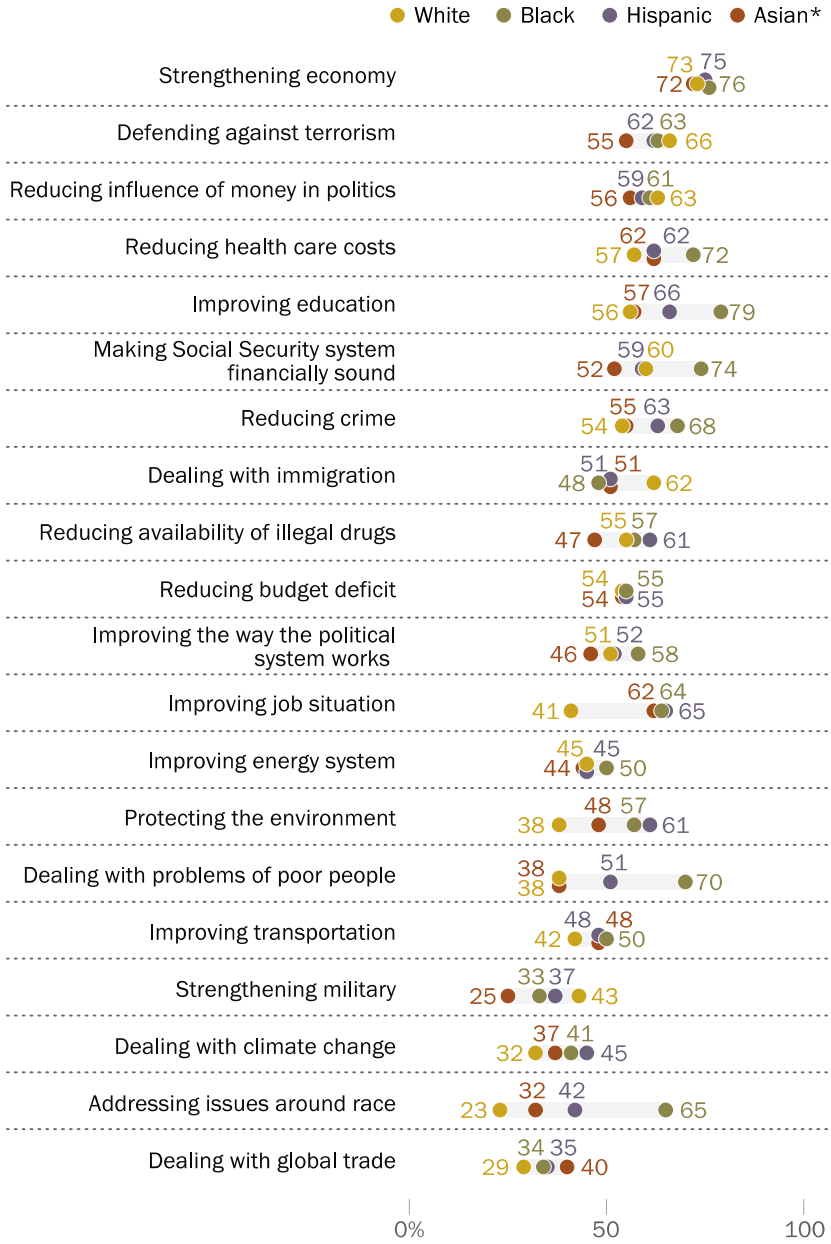
They also uniformly prioritize defending the country against terrorism and reducing the influence of money in politics.

On other issues, differences are starker:

- While 41% of White adults prioritize improving the job situation, six-in-ten or more Black (64%), Hispanic (65%) and Asian Americans (62%) do the same.
- White and Asian adults (38% each) are far less likely than Hispanic (51%) and Black adults (70%) to prioritize dealing with problems of the poor.
- Black adults (65%) are substantially more likely to prioritize addressing issues around race than Hispanic

Racial and ethnic differences in views of top policy priorities for the president and Congress

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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(42%), Asian (32%) or White adults (23%).

Policy priorities by age

Similar shares of younger and older Americans view several issues as top priorities.

Across all age groups, about six-in-ten say reducing health care costs and improving education should be top political priorities this year.

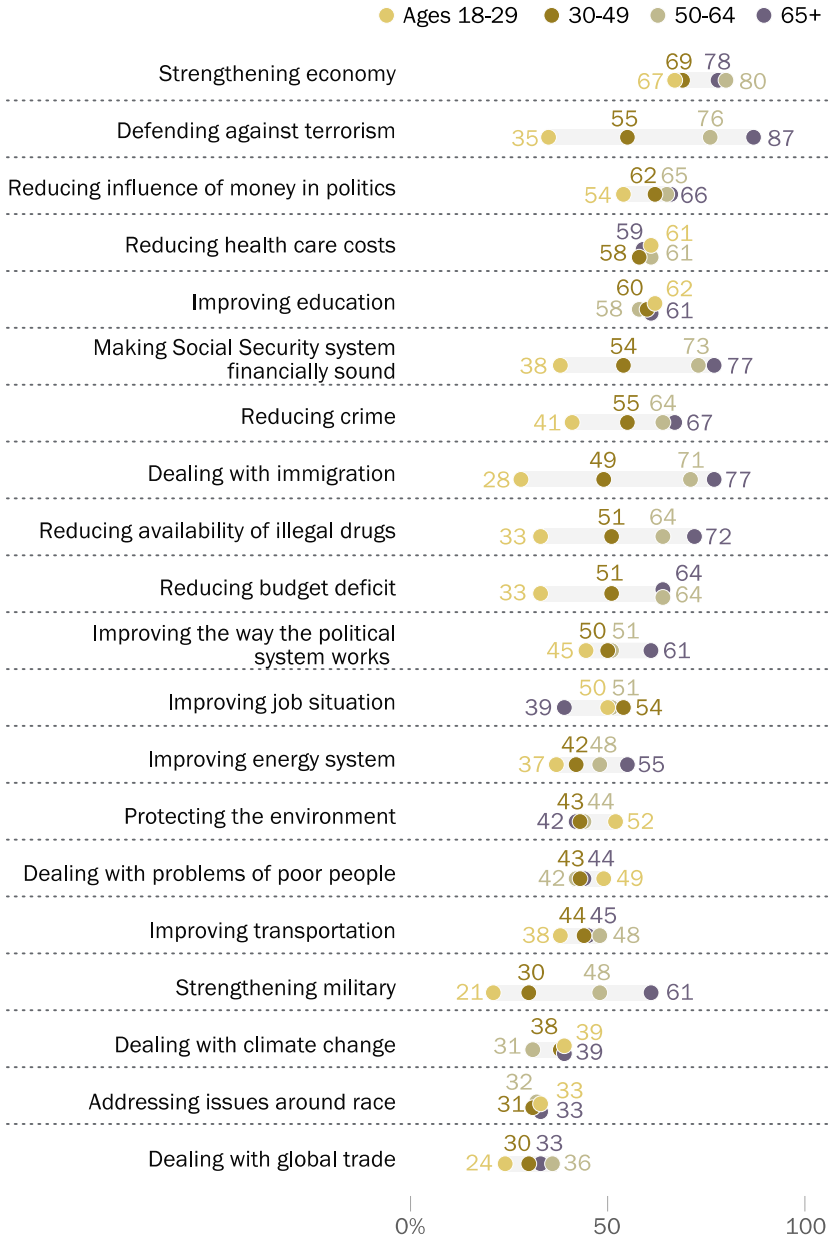
But older Americans are particularly likely to prioritize some issues.

For example, nearly nine-in-ten people 65 and older (87%) and about three-quarters (76%) of those 50 to 64 say defending against terrorism should be a top priority. This drops to 55% of Americans 30 to 49 and 35% of those 18 to 29.

A similar pattern plays out for ensuring Social Security is financially sound, dealing with immigration, reducing the availability of illegal drugs and strengthening the military.

Young adults are less likely to rate many issues as top priorities, including terrorism and immigration

% who say ___ should be a top priority for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Few say policy objectives should not be pursued

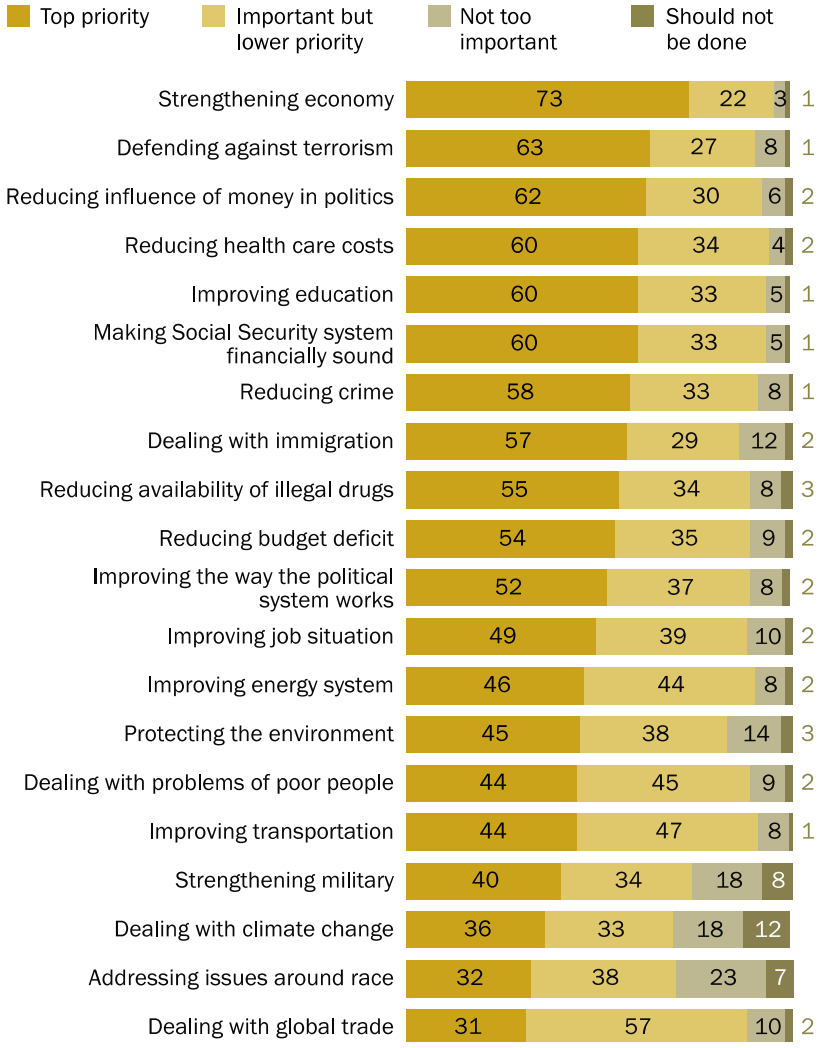
Despite wide differences over whether certain issues should be a *top* priority, relatively few say any of the issues asked about should *not* be prioritized by the president and Congress this year.

For all but three issues surveyed, few Americans (3% or less) say these policy areas should not be pursued. The exceptions are dealing with climate change (12%), strengthening the military (8%) and addressing issues around race (7%).

Similarly, relatively few say any of the policy areas are "not too important" to be addressed this year (at most, about a quarter say this for the same three policy issues).

Majorities of Americans say all objectives are either a 'top priority' or 'important but lower priority'

% who say each of the following should be a(n) ___ for the president and Congress to address this year



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Acknowledgments

This report is a collaborative effort based on the input and analysis of the following individuals:

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Methodology

The American Trends Panel survey methodology

Overview

The American Trends Panel (ATP), created by Pew Research Center, is a nationally representative panel of randomly selected U.S. adults. Panelists participate via self-administered web surveys. Panelists who do not have internet access at home are provided with a tablet and wireless internet connection. Interviews are conducted in both English and Spanish. The panel is being managed by Ipsos.

Data in this report is drawn from ATP Wave 140, conducted from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024, and includes an oversample of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men and Hispanic men in order to provide more precise estimates of the opinions and experiences of these smaller demographic subgroups. These oversampled groups are weighted back to reflect their correct proportions in the population. A total of 5,140 panelists responded out of 5,604 who were sampled, for a response rate of 92%. The cumulative response rate accounting for nonresponse to the recruitment surveys and attrition is 3%. The break-off rate among panelists who logged on to the survey and completed at least one item is less than 1%. The margin of sampling error for the full sample of 5,140 respondents is plus or minus 1.7 percentage points.

Panel recruitment

The ATP was created in 2014, with the first cohort of panelists invited to join the panel at the end of a large, national, landline and cellphone random-digit-dial survey that was conducted in both English and Spanish. Two additional recruitments were conducted using the same method in 2015 and 2017, respectively. Across these three surveys, a total of 19,718 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 9,942 (50%) agreed to participate.

In August 2018, the ATP switched from telephone to address-based sampling (ABS) recruitment. A study cover letter and a pre-incentive are mailed to a stratified, random sample of households selected from the U.S. Postal Service's Delivery Sequence File. This Postal Service file has been estimated to cover as much as 98% of the population, although some studies suggest that the coverage could be in the low 90% range.[1] Within each sampled household, the adult with the next

[1] AAPOR Task Force on Address-based Sampling. 2016. "AAPOR Report: Address-based Sampling."

birthday is asked to participate. Other details of the ABS recruitment protocol have changed over time but are available upon request.[2]

We have recruited a national sample of U.S. adults to the ATP approximately once per year since 2014. In some years, the recruitment has included additional efforts (known as an "oversample") to boost sample size with underrepresented groups. For example, Hispanic adults, Black adults and Asian adults were oversampled in 2019, 2022 and 2023, respectively.

American Trends Panel recruitment surveys

Recruitment dates	Mode	Invited	Joined	Active panelists remaining
Jan. 23 to March 16, 2014	Landline/ cell RDD	9,809	5,338	1,393
Aug. 27 to Oct. 4, 2015	Landline/ cell RDD	6,004	2,976	831
April 25 to June 4, 2017	Landline/ cell RDD	3,905	1,628	405
Aug. 8 to Oct. 31, 2018	ABS	9,396	8,778	3,850
Aug. 19 to Nov. 30, 2019	ABS	5,900	4,720	1,388
June 1 to July 19, 2020; Feb. 10 to March 31, 2021	ABS	3,197	2,812	1,441
May 29 to July 7, 2021; Sept. 16 to Nov. 1, 2021	ABS	1,329	1,162	731
May 24 to Sept. 29, 2022	ABS	3,354	2,869	1,457
April 17 to May 30, 2023	ABS	686	576	435
	Total	**43,580**	**30,859**	**11,931**

Note: RDD is random-digit dial; ABS is address-based sampling. Approximately once per year, panelists who have not participated in multiple consecutive waves or who did not complete an annual profiling survey are removed from the panel. Panelists also become inactive if they ask to be removed from the panel.

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Across the six address-based recruitments, a total of 23,862 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 20,917 agreed to join the panel and completed an initial profile survey. Of the 30,859 individuals who have ever joined the ATP, 11,931 remained active panelists and continued to receive survey invitations at the time this survey was conducted.

The American Trends Panel never uses breakout routers or chains that direct respondents to additional surveys.

Sample design

The overall target population for this survey was noninstitutionalized persons ages 18 and older living in the U.S., including Alaska and Hawaii. It featured a stratified random sample from the ATP in which Hispanic men, non-Hispanic Black men and non-Hispanic Asian adults were selected with certainty. The remaining panelists were sampled at rates designed to ensure that the share of respondents in each stratum is proportional to its share of the U.S. adult population to the

[2] Email pewsurveys@pewresearch.org.

greatest extent possible. Respondent weights are adjusted to account for differential probabilities of selection as described in the Weighting section below.

Questionnaire development and testing

The questionnaire was developed by Pew Research Center in consultation with Ipsos. The web program was rigorously tested on both PC and mobile devices by the Ipsos project management team and Pew Research Center researchers. The Ipsos project management team also populated test data that was analyzed in SPSS to ensure the logic and randomizations were working as intended before launching the survey.

Incentives

All respondents were offered a post-paid incentive for their participation. Respondents could choose to receive the post-paid incentive in the form of a check or a gift code to Amazon.com or could choose to decline the incentive. Incentive amounts ranged from $5 to $20 depending on whether the respondent belongs to a part of the population that is harder or easier to reach. Differential incentive amounts were designed to increase panel survey participation among groups that traditionally have low survey response propensities.

Data collection protocol

The data collection field period for this survey was Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Postcard notifications were mailed to a subset of sampled ATP panelists[3] with a known residential address on Jan. 16.

Invitations were sent out in two separate launches: soft launch and full launch. Sixty panelists were included in the soft launch, which began with an initial invitation sent on Jan. 16. The ATP panelists chosen for the initial soft launch were known responders who had completed previous ATP surveys within one day of receiving their invitation. All remaining English- and Spanish-speaking sampled panelists were included in the full launch and were sent an invitation on Jan. 17.

All panelists with an email address received an email invitation and up to two email reminders if they did not respond to the survey. All ATP panelists who consented to SMS messages received an SMS invitation and up to two SMS reminders.

[3] Postcard notifications are sent to 1) panelists who have been provided with a tablet to take ATP surveys, 2) panelists who were recruited within the last two years, and 3) panelists recruited prior to the last two years who opt to continue receiving postcard notifications.

Invitation and reminder dates, ATP Wave 140

	Soft launch	Full launch
Initial invitation	January 16, 2024	January 17, 2024
First reminder	January 18, 2024	January 18, 2024
Final reminder	January 20 2024	January 20, 2024

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Data quality checks

To ensure high-quality data, the Center's researchers performed data quality checks to identify any respondents showing clear patterns of satisficing. This includes checking for whether respondents left questions blank at very high rates or always selected the first or last answer presented. As a result of this checking, four ATP respondents were removed from the survey dataset prior to weighting and analysis.

Weighting

The ATP data is weighted in a multistep process that accounts for multiple stages of sampling and nonresponse that occur at different points in the survey process. First, each panelist begins with a base weight that reflects their probability of selection for their initial recruitment survey. These weights are then rescaled and adjusted to account for changes in the design of ATP recruitment surveys from year to year. Finally, the weights are calibrated to align with the population benchmarks in the accompanying table to correct for nonresponse to recruitment surveys and panel attrition. If only a subsample of panelists was invited to participate in the wave, this weight is adjusted to account for any differential probabilities of selection.

American Trends Panel weighting dimensions

Variable	Benchmark source
Age (detailed) Age x Gender Education x Gender Education x Age Race/Ethnicity x Education Black (alone or in combination) x Hispanic Born inside vs. outside the U.S. among Hispanics and Asian Americans Years lived in the U.S. Census region x Metropolitan status	2022 American Community Survey (ACS)
Volunteerism	2021 CPS Volunteering & Civic Life Supplement
Voter registration	2022 CPS Voting and Registration Supplement
Party affiliation x Race/Ethnicity Frequency of internet use Religious affiliation	2023 National Public Opinion Reference Survey (NPORS)

Note: Estimates from the ACS are based on noninstitutionalized adults. Voter registration is calculated using procedures from Hur, Achen (2013) and rescaled to include the total U.S. adult population.

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Among the panelists who completed the survey, this weight is then calibrated again to align with the population benchmarks identified in the accompanying table and trimmed at the 2nd and 98th percentiles to reduce the loss in precision stemming from variance in the weights. This trimming is performed separately among non-Hispanic Black, non-Hispanic Asian, Hispanic and all other respondents. Sampling errors and tests of statistical significance take into account the effect of weighting.

The following table shows the unweighted sample sizes and the error attributable to sampling that would be expected at the 95% level of confidence for different groups in the survey.

Sample sizes and margins of error, ATP Wave 140

Group	Unweighted sample size	Weighted %	Plus or minus ...
Total sample	5,140		1.7 percentage points
Half form	At least 2,569		2.5 percentage points
Rep/Lean Rep	2,210	45	2.5 percentage points
Half form	At least 1,088		3.6 percentage points
Dem/Lean Dem	2,710	47	2.4 percentage points
Half form	At least 1,352		3.5 percentage points

Note: This survey includes oversamples of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men and Hispanic men. Unweighted sample sizes do not account for the sample design or weighting and do not describe a group's contribution to weighted estimates. Refer to the Sample design and Weighting sections above for details.

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Sample sizes and sampling errors for other subgroups are available upon request. In addition to sampling error, one should bear in mind that question wording and practical difficulties in conducting surveys can introduce error or bias into the findings of opinion polls.

Dispositions and response rates

Final dispositions, ATP Wave 140

	AAPOR code	Total
Completed interview	1.1	5,140
Logged on to survey; broke off	2.12	23
Logged on to survey; did not complete any items	2.1121	49
Never logged on (implicit refusal)	2.11	387
Survey completed after close of the field period	2.27	1
Completed interview but was removed for data quality	2.3	4
Screened out	4.7	0
Total panelists sampled for the survey		**5,604**
Completed interviews	I	5,140
Partial interviews	P	0
Refusals	R	459
Non-contact	NC	1
Other	O	4
Unknown household	UH	0
Unknown other	UO	0
Not eligible	NE	0
Total		**5,604**
AAPOR RR1 = I / (I+P+R+NC+O+UH+UO)		92%

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Cumulative response rate as of ATP Wave 140

	Total
Weighted response rate to recruitment surveys	11%
% of recruitment survey respondents who agreed to join the panel, among those invited	71%
% of those agreeing to join who were active panelists at start of Wave 140	46%
Response rate to Wave 140 survey	92%
Cumulative response rate	**3%**

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2024 PEW RESEARCH CENTER'S AMERICAN TRENDS PANEL
WAVE 140 JANUARY 2024
FINAL TOPLINE
JANUARY 16–21, 2024
N=5,140

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

ASK ALL:

PRIPRES How much of a priority should each of the following be for the president and Congress to address this year?

[RANDOMIZE ORDER OF SCREENS 1 AND 2 FOR EACH FORM]

		Top priority	Important but lower priority	Not too important	Should not be done	No answer
ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]: [SCREEN 1, RANDOMIZE ITEMS ON SCREEN]						
PRIPRES_JOB	Improving the job situation					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	49	39	10	2	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	49	40	9	1	*
	Jan 10-17, 2022	52	37	8	2	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	67	29	2	1	1
PRIPRES_BD	Reducing the budget deficit					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	54	35	9	2	1
	Jan 18-24, 2023	57	33	7	2	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	45	40	11	3	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	42	44	11	2	1
PRIPRES_DTRD	Reducing the availability of illegal drugs like heroin, fentanyl and cocaine					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	55	34	8	3	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	53	34	11	2	*
PRIPRES_ENV	Protecting the environment					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	45	38	14	3	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	44	39	13	3	1

PRIPRES CONTINUED…		Top priority	Important but lower priority	Not too important	Should not be done	No answer
PRIPRES_TER	Defending the country from future terrorist attacks					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	63	27	8	1	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	60	30	8	1	*
	Jan 10-17, 2022	55	32	8	3	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	63	30	6	1	*
ASK FORM 1 ONLY [N=2,569]: [SCREEN 2, RANDOMIZE ITEMS ON SCREEN]						
PRIPRES_GT	Dealing with global trade issues					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	31	57	10	2	1
	Jan 18-24, 2023	34	54	10	2	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	35	52	9	2	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	32	56	10	2	1
PRIPRES_INF	Improving the country's roads, bridges and public transportation systems					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	44	47	8	1	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	42	49	7	1	*
	Jan 8-12, 2021	32	54	13	1	1
PRIPRES_RA	Addressing issues around race in this county					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	32	38	23	7	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	32	39	22	7	*
	Jan 10-17, 2022	37	34	19	9	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	49	32	13	5	1
PRIPRES_SC	Taking steps to make the Social Security system financially sound					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	60	33	5	1	*
	Jan 10-17, 2022	57	33	6	3	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	54	39	5	2	1
PRIPRES_MON	Reducing the influence of money in politics					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	62	30	6	2	1
	Jan 18-24, 2023	59	34	6	1	1
ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]: [SCREEN 1, RANDOMIZE ITEMS ON SCREEN]						
PRIPRES_EC	Strengthening the nation's economy					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	73	22	3	1	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	75	20	3	1	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	71	24	4	1	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	80	16	2	1	*

PRIPRES CONTINUED…		Top priority	Important but lower priority	Not too important	Should not be done	No answer
PRIPRES_GCC	Dealing with global climate change					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	36	33	18	12	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	37	34	17	11	*
	Jan 10-17, 2022	42	30	17	10	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	38	33	18	10	1
PRIPRES_EDU	Improving the educational system					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	60	33	5	1	1
	Jan 18-24, 2023	57	35	6	1	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	58	33	6	3	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	53	39	5	2	1
PRIPRES_HC	Reducing health care costs					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	60	34	4	2	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	60	34	4	1	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	61	31	4	3	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	58	36	4	2	*
PRIPRES_CRI	Reducing crime					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	58	33	8	1	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	57	34	8	1	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	52	36	8	2	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	47	42	9	1	1
ASK FORM 2 ONLY [N=2,571]: [SCREEN 2, RANDOMIZE ITEMS ON SCREEN]						
PRIPRES_POOR	Dealing with the problems of poor people					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	44	45	9	2	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	47	41	9	2	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	44	42	11	2	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	53	39	6	2	*
PRIPRES_MIL	Strengthening the U.S. military					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	40	34	18	8	1
	Jan 18-24, 2023	40	35	17	7	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	37	34	20	9	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	37	35	20	7	*
PRIPRES_NRG	Improving the nation’s energy system					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	46	44	8	2	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	52	39	7	1	*

PRIPRES CONTINUED…		Top priority	Important but lower priority	Not too important	Should not be done	No answer
PRIPRES_IMM	Dealing with the issue of immigration					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	57	29	12	2	*
	Jan 18-24, 2023	53	32	12	2	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	49	37	11	2	1
	Jan 8-12, 2021	39	44	13	4	1
PRIPRES_POL	Improving the way the political system works in the U.S.					
	Jan 16-21, 2024	52	37	8	2	1
	Jan 10-17, 2022	52	32	9	5	1
	January 8-12, 2021	62	29	6	2	1

Note about trend: *In 2020 and earlier, the priorities list was asked on phone surveys. As a result of mode differences, phone and web data on this question is not directly comparable.*

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

ASK ALL:
PARTY In politics today, do you consider yourself a:
ASK IF INDEP/SOMETHING ELSE (PARTY=3 or 4) OR MISSING:
PARTYLN As of today do you lean more to…[7]

Republican	Democrat	Independent	Something else	No answer	*Lean Rep*	*Lean Dem*
28	29	27	13	3	17	18

Key to Pew Research trends noted in the topline:

(U) Pew Research Center/USA Today polls

[7] PARTY and PARTYLN asked in a prior survey.

Pew Research Center

FOR RELEASE MARCH 26, 2024

Most Americans Favor Legalizing Marijuana for Medical, Recreational Use

Legalizing recreational marijuana viewed as good for local economies; mixed views of impact on drug use, community safety

FOR MEDIA OR OTHER INQUIRIES:

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RECOMMENDED CITATION

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About Pew Research Center

Pew Research Center is a nonpartisan, nonadvocacy fact tank that informs the public about the issues, attitudes and trends shaping the world. It does not take policy positions. The Center conducts public opinion polling, demographic research, computational social science research and other data-driven research. It studies politics and policy; news habits and media; the internet and technology; religion; race and ethnicity; international affairs; social, demographic and economic trends; science; research methodology and data science; and immigration and migration. Pew Research Center is a subsidiary of The Pew Charitable Trusts, its primary funder.

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How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand the public's views about the legalization of marijuana in the United States. For this analysis, we surveyed 5,140 adults from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the report and its methodology.

Most Americans Favor Legalizing Marijuana for Medical, Recreational Use

Legalizing recreational marijuana viewed as good for local economies; mixed views of impact on drug use, community safety

As more states pass laws legalizing marijuana for recreational use, Americans continue to favor legalization of both medical and recreational use of the drug.

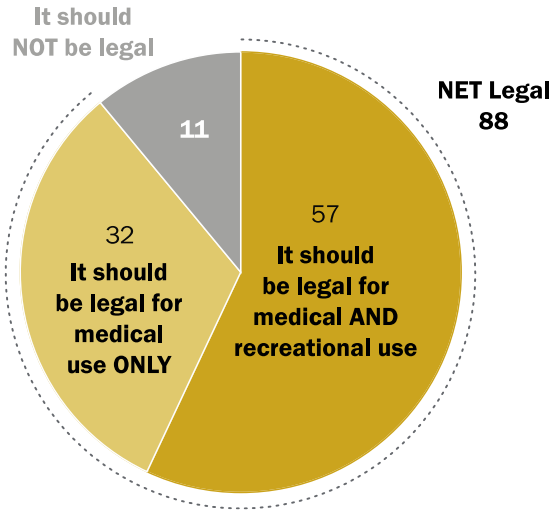
An overwhelming share of U.S. adults (88%) say marijuana **should be legal for medical or recreational use.**

Nearly six-in-ten Americans (57%) say that marijuana should be legal for medical *and* recreational purposes, while roughly a third (32%) say that marijuana should be legal for medical use only.

Just 11% of Americans say that the drug **should not be legal at all.**

Only about 1 in 10 U.S. adults say marijuana should not be legal at all

% of U.S. adults who say the following about marijuana



Note: Fewer than 1% of respondents did not answer the question.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Opinions about marijuana legalization have changed little over the past five years, according to the Pew Research Center survey, conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024, among 5,140 adults.

The impact of legalizing marijuana for recreational use

While a majority of Americans continue to say marijuana should be legal, there are **varying views about the impacts of recreational legalization.**

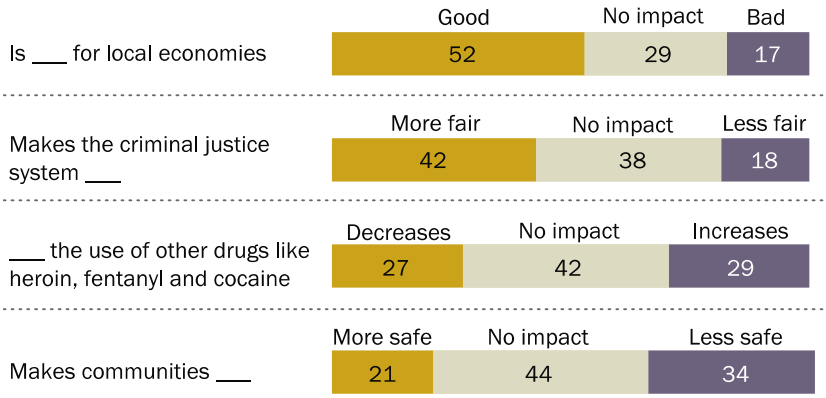
About half of Americans (52%) say that legalizing the recreational use of marijuana is **good for local economies;** just 17% think it is bad and 29% say it has no impact.

More adults also say legalizing marijuana for recreational use makes the **criminal justice system more fair** (42%) than less fair (18%); 38% say it has no impact.

However, Americans have mixed views on the impact of legalizing marijuana for recreational use on:

How Americans view the effects of legalizing recreational marijuana

*% who say when **marijuana is legal for recreational use**, it ...*



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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- **Use of other drugs:** About as many say it increases (29%) as say it decreases (27%) the use of other drugs, like heroin, fentanyl and cocaine (42% say it has no impact).

- **Community safety:** More Americans say legalizing recreational marijuana makes communities less safe (34%) than say it makes them safer (21%); 44% say it has no impact.

Partisan differences on impact of recreational use of marijuana

There are deep partisan divisions regarding the impact of marijuana legalization for recreational use.

Majorities of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents say legalizing recreational marijuana is good for local economies (64% say this) and makes the criminal justice system fairer (58%).

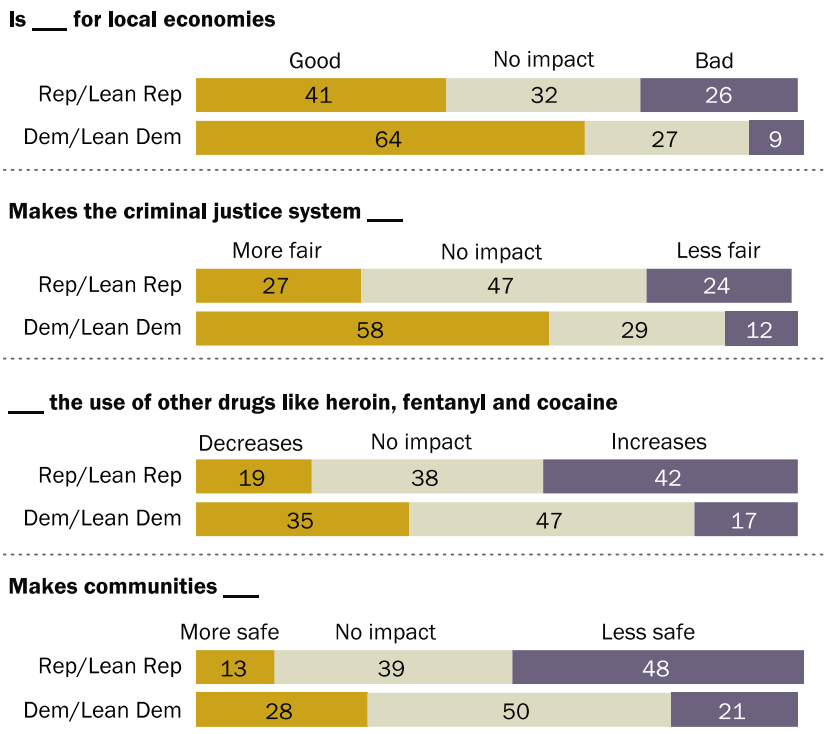
Fewer Republicans and Republican leaners say legalization for recreational use has a positive effect on local economies (41%) and the criminal justice system (27%).

Republicans are more likely than Democrats to cite **downsides from legalizing recreational marijuana:**

- 42% of Republicans say it increases the use of other drugs, like heroin, fentanyl and cocaine, compared with just 17% of Democrats.
- 48% of Republicans say it makes communities less safe, more than double the share of Democrats (21%) who say this.

Democrats more positive than Republicans on impact of legalizing marijuana

*% who say when **marijuana is legal for recreational use**, it ...*



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Demographic, partisan differences in views of marijuana legalization

Sizable age and partisan differences persist on the issue of marijuana legalization though **small shares of adults across demographic groups are completely opposed to it.**

Older adults are far less likely than younger adults to favor marijuana legalization.

This is particularly the case among adults ages 75 and older: 31% say marijuana should be legal for both medical and recreational use.

By comparison, half of adults between the ages of 65 and 74 say marijuana should be legal for medical and recreational use, and larger shares in younger age groups say the same.

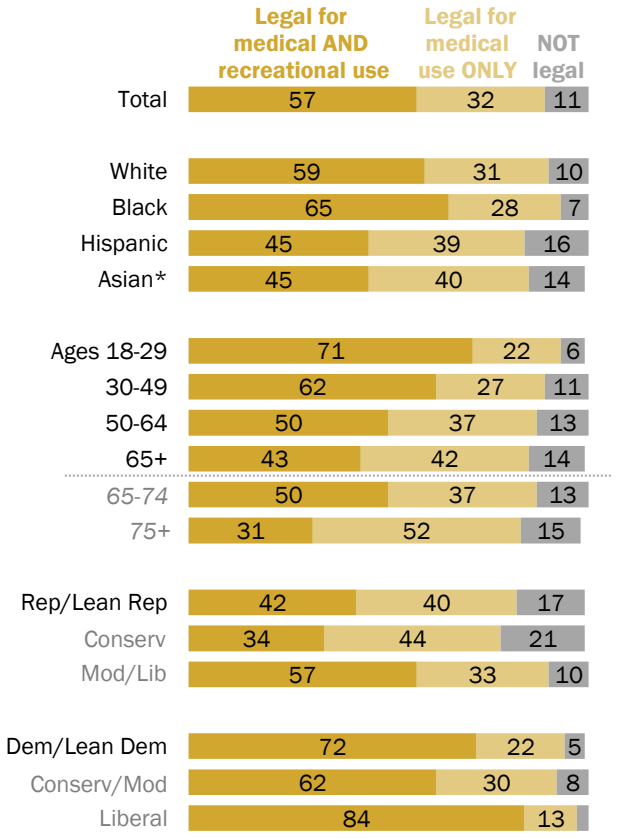
Republicans continue to be less supportive than Democrats of legalizing marijuana for both legal and recreational use: 42% of Republicans favor legalizing marijuana for both purposes, compared with 72% of Democrats.

There continue to be **ideological differences within each party:**

- 34% of conservative Republicans say marijuana should be legal for medical and recreational use, compared with a 57% majority of moderate and liberal Republicans.
- 62% of conservative and moderate Democrats say marijuana should be legal for medical and recreational use, while an overwhelming majority of liberal Democrats (84%) say this.

Views about legalizing marijuana differ by race and ethnicity, age, partisanship

% who say marijuana should be ...



* Asian adults were interviewed in English only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race. No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Views of marijuana legalization vary by age within both parties

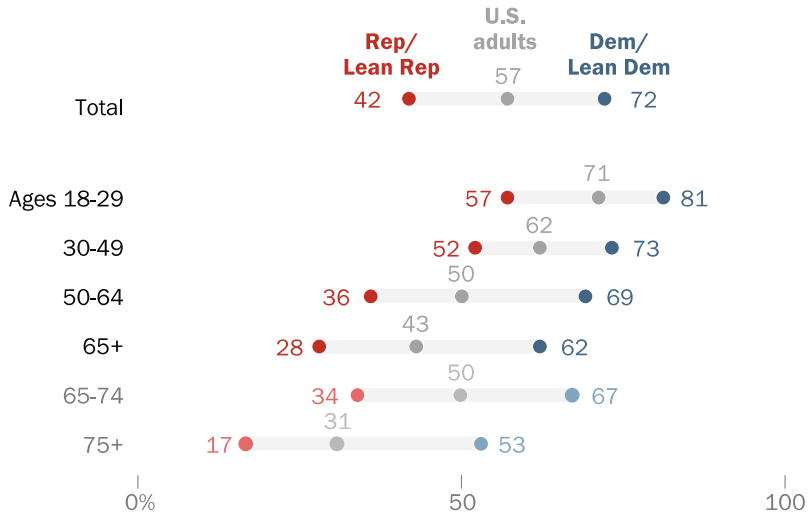
Along with differences by party and age, there are also **age differences *within* each party** on the issue.

A 57% majority of Republicans ages 18 to 29 favor making marijuana legal for medical and recreational use, compared with 52% among those ages 30 to 49 and much smaller shares of older Republicans.

Still, **wide majorities of Republicans in all age groups favor legalizing marijuana at least for medical use.** Among those ages 65 and older, just 20% say marijuana should not be legal even for medical purposes.

Large age differences in both parties in views of legalizing marijuana for medical and recreational use

% who say marijuana should be legal for medical AND recreational use



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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While majorities of Democrats across all age groups support legalizing marijuana for medical and recreational use, older Democrats are less likely to say this.

About half of Democrats ages 75 and older (53%) say marijuana should be legal for both purposes, but much larger shares of younger Democrats say the same (including 81% of Democrats ages 18 to 29). Still, only 7% of Democrats ages 65 and older think marijuana should not be legalized even for medical use, similar to the share of all other Democrats who say this.

Views of the effects of legalizing recreational marijuana among racial and ethnic groups

Substantial shares of Americans across racial and ethnic groups say when marijuana is legal for recreational use, it has a more positive than negative impact on the economy and criminal justice system.

Economy

About half of White (52%), Black (53%) and Hispanic (51%) adults say legalizing recreational marijuana is good for local economies. A slightly smaller share of Asian adults (46%) say the same.

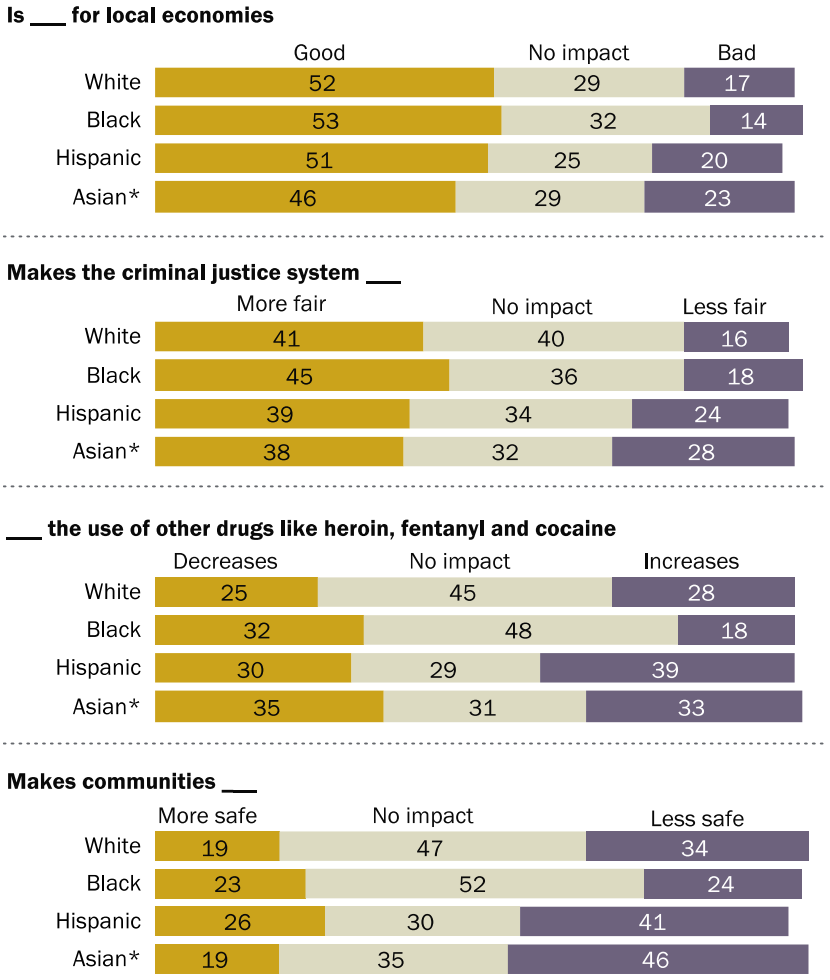
Criminal justice

Across racial and ethnic groups, about four-in-ten say that recreational marijuana being legal makes the criminal justice system fairer, with smaller shares saying it would make it less fair.

However, there are wider racial differences on questions regarding the impact of recreational marijuana on the use of other drugs and the safety of communities.

Hispanic and Asian adults more likely than Black and White adults to say legalizing recreational marijuana negatively impacts safety, use of other drugs

*% who say **when marijuana is legal for recreational use,** it ...*



* Asian adults were interviewed in English only.
Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race. No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Use of other drugs

Nearly half of Black adults (48%) say recreational marijuana legalization doesn't have an effect on the use of drugs like heroin, fentanyl and cocaine. Another 32% in this group say it *decreases* the use of these drugs and 18% say it increases their use.

In contrast, Hispanic adults are slightly more likely to say legal marijuana *increases* the use of these other drugs (39%) than to say it decreases this use (30%); 29% say it has no impact.

Among White adults, the balance of opinion is mixed: 28% say marijuana legalization increases the use of other drugs and 25% say it decreases their use (45% say it has no impact). Views among Asian adults are also mixed, though a smaller share (31%) say legalization has no impact on the use of other drugs.

Community safety

Hispanic and Asian adults also are more likely to say marijuana's legalization makes communities less safe: 41% of Hispanic adults and 46% of Asian adults say this, compared with 34% of White adults and 24% of Black adults.

Wide age gap on views of impact of legalizing recreational marijuana

Young Americans view the legalization of marijuana for recreational use in more positive terms compared with their older counterparts.

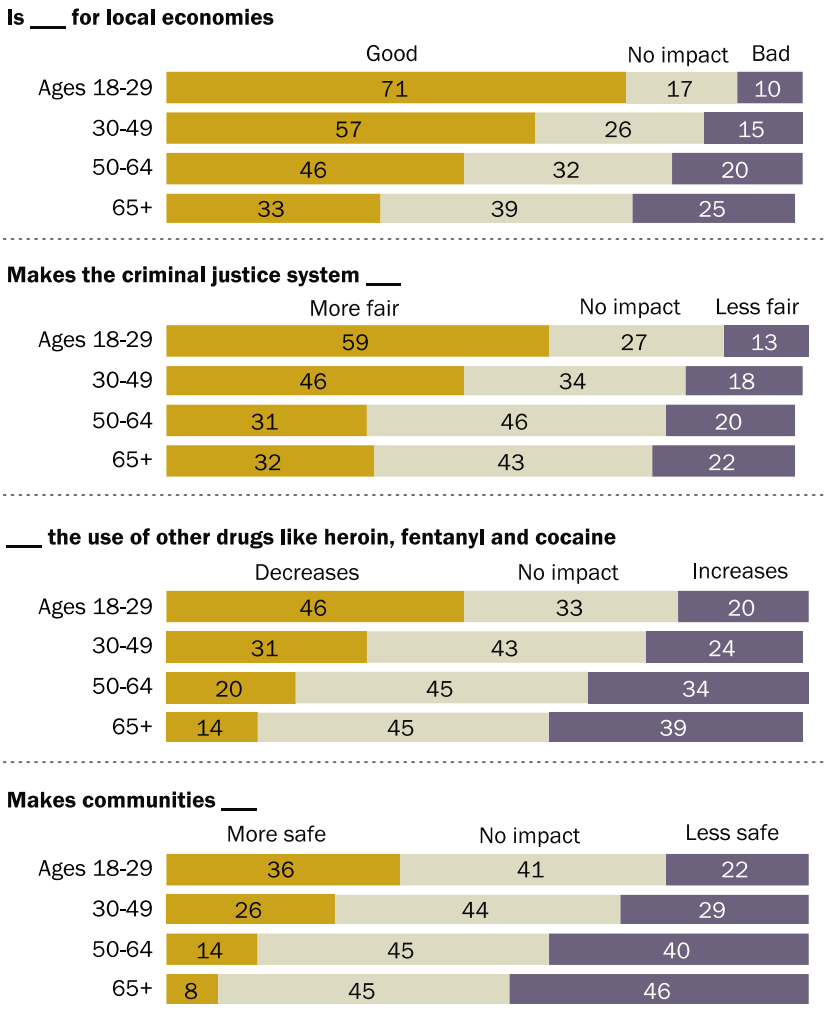
Clear majorities of adults under 30 say it is good for local economies (71%) and that it makes the criminal justice system fairer (59%).

By comparison, a third of Americans ages 65 and older say legalizing the recreational use of marijuana is good for local economies; about as many (32%) say it makes the criminal justice system more fair.

There also are sizable differences in opinion by age about how legalizing recreational marijuana affects the use of other drugs and the safety of communities.

Young adults far more likely than older people to say legalizing recreational marijuana has positive impacts

% who say ***when marijuana is legal for recreational use,*** *it ...*



Note: No answer responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Jan. 16-21, 2024.

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Acknowledgments

This report is a collaborative effort based on the input and analysis of the following individuals:

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Methodology

The American Trends Panel survey methodology

Overview

The American Trends Panel (ATP), created by Pew Research Center, is a nationally representative panel of randomly selected U.S. adults. Panelists participate via self-administered web surveys. Panelists who do not have internet access at home are provided with a tablet and wireless internet connection. Interviews are conducted in both English and Spanish. The panel is being managed by Ipsos.

Data in this report is drawn from ATP Wave 140, conducted from Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024, and includes an oversample of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men, and Hispanic men in order to provide more precise estimates of the opinions and experiences of these smaller demographic subgroups. These oversampled groups are weighted back to reflect their correct proportions in the population. A total of 5,140 panelists responded out of 5,604 who were sampled, for a response rate of 92%. The cumulative response rate accounting for nonresponse to the recruitment surveys and attrition is 3%. The break-off rate among panelists who logged on to the survey and completed at least one item is less than 1%. The margin of sampling error for the full sample of 5,140 respondents is plus or minus 1.7 percentage points.

Panel recruitment

The ATP was created in 2014, with the first cohort of panelists invited to join the panel at the end of a large, national, landline and cellphone random-digit-dial survey that was conducted in both English and Spanish. Two additional recruitments were conducted using the same method in 2015 and 2017, respectively. Across these three surveys, a total of 19,718 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 9,942 (50%) agreed to participate.

In August 2018, the ATP switched from telephone to address-based sampling (ABS) recruitment. A study cover letter and a pre-incentive are mailed to a stratified, random sample of households selected from the U.S. Postal Service's Delivery Sequence File. This Postal Service file has been estimated to cover as much as 98% of the population, although some studies suggest that the coverage could be in the low 90% range.[1] Within each sampled household, the adult with the next

[1] AAPOR Task Force on Address-based Sampling. 2016. "AAPOR Report: Address-based Sampling."

birthday is asked to participate. Other details of the ABS recruitment protocol have changed over time but are available upon request.[2]

We have recruited a national sample of U.S. adults to the ATP approximately once per year since 2014. In some years, the recruitment has included additional efforts (known as an "oversample") to boost sample size with underrepresented groups. For example, Hispanic adults, Black adults and Asian adults were oversampled in 2019, 2022 and 2023, respectively.

American Trends Panel recruitment surveys

Recruitment dates	Mode	Invited	Joined	Active panelists remaining
Jan. 23 to March 16, 2014	Landline/ cell RDD	9,809	5,338	1,393
Aug. 27 to Oct. 4, 2015	Landline/ cell RDD	6,004	2,976	831
April 25 to June 4, 2017	Landline/ cell RDD	3,905	1,628	405
Aug. 8 to Oct. 31, 2018	ABS	9,396	8,778	3,850
Aug. 19 to Nov. 30, 2019	ABS	5,900	4,720	1,388
June 1 to July 19, 2020; Feb. 10 to March 31, 2021	ABS	3,197	2,812	1,441
May 29 to July 7, 2021; Sept. 16 to Nov. 1, 2021	ABS	1,329	1,162	731
May 24 to Sept. 29, 2022	ABS	3,354	2,869	1,457
April 17 to May 30, 2023	ABS	686	576	435
	Total	**43,580**	**30,859**	**11,931**

Note: RDD is random-digit dial; ABS is address-based sampling. Approximately once per year, panelists who have not participated in multiple consecutive waves or who did not complete an annual profiling survey are removed from the panel. Panelists also become inactive if they ask to be removed from the panel.

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Across the six address-based recruitments, a total of 23,862 adults were invited to join the ATP, of whom 20,917 agreed to join the panel and completed an initial profile survey. Of the 30,859 individuals who have ever joined the ATP, 11,931 remained active panelists and continued to receive survey invitations at the time this survey was conducted.

The American Trends Panel never uses breakout routers or chains that direct respondents to additional surveys.

Sample design

The overall target population for this survey was noninstitutionalized persons ages 18 and older living in the U.S., including Alaska and Hawaii. It featured a stratified random sample from the ATP in which Hispanic men, non-Hispanic Black men and non-Hispanic Asian adults were selected with certainty. The remaining panelists were sampled at rates designed to ensure that the share of respondents in each stratum is proportional to its share of the U.S. adult population to the

[2] Email pewsurveys@pewresearch.org.

greatest extent possible. Respondent weights are adjusted to account for differential probabilities of selection as described in the Weighting section below.

Questionnaire development and testing

The questionnaire was developed by Pew Research Center in consultation with Ipsos. The web program was rigorously tested on both PC and mobile devices by the Ipsos project management team and Pew Research Center researchers. The Ipsos project management team also populated test data that was analyzed in SPSS to ensure the logic and randomizations were working as intended before launching the survey.

Incentives

All respondents were offered a post-paid incentive for their participation. Respondents could choose to receive the post-paid incentive in the form of a check or a gift code to Amazon.com or could choose to decline the incentive. Incentive amounts ranged from $5 to $20 depending on whether the respondent belongs to a part of the population that is harder or easier to reach. Differential incentive amounts were designed to increase panel survey participation among groups that traditionally have low survey response propensities.

Data collection protocol

The data collection field period for this survey was Jan. 16 to Jan. 21, 2024. Postcard notifications were mailed to a subset of sampled ATP panelists with a known residential address on Jan. 16.[3]

Invitations were sent out in two separate launches: soft launch and full launch. Sixty panelists were included in the soft launch, which began with an initial invitation sent on Jan. 16. The ATP panelists chosen for the initial soft launch were known responders who had completed previous ATP surveys within one day of receiving their invitation. All remaining English- and Spanish-speaking sampled panelists were included in the full launch and were sent an invitation on Jan. 17.

All panelists with an email address received an email invitation and up to two email reminders if they did not respond to the survey. All ATP panelists who consented to SMS messages received an SMS invitation and up to two SMS reminders.

[3] Postcards notifications are sent to 1) panelists who have been provided with a tablet to take ATP surveys, 2) panelists who were recruited within the last two years, and 3) panelists recruited prior to the last two years who opt to continue receiving postcard notifications.

Invitation and reminder dates, ATP Wave 140

	Soft launch	Full launch
Initial invitation	Jan. 16, 2024	Jan. 17, 2024
First reminder	Jan. 18, 2024	Jan. 18, 2024
Final reminder	Jan. 20, 2024	Jan. 20, 2024

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Data quality checks

To ensure high-quality data, the Center's researchers performed data quality checks to identify any respondents showing clear patterns of satisficing. This includes checking for whether respondents left questions blank at very high rates or always selected the first or last answer presented. As a result of this checking, four ATP respondents were removed from the survey dataset prior to weighting and analysis.

Weighting

The ATP data is weighted in a multistep process that accounts for multiple stages of sampling and nonresponse that occur at different points in the survey process. First, each panelist begins with a base weight that reflects their probability of selection for their initial recruitment survey. These weights are then rescaled and adjusted to account for changes in the design of ATP recruitment surveys from year to year. Finally, the weights are calibrated to align with the population benchmarks in the accompanying table to correct for nonresponse to recruitment surveys and panel attrition. If only a subsample of panelists was invited to participate in the wave, this weight is adjusted to account for any differential probabilities of selection.

American Trends Panel weighting dimensions

Variable	Benchmark source
Age (detailed) Age x Gender Education x Gender Education x Age Race/Ethnicity x Education Black (alone or in combination) x Hispanic Born inside vs. outside the U.S. among Hispanics and Asian Americans Years lived in the U.S. Census region x Metropolitan status	2022 American Community Survey (ACS)
Volunteerism	2021 CPS Volunteering & Civic Life Supplement
Voter registration	2022 CPS Voting and Registration Supplement
Party affiliation x Race/Ethnicity Frequency of internet use Religious affiliation	2023 National Public Opinion Reference Survey (NPORS)

Note: Estimates from the ACS are based on noninstitutionalized adults. Voter registration is calculated using procedures from Hur, Achen (2013) and rescaled to include the total U.S. adult population.

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Among the panelists who completed the survey, this weight is then calibrated again to align with the population benchmarks identified in the accompanying table and trimmed at the 2nd and 98th percentiles to reduce the loss in precision stemming from variance in the weights. This trimming is performed separately among non-Hispanic Black, non-Hispanic Asian, Hispanic and all other respondents. Sampling errors and tests of statistical significance take into account the effect of weighting.

The following table shows the unweighted sample sizes and the error attributable to sampling that would be expected at the 95% level of confidence for different groups in the survey.

Sample sizes and margins of error, ATP Wave 140

Group	Unweighted sample size	Weighted %	Plus or minus ...
Total sample	5,140		1.7 percentage points
Rep/Lean Rep	2,210	45	2.5 percentage points
Dem/Lean Dem	2,710	47	2.4 percentage points

Note: This survey includes oversamples of non-Hispanic Asian adults, non-Hispanic Black men, and Hispanic men. Unweighted sample sizes do not account for the sample design or weighting and do not describe a group's contribution to weighted estimates. Refer to the Sample design and Weighting sections above for details.

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Sample sizes and sampling errors for other subgroups are available upon request. In addition to sampling error, one should bear in mind that question wording and practical difficulties in conducting surveys can introduce error or bias into the findings of opinion polls.

Dispositions and response rates

Final dispositions, ATP Wave 140

	AAPOR code	Total
Completed interview	1.1	5,140
Logged on to survey; broke off	2.12	23
Logged on to survey; did not complete any items	2.1121	49
Never logged on (implicit refusal)	2.11	387
Survey completed after close of the field period	2.27	1
Completed interview but was removed for data quality	2.3	4
Screened out	4.7	0
Total panelists sampled for the survey		**5,604**
Completed interviews	I	5,140
Partial interviews	P	0
Refusals	R	459
Non-contact	NC	1
Other	O	4
Unknown household	UH	0
Unknown other	UO	0
Not eligible	NE	0
Total		**5,604**
AAPOR RR1 = I / (I+P+R+NC+O+UH+UO)		92%

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Cumulative response rate as of ATP Wave 140

	Total
Weighted response rate to recruitment surveys	11%
% of recruitment survey respondents who agreed to join the panel, among those invited	71%
% of those agreeing to join who were active panelists at start of Wave 140	46%
Response rate to Wave 140 survey	92%
Cumulative response rate	**3%**

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2024 PEW RESEARCH CENTER'S AMERICAN TRENDS PANEL
WAVE 140 JANUARY 2024
FINAL TOPLINE
JANUARY 16–21, 2024
N=5,140

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

ASK ALL:
MARIJUANA3 Which comes closer to your view about the use of marijuana by adults?

Jan 16-21, 2024		Oct 10-16, 2022	Apr 5-11, 2021	Sep 3-15, 2019	Aug 16-Sep 12 2016[3]
57	It should be legal for medical AND recreational use	59	60	59	49
32	It should be legal for medical use ONLY	30	31	32	35
11	It should NOT be legal	10	8	8	15
*	No answer	1	1	*	1

ASK ALL:
MARIJ_STRICT Are marijuana laws in your state… **[RANDOMIZE OPTIONS 1-2; ALWAYS ASK OPTIONS 3 AND 4 LAST]**

Jan 16-21, 2024	
24	Too strict
19	Not strict enough
36	About right
21	Not sure
1	No answer

[RANDOMIZE MARIJ_CRIME, MARIJ_ECON, MARIJ_FAIR AND MARIJ_DRUG AND DISPLAY ON SAME PAGE; RANDOMIZE OPTIONS 1-2 WITHIN ITEMS; ALWAYS ASK OPTION 3 LAST]

ASK ALL:
MARIJ_CRIME When marijuana is legal for recreational use, it…

Jan 16-21, 2024	
21	Makes communities more safe
34	Makes communities less safe
44	Does not have much impact
1	No answer

[3] In the survey conducted Aug. 16-Sept. 12, 2016, question wording asked about "medical and personal use" of marijuana.

ASK ALL:
MARIJ_ECON When marijuana is legal for recreational use, it…

Jan 16-21, 2024	
52	Is good for local economies
17	Is bad for local economies
29	Does not have much impact
2	No answer

ASK ALL:
MARIJ_FAIR When marijuana is legal for recreational use, it…

Jan 16-21, 2024	
42	Makes the criminal justice system more fair
18	Makes the criminal justice system less fair
38	Does not have much impact
2	No answer

ASK ALL:
MARIJ_DRUG When marijuana is legal for recreational use, it…

Jan 16-21, 2024	
29	Increases the use of other drugs like heroin, fentanyl and cocaine
27	Decreases the use of other drugs like heroin, fentanyl and cocaine
42	Does not have much impact
2	No answer

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ASK ALL:
PARTY In politics today, do you consider yourself a:
ASK IF INDEP/SOMETHING ELSE (PARTY=3 or 4) OR MISSING:
PARTYLN As of today do you lean more to…[7]

Republican	Democrat	Independent	Something else	No answer	*Lean Rep*	*Lean Dem*
28	29	27	13	3	17	18

Key to Pew Research trends noted in the topline:

(U) Pew Research Center/USA Today polls

[7] PARTY and PARTYLN asked in a prior survey.